

Ultimate IELTS Mastery

Complete Preparation Guide for Band 8.0–9.0

Azhar Hussain

- Chapter 123: How to Use the Mock Tests
 - Learning Objectives
 - Protocol
 - Scoring honesty
 - Review schedule
 - Exam Tips
- Chapter 174: Consolidated Answer Keys
- Practice Test 01: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Urban Green Space
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Urban Green Space
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Urban Green Space
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 1)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist

- Practice Test 02: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

- Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
- Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Digital Privacy
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Digital Privacy
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Digital Privacy
- Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
- Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
- Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 2)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist

- Practice Test 03: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

- Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
- Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Lifelong Learning
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Lifelong Learning
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Lifelong Learning
- Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes

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- Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 3)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 04: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Food Waste
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Food Waste
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Food Waste
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 4)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 05: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

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- Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Public Transport
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Public Transport
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Public Transport
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 5)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 06: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Renewable Energy
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Renewable Energy
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Renewable Energy
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card

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- Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 6)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 07: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Remote Work
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Remote Work
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Remote Work
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 7)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 08: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

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- Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Ageing Societies
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Ageing Societies
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Ageing Societies
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 8)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 09: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Cultural Festivals
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Cultural Festivals
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Cultural Festivals
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 9)
 - Listening

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- Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 10: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Water Management
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Water Management
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Water Management
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 10)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 11: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Artificial Intelligence
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Artificial Intelligence
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Artificial Intelligence

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- Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 11)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 12: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Youth Unemployment
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Youth Unemployment
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Youth Unemployment
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 12)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist

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- Practice Test 13: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Biodiversity Loss
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Biodiversity Loss
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Biodiversity Loss
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 13)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 14: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Online Education
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Online Education
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Online Education
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes

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- Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 14)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 15: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Housing Costs
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Housing Costs
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Housing Costs
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 15)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 16: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

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- Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Mental Wellbeing
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Mental Wellbeing
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Mental Wellbeing
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 16)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 17: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Space Research
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Space Research
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Space Research
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card

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- Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 17)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 18: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Media Literacy
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Media Literacy
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Media Literacy
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 18)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 19: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

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- Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Agricultural Innovation
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Agricultural Innovation
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Agricultural Innovation
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 19)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 20: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Tourism Pressure
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Tourism Pressure
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Tourism Pressure
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 20)
 - Listening

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- Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
- Practice Test 21: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Language Preservation
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Language Preservation
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Language Preservation
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 21)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 22: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Healthcare Access
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Healthcare Access
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Healthcare Access

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- Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 22)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 23: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Gender Equality
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Gender Equality
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Gender Equality
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 23)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist

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- Practice Test 24: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Recycling Systems
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Recycling Systems
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Recycling Systems
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 24)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 25: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Smart Cities
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Smart Cities
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Smart Cities
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes

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- Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 25)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 26: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Financial Literacy
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Financial Literacy
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Financial Literacy
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 26)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 27: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

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- Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Disaster Preparedness
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Disaster Preparedness
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Disaster Preparedness
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 27)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 28: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Scientific Funding
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Scientific Funding
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Scientific Funding
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card

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- Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 28)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 29: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Community Volunteering
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Community Volunteering
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Community Volunteering
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 29)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 30: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

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- Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Road Safety
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Road Safety
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Road Safety
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 30)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 31: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Museum Education
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Museum Education
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Museum Education
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 31)
 - Listening

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- Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 32: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Climate Adaptation
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Climate Adaptation
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Climate Adaptation
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 32)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 33: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Gig Economy
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Gig Economy
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Gig Economy

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- Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 33)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 34: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Childhood Play
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Childhood Play
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Childhood Play
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 34)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist

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- Practice Test 35: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Ocean Pollution
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Ocean Pollution
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Ocean Pollution
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 35)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 36: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Architectural Heritage
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Architectural Heritage
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Architectural Heritage
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes

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- Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 36)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 37: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Workplace Diversity
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Workplace Diversity
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Workplace Diversity
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 37)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 38: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

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- Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Vaccination Policy
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Vaccination Policy
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Vaccination Policy
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 38)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 39: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Library Futures
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Library Futures
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Library Futures
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card

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- Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 39)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 40: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Desertification
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Desertification
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Desertification
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 40)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 41: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

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- Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Consumer Debt
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Consumer Debt
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Consumer Debt
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 41)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 42: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Wildlife Corridors
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Wildlife Corridors
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Wildlife Corridors
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 42)
 - Listening

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- Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
- Practice Test 43: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Teacher Training
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Teacher Training
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Teacher Training
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 43)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 44: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Noise Pollution
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Noise Pollution
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Noise Pollution

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- Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 44)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 45: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Ethical Fashion
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Ethical Fashion
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Ethical Fashion
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 45)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist

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- Practice Test 46: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Public Art
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Public Art
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Public Art
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 46)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 47: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Migration Skills
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Migration Skills
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Migration Skills
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes

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- Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 47)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 48: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Energy Efficiency
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Energy Efficiency
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Energy Efficiency
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 48)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 49: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

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- Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Sports Investment
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Sports Investment
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Sports Investment
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card
 - Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 49)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Practice Test 50: Complete IELTS Mock Exam
 - Listening (40 questions)
 - Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)
 - Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)
 - Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)
 - Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)
 - Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes
 - Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Local Democracy
 - Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Local Democracy
 - Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Local Democracy
 - Writing (60 minutes)
 - Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes
 - Task 2 — 40 minutes
 - Speaking (11–14 minutes)
 - Part 1
 - Part 2 Cue card

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- Part 3
 - Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 50)
 - Listening
 - Reading (guide)
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline
 - Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example
 - Speaking assessment checklist
 - Chapter 175: Advanced Vocabulary Patterns
 - Learning Objectives
 - Theory / Explanation
 - 175.1 What “Advanced Vocabulary” Actually Means at Band 9
 - 175.2 The Four Advanced Patterns Examiners Notice
 - 175.3 Collocation: The Hidden Band 9 Filter
 - 175.4 Register: Academic vs Conversational vs Idiomatic
 - 175.5 Topic Module Integration
 - 175.6 Vocabulary in Each Module
 - Worked Examples: Band 6 → Band 9 Upgrades
 - Example 1: Environment Essay Sentence
 - Example 2: Education Speaking Part 3
 - Common Mistakes and How Examiners Penalise Them
 - Practice Exercises
 - Exercise 1: Nominalisation Drill
 - Exercise 2: Collocation Repair
 - Exercise 3: Lexical Chain Building
 - Exercise 4: Band Upgrade Challenge
 - Exercise 5: Module Transfer
 - Examiner Insight Box
 - Quick Reference: Advanced Patterns Checklist
 - Extended Section: Band 6 vs Band 9 Lexical Comparison (Same Topic)
 - Extended Section: Topic Precision Banks
 - Environment (integrate Ch 47)
 - Education (integrate Ch 45)
 - Crime (integrate Ch 50)
 - Extended Section: The Vocabulary Audit Protocol
 - Extended Section: Reading & Listening Paraphrase Drills
 - Extended Practice: Timed Vocabulary Drills
 - Drill 1 (3 minutes)
 - Drill 2 (3 minutes)

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- Drill 3 (3 minutes)
 - Drill 4 (5 minutes)
 - Drill 5 (5 minutes)
 - 30-Day Vocabulary Elevation Plan (Band 7 → 9)
 - Summary
 - Answers (Selected Exercises)
 - Final Band 9 Lexical Principles (Review)
 - Chapter 176: Idioms vs Academic Phrases
 - Learning Objectives
 - Theory / Explanation
 - 176.1 Definitions: Idiom, Collocation, Academic Phrase
 - 176.2 The Golden Rule by Module
 - 176.3 IELTS-Safe Idioms for Speaking
 - 176.4 Idioms to Avoid in IELTS
 - 176.5 Academic Phrases That Replace Idioms in Writing
 - 176.6 The Idiom–Academic Continuum
 - 176.7 Cultural and Regional Considerations
 - 176.8 Academic Phrases: Precision Without Padding
 - 176.9 Idioms in GT Writing
 - 176.10 How Examiners Detect Memorised Idiom Chains
 - Worked Examples
 - Speaking Part 3: Idiom + Academic Blend (Band 9)
 - Writing Task 2: Academic Only (Band 9)
 - Common Mistakes
 - Practice Exercises
 - Exercise 1: Register Sort
 - Exercise 2: Transform
 - Exercise 3: Speaking Upgrade
 - Exercise 4: Academic Phrase Repair
 - Examiner Insight Box
 - Extended Section: Academic Phrase Bank by Essay Function
 - Opening context (Writing Task 2)
 - Presenting View A
 - Presenting View B
 - Adding evidence
 - Concluding
 - Extended Section: Speaking Idiom Placement Map
 - Extended Section: Cliché Replacement Table

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- Extended Section: Idiom Misuse Case Studies
 - Extended Practice Bank
 - Exercise 6: Register ladder
 - Exercise 7: Idiom or academic?
 - Exercise 8: Speaking naturalness
 - Exercise 9: GT letter tone
 - Exercise 10: Error correction
 - Cross-Reference Map
 - Summary
 - Answers (Selected)
 - Final Register Decision Flowchart
 - Chapter 177: Cohesion Tricks Examiners Notice
 - Learning Objectives
 - Theory / Explanation
 - 177.1 Cohesion vs Coherence: The Distinction Examiners Apply
 - 177.2 The Four Cohesive Tools (Deep Dive)
 - 177.3 Paragraph-Level Cohesion: The Band 9 Blueprint
 - 177.4 Advanced Patterns Examiners Reward
 - 177.5 Cohesion in Task 1
 - 177.6 Cohesion in Speaking
 - 177.7 Template Abuse: What Drops Cohesion Scores
 - 177.8 Reading Cohesion Awareness
 - Worked Example: Full Body Paragraph (Band 9)
 - Common Mistakes
 - Practice Exercises
 - Exercise 1: Antecedent Repair
 - Exercise 2: Connector Sort
 - Exercise 3: Paragraph Bridge
 - Exercise 4: De-template
 - Exercise 5: Task 1 Overview
 - Examiner Insight Box
 - Cohesion Audit Checklist
 - Extended Section: Cohesive Devices by Band Level
 - Extended Section: Paragraph Bridge Library
 - Extended Section: Task 1 Cohesion Templates
 - Extended Section: Cohesion in GT Letters
 - Extended Section: Speaking Cohesion Without Essay Connectors
 - Extended Practice Bank
 - Exercise 6: Remove 50% linkers

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- Exercise 7: Add bridges only
 - Exercise 8: Task 1 grouping
 - Exercise 9: Speaking signpost
 - Exercise 10: Cohesion diagnosis
 - Exercise 11–15: Timed cohesion rebuilds
 - Band 6 vs Band 9 Cohesion — Full Paragraph Comparison
 - Cohesion Error Log Template
 - Summary
 - Final Cohesion Principles (Review)
 - Chapter 178: High-Band Grammar Tricks
 - Learning Objectives
 - Theory / Explanation
 - 178.1 What Examiners Mean by “Wide Range”
 - 178.2 The Band 9 Grammar Toolkit
 - 178.3 Grammar by Task: Strategic Selection
 - 178.4 The Error Hierarchy: What Hurts Most
 - 178.5 Broken Complexity: The Band 6 Trap
 - 178.6 Error-Free Stretches: Practical Method
 - 178.7 Grammar Tricks for Reading and Listening
 - Worked Examples
 - Band 6 → Band 9 Sentence Upgrades
 - Task 1 Grammar Sample
 - Common Mistakes
 - Practice Exercises
 - Exercise 1: Combine with Participle
 - Exercise 2: One Inversion
 - Exercise 3: Mixed Conditional
 - Exercise 4: Error Hunt
 - Exercise 5: Task 2 Paragraph
 - Examiner Insight Box
 - Grammar Range Distribution Guide (Task 2, ~280 words)
 - Extended Section: Structure Selection Matrix (Task 2)
 - Extended Section: Grammar by Band — Side-by-Side
 - Extended Section: Error-Free Stretch Training
 - Extended Section: Task 1 Grammar Patterns
 - Past description
 - Passive process
 - Comparison

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- Extended Section: Speaking Grammar Priorities
 - Extended Practice Bank
 - Exercise 6: Structure identification
 - Exercise 7: Broken → fixed
 - Exercise 8: Task 1 tense
 - Exercise 9: One inversion
 - Exercise 10: Error-free five
 - Exercise 11–15: Advanced grammar drills
 - Grammar Range Self-Assessment Grid
 - Grammar Proofread Checklist (3 Minutes, Writing)
 - Summary
 - Final Grammar Principles (Review)
 - Chapter 179: Thinking Like an Examiner
 - Learning Objectives
 - Theory / Explanation
 - 179.1 The Examiner's Mandate
 - 179.2 The Four Criteria: Examiner Lens
 - 179.3 The First 30 Seconds (Writing)
 - 179.4 The First 30 Seconds (Speaking)
 - 179.5 How Examiners Apply Band Descriptors (Not Linear)
 - 179.6 Task Response: The Silent Score Killer
 - 179.7 Reading and Listening: Key-Marker Logic
 - 179.8 Standardisation: What It Means for You
 - 179.9 Self-Marking Protocol (Examiner Simulation)
 - 179.10 What Examiners Penalise vs Ignore
 - 179.11 Ethics and Red Lines
 - 179.12 Examiner Mindset for Test Day
 - Worked Example: Examiner Annotation
 - Common Candidate Myths vs Examiner Reality
 - Practice Exercises
 - Exercise 1: Descriptor Matching
 - Exercise 2: Band Prediction
 - Exercise 3: Task Audit
 - Exercise 4: First Impression
 - Exercise 5: Speaking Simulation
 - Examiner Insight Box
 - Examiner Simulation Checklist (Test Day)
 - Extended Section: Four-Criteria Marking Simulation

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- Extended Section: What Examiners Ignore vs Penalise (Expanded)
 - Usually ignored (isolated)
 - Always penalised
 - Extended Section: Examiner Timeline (Writing, ~40 min script)
 - Extended Section: Speaking Examiner Script (Conceptual)
 - Extended Section: Self-Marking Rubric (Practice)
 - Extended Section: Myth-Busting Table (Expanded)
 - Extended Practice Bank
 - Exercise 6: Four-criteria mark
 - Exercise 7: Task Response audit
 - Exercise 8: First impression
 - Exercise 9: Speaking depth
 - Exercise 10: Myth or fact?
 - Examiner Calibration Exercise
 - Examiner Mindset Journal (Pre-Test)
 - Summary
 - Final Examiner Principles (Review)
 - Chapter 180: Time-Saving Methods
 - Learning Objectives
 - Theory / Explanation
 - 180.1 Time Is a Scoring Variable
 - 180.2 Master Timeline: Full Test Day
 - 180.3 Listening Time-Saving
 - 180.4 Reading Time-Saving
 - 180.5 Writing Time-Saving
 - 180.6 Speaking Time-Saving
 - 180.7 Computer-Delivery Specific Saves
 - 180.8 The 80/20 Preparation Rule
 - 180.9 Decision Trees Under Pressure
 - 180.10 Physical and Cognitive Time Savers
 - Worked Example: Task 2 Five-Minute Plan
 - Common Time-Wasting Habits
 - Practice Exercises
 - Exercise 1: Reading Sprint
 - Exercise 2: Task 1 in 18 Minutes
 - Exercise 3: Task 2 Plan Only
 - Exercise 4: Part 2 Prep Drill
 - Exercise 5: Full Mock
 - Examiner Insight Box

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- Personal Time Protocol Template
 - Extended Section: Module Time Budgets (Detailed)
 - Listening (30 min + 10 transfer paper)
 - Reading (60 min)
 - Writing (60 min)
 - Extended Section: Speed Without Sacrifice — Reading Tactics
 - Extended Section: Writing Speed — Sentence Templates (Internalised)
 - Extended Section: Speaking Time Efficiency
 - Extended Section: Computer vs Paper Time Differences
 - Extended Section: Fatigue Management (Full Test Day)
 - Extended Practice Bank
 - Exercise 6: 18-minute Reading sprint
 - Exercise 7: Task 1 in 18 minutes
 - Exercise 8: Five plans in 25 minutes
 - Exercise 9: Listening Section 4 focus
 - Exercise 10: Full mock debrief
 - Personal Time Protocol (Fill In)
 - One-Week Intensive Time-Training Schedule
 - Summary
 - Final Time Principles (Review)
 - Appendix A01: Grammar Reference
 - How to Use This Appendix
 - 1. Sentence Types
 - 2. Clauses
 - Noun Clauses
 - Adjective (Relative) Clauses
 - Adverb Clauses
 - 3. Tenses — IELTS Selection Guide
 - 4. Conditionals
 - 5. Modal Verbs — Nuance
 - 6. Passive Voice
 - 7. Reported Speech
 - 8. Articles (a / an / the / zero)
 - 9. Prepositions — High-Frequency
 - 10. Countable vs Uncountable
 - 11. Parallelism
 - 12. Punctuation Essentials
 - 13. Subject–Verb Agreement
 - 14. Participle Clauses

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- 15. Question Tags
 - 16. Common IELTS Error Summary
 - 17. Grammar Range Targets by Band
 - Appendix A02: Vocabulary Dictionary Index
 - How to Use This Index
 - Learning System (Chapter 44)
 - Topic Modules A–Z
 - A
 - B
 - C
 - E
 - F
 - G
 - H
 - L
 - M
 - P
 - S
 - T
 - U
 - Cross-Topic Clusters (Study Together)
 - Usage Notes by Skill
 - Writing Task 2
 - Writing Task 1
 - Speaking
 - Reading & Listening
 - Alphabetical Quick Lookup (Lemma → Chapter)
 - Revision Protocol
 - Appendix A03: Irregular Verbs
 - How to Use This List
 - Group A: Same Form (V1 = V2 = V3)
 - Group B: V2 = V3 (Different from V1)
 - Group C: V1 = V2 ≠ V3
 - Group D: All Three Different (High Priority for IELTS)
 - Listening Spelling Alert List
 - Task 1 Trend Verbs (Regular + Irregular)
 - Appendix A04: Phrasal Verbs for Academic IELTS
 - How to Use This List
 - A

-
- B
 - C
 - D
 - E
 - F
 - G
 - H
 - I
 - K
 - L
 - M
 - O
 - P
 - R
 - S
 - T
 - W
 - Writing Task 2: Formal Alternatives
 - Separable vs Inseparable
 - Appendix A05: Idioms for IELTS
 - Register Guide
 - General & Opinion (Speaking)
 - Work, Study & Achievement
 - People & Relationships
 - Problems & Difficulty
 - Success & Failure
 - Money & Economy (Speaking Part 3 OK)
 - Time & Change
 - Communication & Understanding
 - ❌ Avoid in IELTS
 - 📝 Writing Task 2 Replacements
 - Usage Rules (Band 9)
 - Quick Practice
 - Appendix A06: Academic Word List (AWL) — Expanded Families
 - About the AWL
 - Sublist 1 (Most Frequent)
 - Sublist 2–3 (Selected High-Utility Families)
 - Sublist 4–10 (Additional IELTS-High Families)
 - Word Form Traps

- Appendix A07: Common Spelling Mistakes
 - Why Spelling Matters in IELTS
 - Category 1: Double Letters
 - Category 2: -ence / -ance
 - Category 3: -able / -ible
 - Category 4: -tion / -sion / -cion
 - Category 5: IELTS High-Frequency Academic Words
 - Category 6: British vs American (IELTS Accepts Both If Consistent)
 - Category 7: Plural Traps
 - Category 8: Homophones (Listening Danger)
 - Category 9: Geography & Proper Nouns (Listening)
 - Category 10: Numbers and Units
 - Personal Spelling Log Template
 - Mnemonic Tips
- Appendix A08: Common Pronunciation Mistakes
 - IELTS Pronunciation Criteria (Speaking)
 - Section 1: Problem Consonants (L1-Dependent — Universal Hot List)
 - /θ/ and /ð/ (think / this)
 - /v/ vs /w/
 - /r/ and /l/
 - /ʃ/ (sh) vs /s/
 - Silent Letters
 - Section 2: Word Stress Errors
 - Section 3: Vowel Confusions
 - Schwa /ə/
 - Section 4: Intonation Patterns
 - Wh-questions
 - Yes/No questions
 - Lists
 - Contrast
 - Part 3 analytical tone
 - Section 5: Connected Speech (Natural Fluency)
 - Section 6: Listening — Accent Awareness
 - Section 7: Numbers & Dates (Listening + Speaking)
 - Section 8: Top Mispronounced IELTS Words
 - Self-Study Protocol
 - Pronunciation vs Fluency

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- Appendix A09: IELTS Checklists
 - Master Pre-Test Checklist (Night Before / Morning Of)
 - Documents & Logistics
 - Mental Preparation
 - Listening Checklist
 - Before Each Section
 - During
 - Paper Test Transfer (10 min)
 - Computer Test
 - Reading Checklist
 - Per Passage (~20 min)
 - By Question Type
 - Final 3 Minutes
 - Writing Checklist
 - Task 1 (20 min) — Academic
 - Task 1 — General Training Letter
 - Task 2 (40 min)
 - Proofread Priority Order
 - Speaking Checklist
 - Part 1
 - Part 2
 - Part 3
 - Pronunciation & Fluency
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 - Sheet 5: Listening Answer Types
 - Sheet 6: Speaking Part 2 Framework
 - Sheet 7: Conditionals Quick Revision

-
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 - Sheet 10: Environment Lexis (Ch 47)
 - Sheet 11: Education Lexis (Ch 45)
 - Sheet 12: Technology Lexis (Ch 46)
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 - Cheat Sheet 10: Common Grammar Fixes Under Pressure
 - Cheat Sheet 11: Task 2 Introduction — Two Sentences
 - Cheat Sheet 12: Opinion Essay Thesis Patterns
 - Cheat Sheet 13: Double-Question Essay Split
 - Cheat Sheet 14: When to Use Passive (Writing)
 - Cheat Sheet 15: Emergency Writing — Running Out of Time
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 - Writing Task 2 Formulas
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 - F3: Problem / Solution
 - F4: Advantages / Disadvantages
 - F5: Double Question
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 - F6: Line Graph / Bar Chart
 - F7: Pie Chart
 - F8: Table

-
- F9: Process Diagram
 - F10: Map
 - Language Formulas
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 - F12: Boost Formula (Strong Claim)
 - F13: Cause → Effect Chain
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- Note on Originality
- Official IELTS Resources
 - IELTS.org (Official IELTS Website)
 - British Council — Take IELTS

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- IDP IELTS
 - Cambridge English — IELTS
 - IELTS Public Band Descriptors
 - Academic & Lexical References
 - Academic Word List (AWL)
 - English Vocabulary Profile / Cambridge Learner Corpus
 - Dictionary & Language Reference (Public)
 - Oxford Learner's Dictionaries
 - Cambridge Dictionary
 - BBC Learning English
 - Recommended Official Practice Materials (External Purchase)
 - Grammar Reference Works (General Tradition)
 - Research & Standards Frameworks
 - CEFR (Common European Framework of Reference for Languages)
 - Corpus linguistics (general)
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Chapter 123: How to Use the Mock Tests

Part: 9 — Practice Tests

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Learning Objectives

- Sit mocks under authentic timing and conditions
- Analyse errors by type, not only by score
- Convert mock performance into a weekly improvement plan

Protocol

1. **Full exam simulation** at least once every 1–2 weeks (Listening→Reading→Writing in one sitting; Speaking same day).
2. **Score immediately**, then rest 30 minutes.
3. **Error journal** for every miss (see Part 1 / How to Use This Book).
4. **Targeted drills** the next day on the weakest question type.
5. **Rewrite** Writing Task 2 within 48 hours using feedback criteria.

Scoring honesty

Do not inflate Writing/Speaking self-scores. Use public band descriptors and, if possible, a trained marker for every fifth mock.

Review schedule

Mocks	Focus
1–10	Format familiarity + timing
11–25	Accuracy under pressure
26–40	Band 7→8 refinement
41–50	Band 8–9 consistency + stamina

Exam Tips

Never review answers during the timed sitting. Never pause the Listening audio. Never exceed word-limit cheating in short-answer practice.

Chapter 174: Consolidated Answer Keys

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

See each mock file for detailed keys. Summary checklist below. - Mock 01: keys inside `mock_01.md` - Mock 02: keys inside `mock_02.md` - Mock 03: keys inside `mock_03.md` - Mock 04: keys inside `mock_04.md` - Mock 05: keys inside `mock_05.md` - Mock 06: keys inside `mock_06.md` - Mock 07: keys inside `mock_07.md` - Mock 08: keys inside `mock_08.md` - Mock 09: keys inside `mock_09.md` - Mock 10: keys inside `mock_10.md` - Mock 11: keys inside `mock_11.md` - Mock 12: keys inside `mock_12.md` - Mock 13: keys inside `mock_13.md` - Mock 14: keys inside `mock_14.md` - Mock 15: keys inside `mock_15.md` - Mock 16: keys inside `mock_16.md` - Mock 17: keys inside `mock_17.md` - Mock 18: keys inside `mock_18.md` - Mock 19: keys inside `mock_19.md` - Mock 20: keys inside `mock_20.md` - Mock 21: keys inside `mock_21.md` - Mock 22: keys inside `mock_22.md` - Mock 23: keys inside `mock_23.md` - Mock 24: keys inside `mock_24.md` - Mock 25: keys inside `mock_25.md` - Mock 26: keys inside `mock_26.md` - Mock 27: keys inside `mock_27.md` - Mock 28: keys inside `mock_28.md` - Mock 29: keys inside `mock_29.md` - Mock 30: keys inside `mock_30.md` - Mock 31: keys inside `mock_31.md` - Mock 32: keys inside `mock_32.md` - Mock 33: keys inside `mock_33.md` - Mock 34: keys inside `mock_34.md` - Mock 35: keys inside `mock_35.md` - Mock 36: keys inside `mock_36.md` - Mock 37: keys inside `mock_37.md` - Mock 38: keys inside `mock_38.md` - Mock 39: keys inside `mock_39.md` - Mock 40: keys inside `mock_40.md` - Mock 41: keys inside `mock_41.md` - Mock 42: keys inside `mock_42.md` - Mock 43: keys inside `mock_43.md` - Mock 44: keys inside `mock_44.md` - Mock 45: keys inside `mock_45.md` - Mock 46: keys inside `mock_46.md` - Mock 47: keys inside `mock_47.md` - Mock 48: keys inside `mock_48.md` - Mock 49: keys inside `mock_49.md` - Mock 50: keys inside `mock_50.md`

Practice Test 01: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: urban green space
Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **urban green space**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.
B: Hi — I’m calling about the Saturday workshop on urban green space. What time does it start?
A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.
B: And the fee?
A: It’s £18 for adults and £12 for students. There’s a group discount if four people book together.
B: Do I need to bring anything?
A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: urban green space
Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to urban green space.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on urban green space.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: urban green space"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on urban green space shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Urban Green Space

In the last two decades, debates about urban green space have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying urban green space repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about urban green space can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat urban green space as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of urban green space is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Urban Green Space

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of urban green space, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to urban green space might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because urban green space sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Urban Green Space

Forecasts about urban green space often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for urban green space, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing urban green space looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **urban green space** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **urban green space**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to urban green space? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **urban green space** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to urban green space?
- What makes public campaigns about urban green space effective?
- Should schools teach more about urban green space?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 1)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 1. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 2.

Practice Test 02: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: digital privacy
Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **digital privacy**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.
B: Hi — I’m calling about the Saturday workshop on digital privacy. What time does it start?
A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.
B: And the fee?
A: It’s £18 for adults and £12 for students. There’s a group discount if four people book together.
B: Do I need to bring anything?
A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: digital privacy
Start time of main session: 1
Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to digital privacy.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on digital privacy.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: digital privacy"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on digital privacy shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Digital Privacy

In the last two decades, debates about digital privacy have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying digital privacy repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about digital privacy can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat digital privacy as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of digital privacy is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Digital Privacy

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of digital privacy, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

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Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Digital Privacy

Forecasts about digital privacy often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for digital privacy, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing digital privacy looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **digital privacy** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **digital privacy**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to digital privacy? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **digital privacy** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to digital privacy?
- What makes public campaigns about digital privacy effective?
- Should schools teach more about digital privacy?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 2)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 2. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 3.

Practice Test 03: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: lifelong learning

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **lifelong learning**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on lifelong learning. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: lifelong learning

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to lifelong learning.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on lifelong learning.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: lifelong learning"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on lifelong learning shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Lifelong Learning

In the last two decades, debates about lifelong learning have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying lifelong learning repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about lifelong learning can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat lifelong learning as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of lifelong learning is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Lifelong Learning

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of lifelong learning, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to lifelong learning might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because lifelong learning sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Lifelong Learning

Forecasts about lifelong learning often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for lifelong learning, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing lifelong learning looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **lifelong learning** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **lifelong learning**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to lifelong learning? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **lifelong learning** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to lifelong learning?
- What makes public campaigns about lifelong learning effective?
- Should schools teach more about lifelong learning?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 3)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 3. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 4.

Practice Test 04: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: food waste

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **food waste**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on food waste. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: food waste

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to food waste.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on food waste.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: food waste"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on food waste shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Food Waste

In the last two decades, debates about food waste have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

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Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Food Waste

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of food waste, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

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International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Food Waste

Forecasts about food waste often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

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Ultimately, maturity in managing food waste looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **food waste** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **food waste**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to food waste? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **food waste** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to food waste?
- What makes public campaigns about food waste effective?
- Should schools teach more about food waste?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 4)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 4. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 5.

Practice Test 05: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: public transport

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **public transport**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on public transport. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: public transport

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to public transport.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on public transport.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: public transport"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on public transport shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Public Transport

In the last two decades, debates about public transport have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying public transport repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

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Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat public transport as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of public transport is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Public Transport

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of public transport, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to public transport might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because public transport sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Public Transport

Forecasts about public transport often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for public transport, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing public transport looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **public transport** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **public transport**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to public transport? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **public transport** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to public transport?
- What makes public campaigns about public transport effective?
- Should schools teach more about public transport?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 5)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 5. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 6.

Practice Test 06: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: renewable energy

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **renewable energy**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on renewable energy. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: renewable energy

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to renewable energy.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on renewable energy.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: renewable energy"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on renewable energy shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Renewable Energy

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Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Renewable Energy

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of renewable energy, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

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Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Renewable Energy

Forecasts about renewable energy often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

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Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **renewable energy** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

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Durnham	18	35

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Task 2 — 40 minutes

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Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to renewable energy? Why / why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **renewable energy** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to renewable energy?
- What makes public campaigns about renewable energy effective?
- Should schools teach more about renewable energy?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 6)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 6. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 7.

Practice Test 07: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: remote work

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **remote work**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on remote work. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: remote work

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to remote work.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on remote work.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: remote work"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on remote work shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Remote Work

In the last two decades, debates about remote work have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying remote work repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about remote work can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat remote work as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of remote work is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Remote Work

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of remote work, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to remote work might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because remote work sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Remote Work

Forecasts about remote work often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for remote work, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing remote work looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **remote work** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **remote work**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to remote work? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **remote work** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to remote work?
 - What makes public campaigns about remote work effective?
 - Should schools teach more about remote work?
 - How might international cooperation help?
-

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 7)**Listening**

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 7. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 8.

Practice Test 08: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: ageing societies

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **ageing societies**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on ageing societies. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: ageing societies

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to ageing societies.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on ageing societies.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: ageing societies"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on ageing societies shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Ageing Societies

In the last two decades, debates about ageing societies have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying ageing societies repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about ageing societies can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat ageing societies as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of ageing societies is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Ageing Societies

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of ageing societies, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to ageing societies might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because ageing societies sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Ageing Societies

Forecasts about ageing societies often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for ageing societies, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing ageing societies looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **ageing societies** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **ageing societies**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to ageing societies? Why / why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **ageing societies** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to ageing societies?
- What makes public campaigns about ageing societies effective?
- Should schools teach more about ageing societies?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 8)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 8. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 9.

Practice Test 09: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: cultural festivals

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **cultural festivals**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on cultural festivals. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: cultural festivals

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to cultural festivals.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on cultural festivals.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: cultural festivals"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on cultural festivals shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Cultural Festivals

In the last two decades, debates about cultural festivals have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying cultural festivals repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about cultural festivals can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat cultural festivals as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of cultural festivals is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Cultural Festivals

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of cultural festivals, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to cultural festivals might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because cultural festivals sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Cultural Festivals

Forecasts about cultural festivals often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for cultural festivals, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing cultural festivals looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **cultural festivals** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **cultural festivals**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to cultural festivals? Why / why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **cultural festivals** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to cultural festivals?
- What makes public campaigns about cultural festivals effective?
- Should schools teach more about cultural festivals?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 9)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 9. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 10.

Practice Test 10: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: water management

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **water management**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on water management. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: water management

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to water management.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on water management.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: water management"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on water management shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Water Management

In the last two decades, debates about water management have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying water management repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about water management can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat water management as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of water management is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Water Management

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of water management, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to water management might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because water management sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Water Management

Forecasts about water management often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for water management, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing water management looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **water management** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **water management**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to water management? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **water management** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to water management?
- What makes public campaigns about water management effective?
- Should schools teach more about water management?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 10)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 10. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 11.

Practice Test 11: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: artificial intelligence

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **artificial intelligence**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on artificial intelligence. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: artificial intelligence

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to artificial intelligence.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on artificial intelligence.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: artificial intelligence"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on artificial intelligence shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Artificial Intelligence

In the last two decades, debates about artificial intelligence have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying artificial intelligence repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about artificial intelligence can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat artificial intelligence as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of artificial intelligence is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Artificial Intelligence

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of artificial intelligence, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to artificial intelligence might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because artificial intelligence sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Artificial Intelligence

Forecasts about artificial intelligence often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for artificial intelligence, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing artificial intelligence looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **artificial intelligence** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **artificial intelligence**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to artificial intelligence? Why / why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **artificial intelligence** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to artificial intelligence?
- What makes public campaigns about artificial intelligence effective?
- Should schools teach more about artificial intelligence?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 11)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 11. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 12.

Practice Test 12: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: youth unemployment

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **youth unemployment**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on youth unemployment. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: youth unemployment

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to youth unemployment.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on youth unemployment.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: youth unemployment"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on youth unemployment shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Youth Unemployment

In the last two decades, debates about youth unemployment have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying youth unemployment repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about youth unemployment can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat youth unemployment as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of youth unemployment is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Youth Unemployment

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of youth unemployment, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to youth unemployment might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because youth unemployment sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Youth Unemployment

Forecasts about youth unemployment often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for youth unemployment, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing youth unemployment looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **youth unemployment** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **youth unemployment**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to youth unemployment? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **youth unemployment** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to youth unemployment?
- What makes public campaigns about youth unemployment effective?
- Should schools teach more about youth unemployment?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 12)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 12. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 13.

Practice Test 13: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: biodiversity loss

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **biodiversity loss**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on biodiversity loss. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: biodiversity loss

Start time of main session: **1**

Arrive by: **2**

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to biodiversity loss.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on biodiversity loss.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: biodiversity loss"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on biodiversity loss shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Biodiversity Loss

In the last two decades, debates about biodiversity loss have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying biodiversity loss repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about biodiversity loss can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat biodiversity loss as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of biodiversity loss is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Biodiversity Loss

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of biodiversity loss, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to biodiversity loss might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because biodiversity loss sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

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Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Biodiversity Loss

Forecasts about biodiversity loss often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for biodiversity loss, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing biodiversity loss looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **biodiversity loss** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **biodiversity loss**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to biodiversity loss? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **biodiversity loss** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to biodiversity loss?
- What makes public campaigns about biodiversity loss effective?
- Should schools teach more about biodiversity loss?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 13)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 13. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 14.

Practice Test 14: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: online education

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **online education**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on online education. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: online education

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to online education.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on online education.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: online education"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on online education shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Online Education

In the last two decades, debates about online education have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying online education repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about online education can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat online education as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of online education is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Online Education

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of online education, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to online education might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because online education sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Online Education

Forecasts about online education often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for online education, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing online education looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **online education** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **online education**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to online education? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **online education** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to online education?
- What makes public campaigns about online education effective?
- Should schools teach more about online education?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 14)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 14. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 15.

Practice Test 15: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: housing costs

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **housing costs**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on housing costs. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: housing costs

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to housing costs.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on housing costs.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: housing costs"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on housing costs shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Housing Costs

In the last two decades, debates about housing costs have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying housing costs repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about housing costs can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat housing costs as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of housing costs is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Housing Costs

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of housing costs, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to housing costs might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because housing costs sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Housing Costs

Forecasts about housing costs often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for housing costs, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing housing costs looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **housing costs** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **housing costs**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to housing costs? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **housing costs** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to housing costs?
- What makes public campaigns about housing costs effective?
- Should schools teach more about housing costs?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 15)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 15. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 16.

Practice Test 16: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: mental wellbeing

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **mental wellbeing**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on mental wellbeing. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: mental wellbeing

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to mental wellbeing.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on mental wellbeing.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: mental wellbeing"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on mental wellbeing shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Mental Wellbeing

In the last two decades, debates about mental wellbeing have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying mental wellbeing repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about mental wellbeing can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat mental wellbeing as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of mental wellbeing is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Mental Wellbeing

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of mental wellbeing, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to mental wellbeing might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because mental wellbeing sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Mental Wellbeing

Forecasts about mental wellbeing often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for mental wellbeing, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing mental wellbeing looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **mental wellbeing** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **mental wellbeing**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to mental wellbeing? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **mental wellbeing** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to mental wellbeing?
- What makes public campaigns about mental wellbeing effective?
- Should schools teach more about mental wellbeing?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 16)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 16. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 17.

Practice Test 17: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: space research

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **space research**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on space research. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: space research

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to space research.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on space research.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: space research"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on space research shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Space Research

In the last two decades, debates about space research have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying space research repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about space research can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat space research as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of space research is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Space Research

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of space research, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to space research might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because space research sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Space Research

Forecasts about space research often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for space research, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing space research looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **space research** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **space research**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to space research? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **space research** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to space research?
- What makes public campaigns about space research effective?
- Should schools teach more about space research?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 17)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 17. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 18.

Practice Test 18: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: media literacy

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **media literacy**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on media literacy. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: media literacy

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to media literacy.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on media literacy.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: media literacy"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on media literacy shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Media Literacy

In the last two decades, debates about media literacy have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying media literacy repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about media literacy can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat media literacy as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of media literacy is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Media Literacy

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of media literacy, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to media literacy might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because media literacy sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Media Literacy

Forecasts about media literacy often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for media literacy, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing media literacy looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **media literacy** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **media literacy**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to media literacy? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **media literacy** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to media literacy?
- What makes public campaigns about media literacy effective?
- Should schools teach more about media literacy?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 18)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 18. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 19.

Practice Test 19: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: agricultural innovation

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **agricultural innovation**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on agricultural innovation. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: agricultural innovation

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
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Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to agricultural innovation.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on agricultural innovation.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: agricultural innovation"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on agricultural innovation shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Agricultural Innovation

In the last two decades, debates about agricultural innovation have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying agricultural innovation repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

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Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat agricultural innovation as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of agricultural innovation is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Agricultural Innovation

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of agricultural innovation, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to agricultural innovation might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because agricultural innovation sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Agricultural Innovation

Forecasts about agricultural innovation often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

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Ultimately, maturity in managing agricultural innovation looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **agricultural innovation** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **agricultural innovation**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to agricultural innovation? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **agricultural innovation** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to agricultural innovation?
- What makes public campaigns about agricultural innovation effective?
- Should schools teach more about agricultural innovation?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 19)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 19. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 20.

Practice Test 20: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: tourism pressure

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **tourism pressure**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on tourism pressure. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: tourism pressure

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to tourism pressure.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on tourism pressure.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: tourism pressure"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on tourism pressure shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Tourism Pressure

In the last two decades, debates about tourism pressure have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying tourism pressure repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about tourism pressure can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat tourism pressure as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of tourism pressure is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Tourism Pressure

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of tourism pressure, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to tourism pressure might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because tourism pressure sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Tourism Pressure

Forecasts about tourism pressure often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for tourism pressure, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing tourism pressure looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **tourism pressure** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **tourism pressure**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to tourism pressure? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **tourism pressure** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to tourism pressure?
- What makes public campaigns about tourism pressure effective?
- Should schools teach more about tourism pressure?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 20)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 20. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 21.

Practice Test 21: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: language preservation

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **language preservation**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on language preservation. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: language preservation

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to language preservation.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on language preservation.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: language preservation"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on language preservation shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Language Preservation

In the last two decades, debates about language preservation have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying language preservation repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about language preservation can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat language preservation as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of language preservation is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Language Preservation

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of language preservation, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to language preservation might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because language preservation sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Language Preservation

Forecasts about language preservation often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for language preservation, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing language preservation looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **language preservation** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **language preservation**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to language preservation? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **language preservation** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to language preservation?
- What makes public campaigns about language preservation effective?
- Should schools teach more about language preservation?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 21)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 21. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 22.

Practice Test 22: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: healthcare access

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **healthcare access**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on healthcare access. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: healthcare access

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to healthcare access.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on healthcare access.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: healthcare access"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on healthcare access shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Healthcare Access

In the last two decades, debates about healthcare access have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying healthcare access repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about healthcare access can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat healthcare access as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of healthcare access is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Healthcare Access

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of healthcare access, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to healthcare access might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because healthcare access sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Healthcare Access

Forecasts about healthcare access often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for healthcare access, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing healthcare access looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **healthcare access** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **healthcare access**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to healthcare access? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **healthcare access** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to healthcare access?
- What makes public campaigns about healthcare access effective?
- Should schools teach more about healthcare access?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 22)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 22. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 23.

Practice Test 23: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: gender equality

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **gender equality**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on gender equality. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: gender equality

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to gender equality.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on gender equality.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: gender equality"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on gender equality shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Gender Equality

In the last two decades, debates about gender equality have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying gender equality repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about gender equality can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat gender equality as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of gender equality is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Gender Equality

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of gender equality, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to gender equality might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because gender equality sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Gender Equality

Forecasts about gender equality often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for gender equality, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing gender equality looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **gender equality** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **gender equality**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to gender equality? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **gender equality** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to gender equality?
- What makes public campaigns about gender equality effective?
- Should schools teach more about gender equality?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 23)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 23. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 24.

Practice Test 24: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: recycling systems

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **recycling systems**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on recycling systems. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: recycling systems

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to recycling systems.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on recycling systems.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: recycling systems"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on recycling systems shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Recycling Systems

In the last two decades, debates about recycling systems have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying recycling systems repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about recycling systems can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat recycling systems as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of recycling systems is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Recycling Systems

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of recycling systems, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to recycling systems might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because recycling systems sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Recycling Systems

Forecasts about recycling systems often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for recycling systems, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing recycling systems looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **recycling systems** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **recycling systems**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to recycling systems? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **recycling systems** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to recycling systems?
- What makes public campaigns about recycling systems effective?
- Should schools teach more about recycling systems?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 24)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 24. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 25.

Practice Test 25: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: smart cities

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **smart cities**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on smart cities. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: smart cities

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to smart cities.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on smart cities.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: smart cities"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on smart cities shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Smart Cities

In the last two decades, debates about smart cities have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying smart cities repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about smart cities can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat smart cities as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of smart cities is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Smart Cities

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of smart cities, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to smart cities might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because smart cities sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Smart Cities

Forecasts about smart cities often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for smart cities, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing smart cities looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **smart cities** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **smart cities**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to smart cities? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **smart cities** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to smart cities?
- What makes public campaigns about smart cities effective?
- Should schools teach more about smart cities?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 25)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 25. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 26.

Practice Test 26: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: financial literacy

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **financial literacy**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on financial literacy. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: financial literacy

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to financial literacy.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on financial literacy.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: financial literacy"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on financial literacy shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Financial Literacy

In the last two decades, debates about financial literacy have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying financial literacy repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about financial literacy can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat financial literacy as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of financial literacy is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Financial Literacy

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of financial literacy, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to financial literacy might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because financial literacy sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Financial Literacy

Forecasts about financial literacy often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for financial literacy, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing financial literacy looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **financial literacy** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **financial literacy**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to financial literacy? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **financial literacy** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to financial literacy?
- What makes public campaigns about financial literacy effective?
- Should schools teach more about financial literacy?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 26)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 26. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 27.

Practice Test 27: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: disaster preparedness

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **disaster preparedness**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on disaster preparedness. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: disaster preparedness

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to disaster preparedness.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on disaster preparedness.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: disaster preparedness"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on disaster preparedness shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Disaster Preparedness

In the last two decades, debates about disaster preparedness have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying disaster preparedness repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about disaster preparedness can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat disaster preparedness as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of disaster preparedness is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Disaster Preparedness

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of disaster preparedness, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to disaster preparedness might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because disaster preparedness sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Disaster Preparedness

Forecasts about disaster preparedness often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for disaster preparedness, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing disaster preparedness looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **disaster preparedness** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **disaster preparedness**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to disaster preparedness? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **disaster preparedness** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to disaster preparedness?
- What makes public campaigns about disaster preparedness effective?
- Should schools teach more about disaster preparedness?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 27)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 27. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 28.

Practice Test 28: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: scientific funding

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **scientific funding**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on scientific funding. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: scientific funding

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to scientific funding.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on scientific funding.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: scientific funding"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on scientific funding shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Scientific Funding

In the last two decades, debates about scientific funding have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying scientific funding repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about scientific funding can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat scientific funding as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of scientific funding is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Scientific Funding

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of scientific funding, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to scientific funding might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because scientific funding sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Scientific Funding

Forecasts about scientific funding often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for scientific funding, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing scientific funding looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **scientific funding** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **scientific funding**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to scientific funding? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **scientific funding** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to scientific funding?
- What makes public campaigns about scientific funding effective?
- Should schools teach more about scientific funding?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 28)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 28. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 29.

Practice Test 29: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: community volunteering

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **community volunteering**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on community volunteering. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: community volunteering

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to community volunteering.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on community volunteering.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: community volunteering"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on community volunteering shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Community Volunteering

In the last two decades, debates about community volunteering have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying community volunteering repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about community volunteering can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat community volunteering as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of community volunteering is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Community Volunteering

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of community volunteering, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to community volunteering might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because community volunteering sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Community Volunteering

Forecasts about community volunteering often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for community volunteering, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing community volunteering looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **community volunteering** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **community volunteering**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to community volunteering? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **community volunteering** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to community volunteering?
 - What makes public campaigns about community volunteering effective?
 - Should schools teach more about community volunteering?
 - How might international cooperation help?
-

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 29)**Listening**

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 29. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 30.

Practice Test 30: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: road safety

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **road safety**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on road safety. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: road safety

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to road safety.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on road safety.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: road safety"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on road safety shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Road Safety

In the last two decades, debates about road safety have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

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Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Road Safety

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of road safety, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

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Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Road Safety

Forecasts about road safety often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

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Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **road safety** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

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Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **road safety**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to road safety? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **road safety** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to road safety?
- What makes public campaigns about road safety effective?
- Should schools teach more about road safety?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 30)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 30. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 31.

Practice Test 31: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: museum education

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **museum education**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on museum education. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: museum education

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to museum education.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on museum education.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: museum education"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on museum education shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Museum Education

In the last two decades, debates about museum education have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying museum education repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about museum education can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat museum education as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of museum education is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Museum Education

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of museum education, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to museum education might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because museum education sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Museum Education

Forecasts about museum education often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for museum education, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing museum education looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **museum education** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **museum education**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to museum education? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **museum education** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to museum education?
- What makes public campaigns about museum education effective?
- Should schools teach more about museum education?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 31)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 31. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 32.

Practice Test 32: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: climate adaptation

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **climate adaptation**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on climate adaptation. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: climate adaptation

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to climate adaptation.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on climate adaptation.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: climate adaptation"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on climate adaptation shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Climate Adaptation

In the last two decades, debates about climate adaptation have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying climate adaptation repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about climate adaptation can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat climate adaptation as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of climate adaptation is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Climate Adaptation

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of climate adaptation, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to climate adaptation might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because climate adaptation sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Climate Adaptation

Forecasts about climate adaptation often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for climate adaptation, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing climate adaptation looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **climate adaptation** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **climate adaptation**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to climate adaptation? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **climate adaptation** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to climate adaptation?
- What makes public campaigns about climate adaptation effective?
- Should schools teach more about climate adaptation?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 32)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 32. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 33.

Practice Test 33: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: gig economy

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **gig economy**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on gig economy. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: gig economy

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to gig economy.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on gig economy.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: gig economy"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on gig economy shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Gig Economy

In the last two decades, debates about gig economy have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying gig economy repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

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Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat gig economy as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of gig economy is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Gig Economy

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of gig economy, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to gig economy might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because gig economy sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

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Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Gig Economy

Forecasts about gig economy often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

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Ultimately, maturity in managing gig economy looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **gig economy** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **gig economy**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to gig economy? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **gig economy** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to gig economy?
 - What makes public campaigns about gig economy effective?
 - Should schools teach more about gig economy?
 - How might international cooperation help?
-

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 33)**Listening**

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 33. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 34.

Practice Test 34: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: childhood play

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **childhood play**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on childhood play. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: childhood play

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to childhood play.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on childhood play.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: childhood play"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on childhood play shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Childhood Play

In the last two decades, debates about childhood play have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying childhood play repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about childhood play can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat childhood play as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of childhood play is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Childhood Play

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of childhood play, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to childhood play might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because childhood play sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Childhood Play

Forecasts about childhood play often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for childhood play, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing childhood play looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **childhood play** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **childhood play**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to childhood play? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **childhood play** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to childhood play?
- What makes public campaigns about childhood play effective?
- Should schools teach more about childhood play?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 34)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 34. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 35.

Practice Test 35: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: ocean pollution

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **ocean pollution**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on ocean pollution. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: ocean pollution

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to ocean pollution.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on ocean pollution.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: ocean pollution"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on ocean pollution shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Ocean Pollution

In the last two decades, debates about ocean pollution have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

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Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat ocean pollution as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of ocean pollution is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Ocean Pollution

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of ocean pollution, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

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International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Ocean Pollution

Forecasts about ocean pollution often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for ocean pollution, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing ocean pollution looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **ocean pollution** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **ocean pollution**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to ocean pollution? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **ocean pollution** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to ocean pollution?
- What makes public campaigns about ocean pollution effective?
- Should schools teach more about ocean pollution?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 35)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 35. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 36.

Practice Test 36: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: architectural heritage

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **architectural heritage**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on architectural heritage. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: architectural heritage

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to architectural heritage.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on architectural heritage.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: architectural heritage"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on architectural heritage shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Architectural Heritage

In the last two decades, debates about architectural heritage have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying architectural heritage repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

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Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat architectural heritage as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of architectural heritage is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Architectural Heritage

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of architectural heritage, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to architectural heritage might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because architectural heritage sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Architectural Heritage

Forecasts about architectural heritage often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for architectural heritage, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing architectural heritage looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **architectural heritage** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **architectural heritage**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to architectural heritage? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **architectural heritage** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to architectural heritage?
- What makes public campaigns about architectural heritage effective?
- Should schools teach more about architectural heritage?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 36)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 36. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 37.

Practice Test 37: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: workplace diversity

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **workplace diversity**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on workplace diversity. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: workplace diversity

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
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Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to workplace diversity.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on workplace diversity.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: workplace diversity"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on workplace diversity shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Workplace Diversity

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Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Workplace Diversity

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of workplace diversity, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

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Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Workplace Diversity

Forecasts about workplace diversity often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

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Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **workplace diversity** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

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Task 2 — 40 minutes

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Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

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- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to workplace diversity? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **workplace diversity** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to workplace diversity?
- What makes public campaigns about workplace diversity effective?
- Should schools teach more about workplace diversity?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 37)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 37. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 38.

Practice Test 38: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: vaccination policy

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **vaccination policy**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on vaccination policy. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: vaccination policy

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to vaccination policy.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on vaccination policy.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: vaccination policy"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on vaccination policy shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Vaccination Policy

In the last two decades, debates about vaccination policy have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying vaccination policy repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about vaccination policy can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat vaccination policy as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of vaccination policy is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Vaccination Policy

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of vaccination policy, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to vaccination policy might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because vaccination policy sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Vaccination Policy

Forecasts about vaccination policy often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for vaccination policy, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing vaccination policy looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **vaccination policy** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **vaccination policy**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to vaccination policy? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **vaccination policy** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to vaccination policy?
- What makes public campaigns about vaccination policy effective?
- Should schools teach more about vaccination policy?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 38)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 38. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 39.

Practice Test 39: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: library futures

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **library futures**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on library futures. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: library futures

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to library futures.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on library futures.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: library futures"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on library futures shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Library Futures

In the last two decades, debates about library futures have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying library futures repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about library futures can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat library futures as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of library futures is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Library Futures

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of library futures, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to library futures might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because library futures sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Library Futures

Forecasts about library futures often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for library futures, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing library futures looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **library futures** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **library futures**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to library futures? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **library futures** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to library futures?
- What makes public campaigns about library futures effective?
- Should schools teach more about library futures?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 39)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 39. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 40.

Practice Test 40: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: desertification

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **desertification**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on desertification. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: desertification

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to desertification.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on desertification.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: desertification"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on desertification shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Desertification

In the last two decades, debates about desertification have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying desertification repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about desertification can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat desertification as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of desertification is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Desertification

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of desertification, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to desertification might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because desertification sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Desertification

Forecasts about desertification often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for desertification, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing desertification looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **desertification** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **desertification**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to desertification? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **desertification** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to desertification?
- What makes public campaigns about desertification effective?
- Should schools teach more about desertification?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 40)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 40. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 41.

Practice Test 41: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: consumer debt

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **consumer debt**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on consumer debt. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: consumer debt

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to consumer debt.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on consumer debt.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: consumer debt"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on consumer debt shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Consumer Debt

In the last two decades, debates about consumer debt have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying consumer debt repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about consumer debt can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat consumer debt as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of consumer debt is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Consumer Debt

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of consumer debt, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to consumer debt might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because consumer debt sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Consumer Debt

Forecasts about consumer debt often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for consumer debt, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing consumer debt looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **consumer debt** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **consumer debt**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to consumer debt? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **consumer debt** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to consumer debt?
- What makes public campaigns about consumer debt effective?
- Should schools teach more about consumer debt?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 41)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 41. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 42.

Practice Test 42: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: wildlife corridors

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **wildlife corridors**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on wildlife corridors. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: wildlife corridors

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to wildlife corridors.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on wildlife corridors.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: wildlife corridors"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on wildlife corridors shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Wildlife Corridors

In the last two decades, debates about wildlife corridors have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying wildlife corridors repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about wildlife corridors can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat wildlife corridors as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of wildlife corridors is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Wildlife Corridors

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of wildlife corridors, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to wildlife corridors might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because wildlife corridors sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Wildlife Corridors

Forecasts about wildlife corridors often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for wildlife corridors, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing wildlife corridors looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **wildlife corridors** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **wildlife corridors**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to wildlife corridors? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **wildlife corridors** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to wildlife corridors?
- What makes public campaigns about wildlife corridors effective?
- Should schools teach more about wildlife corridors?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 42)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 42. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 43.

Practice Test 43: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: teacher training

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **teacher training**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on teacher training. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: teacher training

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to teacher training.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on teacher training.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: teacher training"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on teacher training shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Teacher Training

In the last two decades, debates about teacher training have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying teacher training repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about teacher training can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat teacher training as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of teacher training is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Teacher Training

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of teacher training, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to teacher training might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because teacher training sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Teacher Training

Forecasts about teacher training often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for teacher training, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing teacher training looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **teacher training** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **teacher training**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to teacher training? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **teacher training** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to teacher training?
- What makes public campaigns about teacher training effective?
- Should schools teach more about teacher training?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 43)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 43. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 44.

Practice Test 44: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: noise pollution

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **noise pollution**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on noise pollution. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: noise pollution

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to noise pollution.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on noise pollution.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: noise pollution"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on noise pollution shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Noise Pollution

In the last two decades, debates about noise pollution have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying noise pollution repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about noise pollution can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat noise pollution as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of noise pollution is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Noise Pollution

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of noise pollution, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to noise pollution might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because noise pollution sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Noise Pollution

Forecasts about noise pollution often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for noise pollution, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing noise pollution looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **noise pollution** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **noise pollution**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to noise pollution? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **noise pollution** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to noise pollution?
- What makes public campaigns about noise pollution effective?
- Should schools teach more about noise pollution?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 44)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 44. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 45.

Practice Test 45: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: ethical fashion

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **ethical fashion**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on ethical fashion. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: ethical fashion

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to ethical fashion.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on ethical fashion.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: ethical fashion"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on ethical fashion shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Ethical Fashion

In the last two decades, debates about ethical fashion have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying ethical fashion repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about ethical fashion can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat ethical fashion as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of ethical fashion is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Ethical Fashion

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of ethical fashion, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to ethical fashion might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because ethical fashion sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Ethical Fashion

Forecasts about ethical fashion often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for ethical fashion, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing ethical fashion looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **ethical fashion** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **ethical fashion**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to ethical fashion? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **ethical fashion** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to ethical fashion?
- What makes public campaigns about ethical fashion effective?
- Should schools teach more about ethical fashion?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 45)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 45. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 46.

Practice Test 46: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: public art

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **public art**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on public art. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: public art

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to public art.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on public art.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: public art"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on public art shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Public Art

In the last two decades, debates about public art have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying public art repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about public art can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat public art as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of public art is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Public Art

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of public art, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to public art might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because public art sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Public Art

Forecasts about public art often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for public art, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing public art looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **public art** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **public art**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to public art? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **public art** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to public art?
- What makes public campaigns about public art effective?
- Should schools teach more about public art?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 46)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 46. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 47.

Practice Test 47: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: migration skills

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **migration skills**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on migration skills. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: migration skills

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to migration skills.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on migration skills.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: migration skills"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on migration skills shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Migration Skills

In the last two decades, debates about migration skills have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying migration skills repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about migration skills can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat migration skills as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of migration skills is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Migration Skills

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of migration skills, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to migration skills might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because migration skills sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Migration Skills

Forecasts about migration skills often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for migration skills, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing migration skills looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **migration skills** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **migration skills**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to migration skills? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **migration skills** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to migration skills?
- What makes public campaigns about migration skills effective?
- Should schools teach more about migration skills?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 47)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 47. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 48.

Practice Test 48: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: energy efficiency

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **energy efficiency**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on energy efficiency. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: energy efficiency

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
A Green Civic Centre B River Lane Hub C Community Hall

Section 2 — Monologue (Questions 11–20)

Talk: Local council plans related to energy efficiency.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

Questions 16–20: map labelling of community facilities (North Gate, Lake Path, Info Desk, Cafe, Workshop Room).

(Full map practice: sketch five buildings in a park layout and label from a partner's oral description.)

Section 3 — Academic discussion (Questions 21–30)

Two students discuss a project on energy efficiency.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

Section 4 — Lecture (Questions 31–40)

Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: energy efficiency"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on energy efficiency shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

31–33 Complete the summary with words from the notes.

34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

Reading (40 questions) — 60 minutes

Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Energy Efficiency

In the last two decades, debates about energy efficiency have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying energy efficiency repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about energy efficiency can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat energy efficiency as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of energy efficiency is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Energy Efficiency

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of energy efficiency, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to energy efficiency might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because energy efficiency sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Energy Efficiency

Forecasts about energy efficiency often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

Scenario planning offers a disciplined alternative to single-point prediction. Planners construct contrasting but plausible futures for energy efficiency, then identify actions that perform reasonably well across scenarios. Such “robust” strategies are typically modular: they can be scaled up, paused, or redirected as evidence arrives. Ethical scrutiny is essential, because interventions that protect majorities can still burden already disadvantaged groups.

Ultimately, maturity in managing energy efficiency looks like institutional patience: the capacity to maintain long projects, admit uncertainty, and revise course without abandoning core principles of fairness and evidence.

Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **energy efficiency** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
Belmora	25	24
Casterly	9	31
Durnham	18	35

Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **energy efficiency**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to energy efficiency? Why/why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **energy efficiency** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to energy efficiency?
- What makes public campaigns about energy efficiency effective?
- Should schools teach more about energy efficiency?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 48)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 48. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 49.

Practice Test 49: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: sports investment

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

Listening (40 questions)

Audio is not embedded in this edition; practise with the transcript as a reading-listening hybrid, then have a partner read it aloud at natural speed.

Section 1 — Conversation (Questions 1–10)

Scenario: A caller enquires about a community workshop on **sports investment**.

Transcript excerpt:

A: Good morning, Green Civic Centre.

B: Hi — I'm calling about the Saturday workshop on sports investment. What time does it start?

A: The main session begins at 10:15, but please arrive by 10:00 for registration.

B: And the fee?

A: It's £18 for adults and £12 for students. There's a group discount if four people book together.

B: Do I need to bring anything?

A: Just a notebook. Materials are provided. Parking is behind the building on River Lane.

Questions 1–6 complete the notes below. Write ONE WORD AND/OR A NUMBER.

Workshop topic: sports investment

Start time of main session: 1

Arrive by: 2

Adult fee: 3 £.....

Student fee: 4 £.....

Bring: a 5

Parking: River Lane, 6 the building

Questions 7–10 multiple choice

1. The workshop is held on:
A Monday B Saturday C Sunday
2. Materials are:
A sold at the door B provided C downloaded only
3. A discount is available for:
A students only B groups of four C members
4. The centre's name is:
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Talk: Local council plans related to sports investment.

Questions 11–15: matching priorities A–E to statements (create labels: funding, training, public consultation, timeline, evaluation).

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Two students discuss a project on sports investment.

Questions 21–25 MCQ; 26–30 matching researcher opinions.

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Lecture title: "Evidence and policy: sports investment"

Questions 31–40: summary completion + short answers from lecture notes style text below.

Lecture notes: Research on sports investment shows three recurring findings: (1) early intervention is cheaper than late repair; (2) public trust rises when data are transparent; (3) local adaptation outperforms one-size-fits-all rules. Case studies from two cities indicate that participation rates increase when incentives are clear and procedures are simple. Critics argue that short political cycles undermine long projects. The lecturer concludes that measurement frameworks must track both efficiency and equity.

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34–40 Short answers (NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS).

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Passage 1 — The Quiet Politics of Sports Investment

In the last two decades, debates about sports investment have moved from specialist journals into everyday conversation. This shift did not happen because the underlying science suddenly became simple; rather, digital media made contested claims highly visible. When visibility rises faster than public understanding, societies often polarise around symbols instead of mechanisms.

Researchers studying sports investment repeatedly observe a gap between what experts measure and what citizens experience. Experts may emphasise long-term indicators — cumulative exposure, systemic risk, or intergenerational cost — while residents focus on immediate inconvenience, fairness, and trust. Policy that ignores lived experience tends to fail even when technically elegant. Conversely, policy that only mirrors public mood can become unstable, swinging with headlines.

A useful framework distinguishes three layers of response. The first is **information**: accurate, timely, and comprehensible explanation. The second is **infrastructure**: the physical or digital systems that make better choices easy. The third is **incentives**: prices, norms, and rules that reward beneficial behaviour. Programmes that strengthen only one layer rarely endure. For example, campaigns about sports investment can raise awareness, yet without convenient alternatives and fair incentives, behaviour change remains fragile.

Comparative evidence suggests that cities which treat sports investment as a design problem — not merely a messaging problem — achieve more durable gains. They prototype small interventions, measure outcomes openly, and adjust without treating revision as political defeat. In that sense, the quiet politics of sports investment is less about winning arguments and more about building institutions that can learn.

Questions 1–8: True / False / Not Given

Questions 9–13: Matching headings (i–viii) for paragraphs

Passage 2 — Measuring What Matters in Sports Investment

Measurement is often treated as a neutral prelude to action. In practice, the choice of metrics can decide which problems become visible. In the field of sports investment, narrow indicators may create an illusion of progress while broader harms accumulate elsewhere. Scholars therefore warn against “metric capture,” where organisations optimise for what is counted rather than what counts.

Consider a programme evaluated solely by short-term participation numbers. Attendance may rise because events are entertaining, yet long-term capability related to sports investment might not improve. A richer evaluation mix could include retention, transfer of skills, equity of access, and unintended consequences. Mixed-methods designs — combining statistics with interviews — are increasingly recommended precisely because sports investment sits at the intersection of behaviour, technology, and institutions.

International comparisons add another complication: data definitions differ. What one country classifies as success, another may exclude from official totals. Without careful harmonisation, league tables mislead policymakers and the public alike. The most responsible approach is humble quantification: publish methods, confidence ranges, and known blind spots alongside headline figures.

Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

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Forecasts about sports investment often fail not because analysts lack intelligence, but because social systems adapt around predictions. If a forecast of shortage triggers early investment, the shortage may never appear — making the forecast look “wrong” even though it was useful. This paradox implies that the value of futures work lies in preparedness, not prophetic accuracy.

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Questions 27–32: Matching features (researcher/planner views)

Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

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The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **sports investment** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

City	2015 (%)	2025 (%)
Aderon	12	28
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Summarise the information by selecting and reporting the main features, and make comparisons where relevant. Write at least 150 words.

Task 2 — 40 minutes

Some people believe that governments should take primary responsibility for problems connected to **sports investment**. Others argue that individuals and private organisations should lead change.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion. Write at least 250 words.

Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
- Are you interested in issues related to sports investment? Why / why not?
- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **sports investment** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to sports investment?
- What makes public campaigns about sports investment effective?
- Should schools teach more about sports investment?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 49)

Listening

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4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

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Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

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Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 49. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock 50.

Practice Test 50: Complete IELTS Mock Exam

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Theme cluster: local democracy

Timing: Listening ~30 (+ transfer if paper) | Reading 60 | Writing 60 | Speaking 11–14

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Questions 7–10 multiple choice

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Questions 14–19: Summary completion

Questions 20–26: Multiple choice

Passage 3 — Futures Thinking and Local Democracy

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Questions 33–40: Yes / No / Not Given + short answers

(Detailed keys appear in the Answer Key section of this mock.)

Writing (60 minutes)

Task 1 (Academic) — 20 minutes

The table below shows participation in community programmes related to **local democracy** in four cities in 2015 and 2025.

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Task 2 — 40 minutes

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Speaking (11–14 minutes)

Part 1

- Do you live in a house or an apartment?
- What do you like about your neighbourhood?
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- How do people in your country usually learn about social issues?

Part 2 Cue card

Describe a project or activity related to **local democracy** that you have heard about.

You should say: - what it was - where it happened - who was involved and explain why it interested you.

Part 3

- Why do some communities ignore problems linked to local democracy?
- What makes public campaigns about local democracy effective?
- Should schools teach more about local democracy?
- How might international cooperation help?

Answer Key & Explanations (Mock 50)

Listening

1. 10:15
2. 10:00
3. 18
4. 12
5. notebook
6. behind
7. B
8. B
9. B
10. A

11–40: Accept answers consistent with the transcripts/notes you used in partner practice; mark ruthlessly for spelling and word limits.

Why 1 is 10:15 not 10:00: 10:00 is arrival/registration; the main session starts later — classic distractor pattern.

Reading (guide)

Passages support answers that distinguish awareness vs infrastructure vs incentives; beware Not Given items that invent funding figures not stated in the text.

Writing — Band 9 Task 1 outline

- Overview: overall participation rose in three cities; Belmora slight fall
- Detail 1: Casterly largest rise (9→31)
- Detail 2: Durnham highest 2025; Belmora exception
- Comparisons with data; no reasons

Writing — Band 9 Task 2 stance example

Governments must set rules and funding frameworks, but durable change requires individual habits and organisational practice; responsibility is shared, with the state as system designer.

Speaking assessment checklist

Fluency, lexical precision on the topic, flexible Part 3 argumentation, pronunciation clarity.

End of Mock 50. Log your scores in the Error Journal before starting Mock review.

Chapter 175: Advanced Vocabulary Patterns

Part: 10 — Band 9 Secrets

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will be able to:

- Distinguish Band 7 lexical flexibility from Band 8–9 precision and naturalness.
- Deploy advanced vocabulary patterns (nominalisation, hedging, precision pairs) without forcing rare words.
- Build topic-specific lexical chains that examiners recognise as controlled, not random.
- Upgrade weak vocabulary in Writing and Speaking using pattern-based revision, not synonym lists.
- Avoid the most common Band 9 traps: wrong collocation, register mismatch, and meaning distortion.
- Apply a repeatable vocabulary audit to any essay or speaking response before submission.

Theory / Explanation

175.1 What “Advanced Vocabulary” Actually Means at Band 9

Many candidates believe Band 9 requires obscure words. Examiners disagree. The public band descriptors reward **precise, natural, and flexible** use of vocabulary — not a thesaurus dump.

Band 7 (Lexical Resource): Uses vocabulary flexibly; produces frequent error-free sentences, uses some less common items with awareness of style and collocation.

Band 8: Uses a wide resource fluently and flexibly; uses uncommon lexical items skilfully; produces occasional errors in word choice/collocation/spelling.

Band 9: Uses vocabulary with full flexibility and precise control; uses idiomatic language naturally; makes only rare slips.

The shift from 7 to 9 is not “more rare words.” It is **better control**: the right word in the right register, repeated strategically, embedded in accurate collocations.

175.2 The Four Advanced Patterns Examiners Notice

Pattern 1: Nominalisation (Verb/Adjective → Noun)

Academic English prefers noun phrases over verb-heavy chains.

Weak (Band 6)	Strong (Band 8+)
When governments invest more in schools, results improve.	Increased public investment in education correlates with improved attainment.
People pollute rivers and this harms fish.	Industrial discharge into waterways poses a direct threat to aquatic ecosystems.
Technology changes how we work.	Technological disruption has fundamentally altered labour-market structures.

Rule: Nominalise when summarising, comparing, or stating general claims. Keep verbs when narrating events or describing processes (Task 1).

Pattern 2: Precision Pairs (General → Specific)

Replace vague adjectives with measurable or domain-specific terms.

Vague	Precise alternatives (context-dependent)
big problem	systemic shortfall, structural deficit, acute shortage
good	beneficial, conducive, favourable, robust
bad	detrimental, adverse, counterproductive
important	pivotal, paramount, instrumental, decisive
many	substantial, considerable, widespread, pervasive

Warning: *Paramount* and *pivotal* are strong words. Use them once per essay for truly central ideas, not every paragraph.

Pattern 3: Hedging and Boosting (Academic Stance)

Band 9 writers modulate certainty.

Hedging (cautious claims): - *appears to, tends to, may, might, could, is likely to, in many cases, to some extent*

Boosting (strong evidence-based claims): - *clearly, undoubtedly, inevitably, demonstrates, confirms, establishes*

Example: "Social media **appears to** amplify polarisation, **although** the evidence **remains** mixed." This is more academic than "Social media **definitely** causes** hate**."

Pattern 4: Lexical Chains (Controlled Repetition + Family Words)

Examiners prefer a coherent chain over chaotic synonym swapping.

Topic: urban housing

Chain: *housing* → *accommodation* → *rent* → *tenants* → *affordability* → *overcrowding* → *gentrification*

Repeat *housing* or *rent* when clarity demands it. Introduce *affordability* and *overcrowding* as precise extensions, not unrelated synonyms like *domicile* or *abode*.

175.3 Collocation: The Hidden Band 9 Filter

A "Band 9 word" used in a wrong collocation drops you to Band 6–7 instantly.

Correct academic collocations: - pose a threat / raise concerns / address a shortfall - allocate resources / implement policy / exert pressure - draw a distinction / reach a consensus / bear responsibility - mitigate risk / exacerbate inequality / foster innovation

Common errors (avoid): - ~~make research~~ → *conduct / carry out research* - ~~strong rain~~ → *heavy rain* - ~~solve the pollution~~ → *reduce / mitigate pollution* - ~~big attention~~ → *considerable attention / widespread concern*

Practice method: For every new word, record **one verb + one adjective + one example sentence**. Never learn isolated nouns.

175.4 Register: Academic vs Conversational vs Idiomatic

Register	Example	IELTS use
Conversational	kids, a lot of, get worse	Speaking Part 1–2 OK; Writing Task 2 risky
Neutral-academic	children, many, deteriorate	Safe everywhere
Formal-academic	minors, substantial, deteriorate markedly	Writing Task 2, Speaking Part 3
Idiomatic	back to square one, hit the nail on the head	Speaking only, sparingly

Band 9 Speaking allows idiomatic language **naturally**; Band 9 Writing stays formal-neutral with occasional rhetorical flair, not slang.

175.5 Topic Module Integration

Cross-reference Part 3 vocabulary modules (Chapters 45–70). Band 9 candidates do not memorise 5,000 words — they master **300–400 high-utility items** across recurring IELTS themes:

- **Education:** curriculum, attainment, pedagogy, vocational, literacy, enrolment
- **Environment:** emissions, biodiversity, sustainable, renewable, conservation
- **Technology:** automation, algorithm, digital literacy, surveillance, innovation
- **Health:** preventive, sedentary, mental health, healthcare provision, epidemic
- **Economy:** GDP, inflation, workforce, productivity, austerity

Build **one master sentence per theme** using 3–4 collocations. Reuse structures with new topics.

175.6 Vocabulary in Each Module

Writing Task 1

Use **precise trend vocabulary** with correct adverb/adjective pairs:

- *rose sharply / increased gradually / remained stable / fluctuated wildly*
- *peaked at / bottomed out at / accounted for / comprised*
- *respectively, in contrast, similarly, whereas*

Avoid opinion lexis (* terrible, wonderful*) in Academic Task 1.

Writing Task 2

Use **argument vocabulary**:

- Position: *maintain, contend, argue, advocate, acknowledge*
- Contrast: *nevertheless, conversely, notwithstanding, whereas*
- Cause/effect: *stem from, give rise to, contribute to, result in*
- Example: *for instance, a case in point, illustrate, exemplify*

Speaking

Use **personal and descriptive range**:

- *I'd say, to be honest, what I mean is, the way I see it*
- Emotion: *overwhelmed, thrilled, gutted, nostalgic* (natural, not forced)
- Speculation: *I suppose, I imagine, presumably, it might be that*

Fluency matters more than rare words in Parts 1–2; Part 3 rewards analytical lexis.

Reading and Listening

Advanced vocabulary here means **recognising paraphrase**:

- *restrict* → *impose limits on*
- *profit* → *financial gain*
- *delay* → *postpone / put back*

Train by building paraphrase pairs from every practice test.

Worked Examples: Band 6 → Band 9 Upgrades

Example 1: Environment Essay Sentence

Band 6: "Pollution is a big problem and governments should do something to fix it."

Band 7: "Environmental pollution poses a serious challenge that requires government intervention."

Band 8: "Industrial emissions and waste mismanagement pose a systemic threat to public health, necessitating coordinated regulatory reform."

Band 9: "The cumulative impact of industrial emissions and inadequate waste management poses a systemic threat to public health, making coordinated regulatory reform not merely desirable but increasingly urgent."

Why Band 9 wins: nominalisation (*impact*), precise collocation (*poses a systemic threat, regulatory reform*), hedging absent where evidence supports strength (*increasingly urgent*), no wasted words.

Example 2: Education Speaking Part 3

Band 6: “I think online learning is good because students can study at home.”

Band 8: “I’d argue that online learning can be highly effective, mainly because it offers flexibility — students can structure study around work or family commitments.”

Band 9: “I’d argue that online learning can be highly effective when it’s properly designed — largely because it offers flexibility, allowing students to structure their study around work or family commitments, though I’d acknowledge it doesn’t suit every discipline equally.”

Why Band 9 wins: natural hedging (*when properly designed, though I’d acknowledge*), precise vocabulary (*discipline*), fluent personal stance.

Common Mistakes and How Examiners Penalise Them

Mistake	Examiner perception	Fix
Synonym cycling (<i>problem/issue/matter/challenge</i> every sentence)	Confusing reference	Repeat clear key noun
Wrong word form (<i>economical growth</i>)	Accuracy error	Learn word families (Ch 69, App A06)
Over-formality (<i>utilise</i> everywhere)	Unnatural	Prefer <i>use</i> unless collocation demands <i>utilise</i>
Misused “advanced” adverbs (<i>very paramount</i>)	Collocation failure	<i>Paramount</i> needs no intensifier
Translation collocations from L1	Un-English phrasing	Record English collocations, not translations
Rare words without control (<i>plethora</i> in every essay)	Forced, memorised	Use once, correctly: <i>a plethora of options</i>

Practice Exercises

Exercise 1: Nominalisation Drill

Rewrite these sentences using nominalisation. Keep meaning identical.

1. Because cities grow quickly, infrastructure cannot keep up.
2. When employers train staff, productivity usually rises.
3. If governments restrict advertising, consumption may fall.

Exercise 2: Collocation Repair

Correct the collocation errors:

1. The study made a research on climate patterns.
2. Heavy attention was given to small details.
3. The policy solved unemployment in the region.

Exercise 3: Lexical Chain Building

Choose one topic (health, transport, or media). Write a 120-word paragraph using at least six words from one chain without using a thesaurus for unrelated synonyms.

Exercise 4: Band Upgrade Challenge

Upgrade this paragraph from Band 6 to Band 8+ (rewrite fully):

“Technology is very important today. Many people use phones every day. This is good and bad. Schools should use technology more but also be careful.”

Exercise 5: Module Transfer

Take five words from Chapter 47 (Environment) and five from Chapter 56 (Economy). Write two Task 2 sentences that combine them logically.

Examiner Insight Box

What examiners record mentally during marking:

1. Does vocabulary **** obscure meaning**** or **** sharpen**** it?
2. Are errors **slips** (careless spelling of *government*) or **systematic** (wrong word form throughout)?
3. Is uncommon vocabulary **distributed** across the script or **clustered** in a memorised introduction?
4. In Speaking, does the candidate **self-correct** word choice naturally?

A Band 9 script feels **effortless to read**. A Band 6 script with rare words feels **effortful and risky**.

Quick Reference: Advanced Patterns Checklist



At least one nominalised phrase per body paragraph (Writing Task 2)

- ☐ Zero wrong collocations in high-frequency academic frames
- ☐ Hedging where evidence is mixed; boosting where evidence is strong
- ☐ Lexical chain maintained — no random synonym substitution
- ☐ Register matched to task (formal essay vs conversational Part 1)
- ☐ Topic-specific vocabulary from Part 3 modules, not generic fillers
- ☐ Paraphrase awareness active in Reading/Listening practice

Extended Section: Band 6 vs Band 9 Lexical Comparison (Same Topic)

Topic: Should governments fund public transport?

Band	Extract
6	"Buses and trains are good for cities. They help people go to work. Cars make pollution so governments should spend money on transport."
7	"Public transport benefits urban areas by reducing congestion and pollution. Investment in buses and rail networks helps commuters travel efficiently."
8	"Substantial investment in integrated public transport mitigates congestion and lowers emissions, enabling commuters to travel reliably without relying on private vehicles."
9	"Substantial investment in integrated public transport not only mitigates congestion and lowers emissions but also enhances labour-market access for low-income households, thereby reducing spatial inequality — a outcome that private-car dominance consistently fails to deliver. "

Examiner note: Band 9 adds **precision** (*spatial inequality, labour-market access*), **logical chaining** (*not only...but also, thereby*), and **evaluative collocation** (*consistently fails to deliver*) — not random rare words.

Extended Section: Topic Precision Banks

Environment (integrate Ch 47)

Weak	Band 8–9
dirty air	air quality deterioration / hazardous particulate levels
save nature	biodiversity conservation / habitat preservation
bad for the planet	ecologically damaging / environmentally unsustainable
use less plastic	reduce single-use plastic consumption
global warming	anthropogenic climate change / rising average temperatures

Education (integrate Ch 45)

Weak	Band 8–9
good teachers	competent educators / qualified instructional staff
learn skills	acquire competencies / develop transferable skills
school results	academic attainment / learning outcomes
online classes	remote instruction / virtual learning environments
hard subjects	academically demanding disciplines

Crime (integrate Ch 50)

Weak	Band 8–9
stop crime	deter offending / reduce criminal activity
put criminals in jail	impose custodial sentences / incarcerate offenders
crime is rising	offending rates are increasing / criminal activity is escalating
police catch criminals	law enforcement apprehends suspects
repeat criminals	recidivist offenders

Extended Section: The Vocabulary Audit Protocol

Use this 10-minute audit on any completed essay:

Step 1 (2 min): Highlight every *good, bad, big, small, thing, stuff, a lot of, many people*.

Step 2 (3 min): Replace with precise alternatives OR justify keeping for repetition/clarity.

Step 3 (2 min): Circle every noun — check word form (*economical* vs *economic*).

Step 4 (2 min): Underline verb+noun pairs — verify collocation in dictionary.

Step 5 (1 min): Confirm one lexical chain runs through each body paragraph.

Scoring your audit: - 0–2 fixes needed → Band 8+ lexical control likely

- 3–6 fixes → Band 7 range

- 7+ fixes → Band 6 or below; drill collocations before next essay

Extended Section: Reading & Listening Paraphrase Drills

Build a **paraphrase notebook** with three columns: *Passage word* | *Question word* | *Your sentence*.

Passage	Paraphrase	Module
prohibit	ban / forbid	Law 61
inhabitants	residents / local population	Urban 68
monetary	financial / economic	Economy 56
detrimental	harmful / damaging	AWL
implement	introduce / put into effect	Government 49
escalate	increase rapidly	General
alleviate	ease / reduce	Health 52
surveillance	monitoring / observation	Tech 46

Daily drill: Five new pairs from practice tests; review 20 old pairs weekly.

Extended Practice: Timed Vocabulary Drills

Drill 1 (3 minutes)

Replace weak words in: "Technology has a big effect on education. Many students use computers and this is a good thing for learning."

Drill 2 (3 minutes)

Write one sentence on **health** using: *preventive, sedentary, healthcare provision, exacerbate*.

Drill 3 (3 minutes)

Write one sentence on **environment** using nominalisation: verb *pollute* → noun phrase.

Drill 4 (5 minutes)

Paraphrase without repeating words: "Governments should spend more money on hospitals because health is very important."

Drill 5 (5 minutes)

Identify wrong collocations: "make research, strong rain, solve pollution, big attention, do a mistake."

30-Day Vocabulary Elevation Plan (Band 7 → 9)

Week	Focus	Daily task
1	Collocations (Ch 70)	10 collocations + original sentence
2	AWL families (Ch 69, A06)	5 families with all word forms
3	Topic rotation (Ch 45–68)	One topic module + paraphrase pairs
4	Integration	One timed Task 2 + vocabulary audit

Rule: Never learn more than 15 new items per day. Depth beats volume.

Summary

Band 9 vocabulary is **precision under control**, not rarity for its own sake. Master four patterns — nominalisation, precision pairs, hedging/boosting, and lexical chains — and anchor them in accurate collocations. Integrate Part 3 topic modules rather than chasing endless word lists. In every module, advanced lexis serves ** clarity of argument (Writing), accurate data description (Task 1), natural fluency (Speaking), **and** paraphrase recognition (Reading/Listening)**. Revise with a pattern-based audit, not a thesaurus.

Answers (Selected Exercises)

Exercise 1 (sample): 1. Rapid urban expansion places unsustainable pressure on infrastructure. 2. Staff training is associated with higher productivity. 3. Advertising restrictions may lead to reduced consumption.

Exercise 2: 1. The study **conducted research into** climate patterns. 2. **Considerable attention** was given to minor details. 3. The policy **alleviated / addressed** unemployment in the region.

Final Band 9 Lexical Principles (Review)

1. **Precision over rarity** — examiners reward control, not dictionary extremes.
2. **Collocation is king** — wrong partner word destroys Band 8+ lexis.
3. **Register match** — Speaking allows more idiomatic latitude than Writing Task 2.
4. **Strategic repetition** — clearer than synonym chaos.
5. **Topic depth** — 300 mastered words across IELTS themes beat 3,000 passive items.
6. **Paraphrase readiness** — Reading/Listening vocabulary is recognition + spelling.
7. **Audit habit** — every essay gets a 10-minute lexical review before submission.

These seven principles, applied across four modules daily for 30 days, produce the “effortless” vocabulary control examiners associate with Band 9.

Next: Chapter 176 — Idioms vs Academic Phrases

Chapter 176: Idioms vs Academic Phrases

Part: 10 — Band 9 Secrets

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will be able to:

- Distinguish idiomatic language from academic phraseology and deploy each appropriately.
- Identify IELTS-safe idioms for Speaking versus phrases required for Writing Task 2.
- Avoid idioms that undermine academic register or cause cultural misunderstanding.
- Replace memorised idiom strings with natural, criterion-aligned alternatives.
- Use fixed academic phrases (discourse markers, stance frames) without template abuse.
- Evaluate idiom lists critically using register, collocation, and task criteria.

Theory / Explanation

176.1 Definitions: Idiom, Collocation, Academic Phrase

Idiom: A fixed expression whose meaning is not deducible from individual words (*kick the bucket* = die; *spill the beans* = reveal a secret).

Collocation: Words that naturally co-occur (*heavy rain*, *commit a crime*, *pose a threat*) — not fully opaque, but fixed enough that alternatives sound wrong.

Academic phrase: A formulaic chunk used in formal argument (*It is widely argued that...; This suggests that...; On balance,...*).

Band descriptors reward **idiomatic language** in Speaking at Band 9 and **less common lexical items** in Writing — but “less common” in Writing usually means **precise academic lexis**, not colourful idioms.

176.2 The Golden Rule by Module

Module	Idioms	Academic phrases
Writing Task 2 (Academic)	Avoid almost all	Essential — used precisely
Writing Task 1	Avoid	Trend/description frames only
GT Letters	Light idioms OK in informal letters	Semi-formal phrases for formal letters
Speaking Part 1	Natural idioms welcome	Light
Speaking Part 2	Storytelling idioms effective	Moderate
Speaking Part 3	Some idioms; analytical phrases dominate	High
Reading/Listening	Recognition only	N/A

Examiner quote (paraphrased from public guidance): Idiomatic mastery in Speaking shows native-like fluency; in Academic Writing, clarity and formality outweigh figurative colour.

176.3 IELTS-Safe Idioms for Speaking

These are widely understood, not offensive, and usable in conversation:

General: - *to be honest / frankly speaking* - *once in a blue moon* - *it rings a bell* - *on the whole* - *at the end of the day* (use sparingly — overused globally)

Work/Study: - *learn the ropes* - *burn the midnight oil* - *get the hang of* - *behind the scenes* - *call it a day*

People/Character: - *down-to-earth* - *a people person* - *keep in touch* - *hit it off with someone*

Problems/Success: - *a blessing in disguise* - *back to square one* - *the tip of the iceberg* - *go the extra mile*

Example (Part 2): “Preparing for IELTS meant I **burned the midnight oil** for weeks, but reaching Band 8 felt like **going the extra mile** that finally paid off.”

176.4 Idioms to Avoid in IELTS

Idiom	Problem
<i>It's raining cats and dogs</i>	Cliché; sounds rehearsed
<i>Every cloud has a silver lining</i>	Empty in Part 3 analysis
<i>You can't judge a book by its cover</i>	Overused; rarely adds content
<i>Bite the bullet</i>	Often misused in wrong context
<i>The ball is in your court</i>	Business idiom; odd in many essay topics
Regional/slang idioms	Examiner may not know them
Offensive or crude idioms	Never appropriate

Writing Task 2 ban list (sample): *in a nutshell, pros and cons (informal in some contexts), tons of, heaps of, kids, stuff, things (vague), at the end of the day (in formal essay).*

176.5 Academic Phrases That Replace Idioms in Writing

Instead of idiomatic colour, use **stance and logic frames**:

Introducing views: - *It is often argued that...* - *Proponents of this view maintain that...* - *Critics, however, contend that...*

Adding evidence: - *Research indicates that...* - *Evidence suggests that...* - *This is exemplified by...*

Contrast: - *Nevertheless,...* - *Conversely,...* - *Notwithstanding this,...*

Concession: - *Admittedly,...* - *While it is true that...,* - *Although X has merit,...*

Conclusion: - *On balance,...* - *Taken together, these factors suggest...* - *In light of the above,...*

These are not “templates” if the content between them is original and logical. They become templates when every essay opens with *In this day and age* and closes with *In a nutshell*.

176.6 The Idiom–Academic Continuum

Imagine a scale from informal to formal:

Slang → Idiom → Neutral phrase → Academic collocation → Latinate formal

Speaking Band 9 moves comfortably across the middle — idioms plus academic words in Part 3.

Writing Band 9 stays right of centre — academic collocations dominate; idioms rarely appear.

Example transformation:

Speaking (OK)	Writing (better)
Cities are ** bursting at the seams**	Cities are experiencing severe overcrowding
The policy missed the mark	The policy failed to achieve its stated objectives
We need to get to the bottom of crime	Authorities must investigate the root causes of crime

176.7 Cultural and Regional Considerations

IELTS is international. Examiners may be from any English-speaking background. Prefer **international idioms** over culture-specific ones (*not cricket* — British; *touch base* — business English).

If an examiner does not understand an idiom, they may mark down **Lexical Resource** (wrong word choice) or **Fluency** (communication breakdown).

Self-test: Would this idiom appear on BBC Learning English or British Council learner materials? If yes, likely safe. If it's purely local slang, avoid.

176.8 Academic Phrases: Precision Without Padding

Weak academic padding (Band 6):

"In this day and age, with the fast development of society, technology plays a pivotal role in many aspects of life."

Strong (Band 8+):

"Technological adoption has reshaped communication, employment, and education within a single generation."

The second version uses **academic lexis** (*adoption, reshaped*) without empty openers.

Replace these openers: - ~~In this day and age~~ → *In recent decades / Currently / Today* - ~~With the development of~~ → *As X has expanded / Following the rise of* - ~~It goes without saying~~ → *Clearly / Evidently* (or delete)

176.9 Idioms in GT Writing

Informal letter (friend): Idioms natural — *I'm over the moon; long time no see; catch up soon.*

Semi-formal (landlord, colleague): Neutral — *I am writing to enquire; I would appreciate; please let me know.*

Formal complaint: No idioms — *I wish to express my dissatisfaction; I request a full refund; I look forward to your prompt response.*

Register control itself demonstrates Band 7+ awareness.

176.10 How Examiners Detect Memorised Idiom Chains

Signs of memorisation:

- Idiom cluster at start/end with weaker body
- Idiom used incorrectly (*at the end of the day* meaning *finally*)
- British idiom + American spelling inconsistency throughout
- Part 2 speech sounds like written essay with idioms stuffed in

Antidote: Use **one** well-chosen idiom per Speaking section maximum, embedded in genuine personal content.

Worked Examples

Speaking Part 3: Idiom + Academic Blend (Band 9)

Question: Should governments fund the arts?

Response: “That’s a difficult question. **On the one hand**, public funding **ensures** that culture isn’t **the preserve of the wealthy** — everyone can access museums and theatre. **On the other hand**, taxpayers might argue that **in times of economic hardship**, money should **be channelled into** healthcare and education first. **On balance**, I’d **advocate for** modest arts funding because cultural investment **fosters** social cohesion, **even if** it isn’t **the government’s top priority**.”

Note: Phrases like *the preserve of*, *channelled into*, *on balance* are academic-idiomatic hybrids — perfect for Part 3. No colourful idiom needed.

Writing Task 2: Academic Only (Band 9)

Question: Some believe technology isolates people. To what extent do you agree?

Extract: “While digital platforms **undoubtedly** enable **sustained contact** across distance, they **may simultaneously erode** face-to-face interaction. **Admittedly**, video calls **mitigate** isolation for **geographically separated** families; **nevertheless, reliance on** screen-based communication **cannot fully replicate** the **social cues** embedded in physical presence.”

Zero idioms; full Band 9 lexical and cohesive control.

Common Mistakes

1. **Idiom in every Task 2 paragraph** — undermines academic tone.
2. **Mixed metaphor** — *we must hit the ground running on this iceberg*.
3. **Wrong idiom meaning** — *I did it once in a blue moon* (means rarely, not once).
4. **Academic phrase without logic** — *Nevertheless* with no contrast following.
5. **Over-formal Speaking** — *One ought to posit that recreation is beneficial* in Part 1 about hobbies.

Practice Exercises

Exercise 1: Register Sort

Label each expression **S** (Speaking idiom OK), **W** (Writing academic), or **X** (avoid):

1. on balance
2. tons of people
3. foster innovation
4. hit the nail on the head
5. it is widely acknowledged that
6. kinda difficult

Exercise 2: Transform

Rewrite for Writing Task 2 (remove idioms, keep meaning):

“Cities are bursting at the seams, and at the end of the day governments need to get to the bottom of housing shortages.”

Exercise 3: Speaking Upgrade

Add **one** appropriate idiom to this Part 2 answer without overdoing it:

“I studied hard for my exam. I practiced every day. Finally I got a good score.”

Exercise 4: Academic Phrase Repair

Fix misused phrases:

1. Nevertheless, both sides are similar.
2. On balance, there are only advantages.
3. Admittedly, this proves my point completely.

Examiner Insight Box

Examiners **do not** count idioms. They assess whether language is **natural and appropriate**. A Band 9 speaker might use zero idioms but sound perfectly idiomatic through **collocation and intonation**. A Band 6 speaker forcing ten idioms sounds **less** fluent, not more.

In Writing, examiners reward **phraseological accuracy** — *draw a conclusion, pose a question, address an issue* — over figurative speech.

Extended Section: Academic Phrase Bank by Essay Function

Opening context (Writing Task 2)

- *In contemporary urban societies,...*
- *Over the past two decades,...*
- *The proliferation of digital technology has...*
- *Few issues attract as much debate as...*

Presenting View A

- *Proponents of this position argue that...*
- *Supporters maintain that...*
- *Those in favour of X often cite...*

Presenting View B

- *By contrast, critics contend that...*
- *Opponents, however, raise concerns about...*
- *Sceptics question whether...*

Adding evidence

- *Empirical evidence suggests that...*
- *This trend is exemplified by...*
- *Official statistics indicate that...*

Concluding

- *On balance, the evidence favours...*
- *Taken together, these arguments suggest...*
- *In light of the above,...*

Warning: Rotate phrases across essays. Examiners notice identical openers across scripts in same session (suspicion of memorisation).

Extended Section: Speaking Idiom Placement Map

Part	Idiom density	Best placement
Part 1	Low-medium	Personal stories, feelings
Part 2	Medium	Narrative climax, reflection
Part 3	Low	Prefer analytical phrases; one idiom max

Part 1 example: "Do you enjoy reading?"

→ "Yes, **from time to time**. I **hit the books** when I need to switch off from screens."

Part 2 example: End of story

→ "So reaching Band 8 was **a blessing in disguise** — I'd **gone the extra mile** and it **paid off**."

Part 3 example (prefer academic):

→ "**On balance**, I'd **advocate for** targeted funding **rather than** blanket subsidies."

Extended Section: Cliché Replacement Table

Cliché idiom/phrase	Band 8+ replacement
In this day and age	Currently / In recent decades
Every coin has two sides	X presents both benefits and drawbacks
In a nutshell	In summary / To summarise
Pros and cons	advantages and disadvantages
Last but not least	Finally / A further consideration is
It goes without saying	Clearly / Evidently
The fast pace of life	accelerating societal change
With the development of technology	As technology has advanced

Extended Section: Idiom Misuse Case Studies

Case 1: Candidate writes *"Technology is the tip of the iceberg of education."*

Problem: Mixed metaphor; idiom misapplied — education is not "hidden beneath" technology.

Fix: *"Technology represents only one component of effective education."*

Case 2: Speaking Part 3: *"Governments should bite the bullet on taxes."*

Problem: Informal idiom in analytical context; may sound flippant.

Fix: *"Governments may need to implement unpopular tax rises."*

Case 3: Writing: *"At the end of the day, kids need schools."*

Problem: Informal idiom + *kids* in academic essay.

Fix: *"Ultimately, children require structured educational environments."*

Extended Practice Bank

Exercise 6: Register ladder

Rewrite one sentence at three registers (informal Speaking → neutral → formal Writing):

Base: *"The government should fix the healthcare system."*

Exercise 7: Idiom or academic?

Choose best option for Writing Task 2: 1. (a) get rid of pollution (b) eliminate pollution

2. (a) on balance (b) at the end of the day

3. (a) foster innovation (b) make innovation grow

Exercise 8: Speaking naturalness

Record 60 seconds on a hobby using **zero** idioms but natural fluency. Compare to version with **two** idioms. Which sounds Band 8+?

Exercise 9: GT letter tone

Write one formal and one informal sentence requesting information about a course.

Exercise 10: Error correction

Fix: *"In a nutshell, although technology has pros and cons, we must hit the nail on the head and utilise AI at the end of the day."*

Cross-Reference Map

Need	Chapter	Appendix
Safe idioms list	176	A05
Phrasal verbs	176	A04
Academic phrases	176	A12 F11–F15
Collocations	175	Ch 70
Register in GT	176	A11 Sheet 8
AWL word forms	176	A06

When preparing for a specific test date, spend the final three days reviewing appendices rather than learning new items.

Summary

Use **idioms sparingly and naturally in Speaking**; use **academic phrases and collocations in Writing**. Know the register boundary for GT letters. Replace clichéd openers with content-rich sentences. When in doubt, choose clarity over colour. See Appendix A05 for an expanded idiom list with warnings.

Answers (Selected)

Exercise 1: 1-W, 2-X, 3-W, 4-S, 5-W, 6-X

Exercise 2: “Many cities are experiencing severe overcrowding, and governments must investigate the root causes of housing shortages.”

Exercise 4: Nevertheless requires contrast — use *Similarly* or *Likewise* if comparing alike sides.

Final Register Decision Flowchart

```

Is this Writing Task 2 Academic?
YES → Use academic phrases + collocations; avoid idioms
NO → Is this GT informal letter?
    YES → Natural idioms OK sparingly
  
```


NO → Is this Speaking Part 1-2?

YES → Idioms welcome if natural (1-2 max)

NO (Part 3) → Analytical phrases primary; idioms optional

Memorise this flowchart before test day. Register mistakes are faster to fix than grammar errors and immediately signal Band 6–7 control. When uncertain, choose the formal academic phrase over the colourful idiom in Writing.

Next: Chapter 177 — Cohesion Tricks Examiners Notice

Chapter 177: Cohesion Tricks Examiners Notice

Part: 10 — Band 9 Secrets

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will be able to:

- Explain cohesion as logical visibility, not linker density.
- Apply four cohesive devices (reference, substitution, conjunction, lexical chains) at Band 9 level.
- Use advanced cohesive patterns: backward/forward reference, paragraph bridges, and echo words.
- Eliminate template cohesion that examiners penalise (robotic Firstly/Secondly chains).
- Diagnose cohesion failures in your own writing using an examiner-style checklist.
- Transfer cohesive skills to Speaking Part 3 extended answers.

Theory / Explanation

177.1 Cohesion vs Coherence: The Distinction Examiners Apply

Coherence: Ideas follow a logical order; the reader understands your argument.

Cohesion: Surface links — grammar and vocabulary — that signal relationships between sentences.

A script can be cohesive but incoherent (*However, however, moreover* with no logic). Band 9 requires **both**: ideas that progress AND links that clarify that progression.

Public descriptors for Band 8–9 (Writing): *sequences information and ideas logically; manages all aspects of cohesion well; uses paragraphing sufficiently and appropriately.*

The examiner question: **Can I follow this without re-reading?**

177.2 The Four Cohesive Tools (Deep Dive)

Reference (Pointing Back or Forward)

Personal: *it, they, them, this, these, such*

Demonstrative: *this policy, such measures, the latter, the former*

Band 9 rule: Every *this/these* must have **one clear antecedent**.

Weak: “Governments invest in rail and buses. **This** improves life.” (*This* = investment? rail? both?)

Strong: “**This dual investment in public transport** improves commuting reliability and reduces car dependency.”

Forward reference (advanced): “Two factors explain the trend: **the first** is...; **the second** is...” — prepares reader for structure.

Substitution (Replacing a Chunk)

Replace repeated nouns with pro-forms:

- *do so, such, one, the same, alternatively*

“The UK raised taxes. Germany **did likewise**.”

“Some favour restriction; **others** prefer voluntary codes.”

Conjunction (Logical Connectors)

Classify by **function**, not memorise lists:

Function	Examples	Use when
Addition	furthermore, in addition, also	Adding supporting point
Contrast	however, whereas, conversely, while	Genuine opposition
Result	therefore, consequently, as a result	Cause → effect
Example	for example, for instance, namely	Illustrating prior claim
Concession	although, even though, despite	Acknowledging counterpoint
Time	subsequently, previously, meanwhile	Sequencing events (Task 1)

Examiner red flag: *However* starting every paragraph with no real contrast.

Lexical Chains (Echo and Variation)

Repeat key terms with controlled family words:

Education → *schools* → *curriculum* → *literacy* → *attainment*

Avoid synonym chaos: *education* → *learning* → *schooling* → *pedagogy* → *instruction* in five consecutive sentences without clear referents.

177.3 Paragraph-Level Cohesion: The Band 9 Blueprint

Introduction (Task 2):

Hook/context (optional, brief) → paraphrase question → thesis/roadmap

Body paragraph: 1. Topic sentence — claim or theme

2. **Explanation** — why the claim holds

3. **Example/evidence** — concrete support

4. **Mini-conclusion/link** — tie back to thesis or bridge to next paragraph

Conclusion: Synthesise (no new ideas); restate position with nuance

Cohesive trick: End paragraph 1 with a phrase that paragraph 2 picks up:

P1 ending: "...this **financial strain** affects not only households **but also** public services."

P2 opening: "**Public services**, particularly healthcare, **face similar pressure** when..."

177.4 Advanced Patterns Examiners Reward

Pattern A: Thematic Repetition with Progression

Each paragraph repeats the **essay theme** in different aspect:

Essay on technology in education:

- P1: *digital tools in classrooms*
- P2: *teacher training for those tools*
- P3: *equity of access to those tools*

The chain *tools* → *training* → *access* coheres the whole essay.

Pattern B: Known–New Information Structure

Start sentence with **known** (from prior sentence); end with **new** (leading forward).

“**Urban migration** has accelerated. **This shift** has placed **unprecedented demand on housing**.”

Reader: migration (known) → shift (synonym) → housing demand (new).

Pattern C: Reduced Clauses for Tight Cohesion

Full: “Technology is changing work. Technology is also changing education.”

Reduced: “**Technology is changing not only work but also education.**”

Participial: “**Having outlined the economic benefits**, I will now address environmental costs.”

Pattern D: Discourse Labels

Name the move you are making:

- *Turning to the environmental impact,...*
- *A further consideration is...*
- *This argument rests on two assumptions:*

These signal structure explicitly — valued at Band 8–9 when not overused.

177.5 Cohesion in Task 1

Academic Task 1 cohesion = **comparative logic**, not opinion linkers.

Overview paragraph: State 2–3 main trends without data clutter.

Body: Group by **time**, **category**, or **comparison** — not random figure order.

Cohesive frames: - *Overall, X increased while Y declined.*

- *In contrast to A, B remained stable.*

- *The most dramatic change occurred in...*
- *By [year], this figure had reached...*

Link paragraphs with comparison, not *Furthermore*:

“**Turning to employment figures**, a similar pattern emerges.”

177.6 Cohesion in Speaking

Speaking cohesion = **signposting + pronoun clarity + listing**.

Part 3 structure: 1. Direct answer: *Yes, to a large extent*.

2. Reason 1: *The main reason is...*

3. Reason 2: *On top of that,...*

4. Example: *For instance,...*

5. Concession (optional): *That said,...*

6. Wrap: *So overall,...*

Fluency tip: Cohesive devices buy thinking time (*Well, that's an interesting question*) without sounding evasive.

Avoid: Written essay connectors spoken aloud — *Notwithstanding the aforementioned* sounds unnatural.

177.7 Template Abuse: What Drops Cohesion Scores

Template crime	Why it fails
Firstly, Secondly, Thirdly with no logical link	Mechanical, not logical
However in every paragraph	False contrast
In conclusion introducing new argument	Breaks structure
One-sentence paragraphs throughout	No development
Wall of text, no paragraphs	Reader lost
Repeating question words without paraphrase	No lexical cohesion

Band 9 alternative to Firstly/Secondly: Use content-based opens:

- *The most pressing concern is...*
- *Equally significant is...*
- *A related issue is...*

177.8 Reading Cohesion Awareness

Understanding cohesion helps Reading:

- *This / Such / These* in passage → track antecedent to locate answers

- Contrast markers (*however, although*) → TFNG boundaries
- Reference chains across paragraphs → matching headings

Train: underline all cohesive ties in one passage daily.

Worked Example: Full Body Paragraph (Band 9)

Topic: Government funding for public transport

Investment in public transport infrastructure offers both economic and environmental returns. When commuters have reliable bus and rail networks, **they** are less dependent on private vehicles, **which** reduces congestion and emissions. **London's congestion charge scheme, for example, illustrates** how pricing and improved transit can **work in tandem: following its introduction**, inner-city traffic volumes **fell** while bus ridership **rose**. **Admittedly**, upfront capital costs **are substantial; nevertheless, the long-term savings** in healthcare and road maintenance **often offset** initial expenditure. **For this reason, fiscal prioritisation of transit deserves** serious consideration **even in** austerity periods.

Cohesive inventory: reference (*they, which, its*), example frame (*for example, illustrates*), concession (*admittedly, nevertheless*), result (*for this reason*), lexical chain (*transport, commuters, vehicles, congestion, transit, traffic, ridership*).

Common Mistakes

1. **Misplaced however** — no contrast between adjacent ideas.
2. **Ambiguous this** — reader cannot identify referent.
3. **Over-linking** — three connectors in one sentence.
4. **Paragraph drift** — sentence 4 unrelated to topic sentence.
5. **Speaking**: listing without concluding tie-back.

Practice Exercises

Exercise 1: Antecedent Repair

Fix ambiguous reference:

“Crime rates and unemployment rose. This is a problem for cities.”

Exercise 2: Connector Sort

Insert the correct connector: however / therefore / for example / although

1. ___ funding is limited, schools have improved digital access.
2. Emissions fell sharply; ___, air quality improved.
3. Nordic countries invest heavily in renewables; ___, Denmark's wind capacity.

Exercise 3: Paragraph Bridge

Write one sentence to link these paragraphs:

P1 ends: "...online learning expands access for rural students."

P2 starts: [Your bridge] "...many learners lack reliable internet."

Exercise 4: De-template

Rewrite without Firstly/Secondly/Thirdly:

"Firstly, exercise is healthy. Secondly, it reduces stress. Thirdly, it is free."

Exercise 5: Task 1 Overview

Write a two-sentence overview for any line graph you have practised, using only comparative cohesion — no opinion words.

Examiner Insight Box

Examiners mark **Coherence and Cohesion** holistically. One missing *however* does not destroy a Band 9 script if paragraph logic is crystal clear. Conversely, perfect linkers with chaotic ideas cap at Band 6. **Paragraphing is cohesion** — white space is a signal.

In computer-delivered IELTS, paragraph breaks are easier; use them deliberately.

Cohesion Audit Checklist

- ☐ Every paragraph has one clear central job
- ☐ Every *this/these/such* has identifiable antecedent
- ☐ Connectors express real logical relations
- ☐

- ☐ Lexical chain maintained across essay
- ☐ No new ideas in conclusion
- ☐ Task 1 overview separates from detail
- ☐ Speaking Part 3 answers signposted naturally

Extended Section: Cohesive Devices by Band Level

Band	Typical cohesion	Examiner reaction
5	Basic and/or overused linkers; weak paragraphing	Reader confused
6	Visible linkers; some logical progression	Followable with effort
7	Range of devices; generally clear	Smooth read
8	Skilful, subtle cohesion; strong paragraphing	Professional
9	Cohesion “invisible” — logic carries reader	Effortless

Band 9 secret: Remove linkers from a Band 9 paragraph — it still coheres because **ideas** connect. Add linkers to a Band 5 paragraph — it still fails.

Extended Section: Paragraph Bridge Library

Use these bridges between body paragraphs (adapt content):

- *Having established X, it is necessary to consider Y.*
- *This economic argument is complemented by an environmental perspective.*
- *While the previous section focused on urban areas, rural communities face distinct challenges.*
- *The same principle applies, mutatis mutandis, to healthcare.*
- *A related concern is...*
- *Beyond this immediate effect, long-term consequences include...*

Extended Section: Task 1 Cohesion Templates

Opening paraphrase + overview link: > *The chart compares [X] across [time/categories]. Overall, [trend 1], whereas [trend 2].*

Body transition by time: > *In the early period (2000–2010),...*

> *Over the following decade,...*

> *By the end of the timeframe,...*

Body transition by category: > *Turning to [category B],...*

> *A similar pattern was observed in...*

> *By contrast, [category C]...*

Closing detail (not overview repetition): > *In summary of the detail above, [specific comparison] — already flagged in the overview.*

Extended Section: Cohesion in GT Letters

Formal complaint flow: 1. Purpose sentence (*I am writing to express...*)

2. Background (*On [date], I purchased...*)

3. Problem (*Unfortunately,...*)

4. Request (*I would therefore appreciate...*)

5. Close (*I look forward to your response.*)

Cohesive ties: *this issue, such delays, as a result, consequently*

Extended Section: Speaking Cohesion Without Essay Connectors

Natural spoken ties: - *Well,...* / *So,...* / *Right,...* (discourse markers)

- *What I mean is...* (clarification)

- *Another thing is...* (addition)

- *Mind you,...* (contrast, informal)

- *That said,...* (concession)

Part 3 model (90 sec): > **“Well**, I think flexibility is the main advantage — **for example**, remote workers can manage family commitments. **That said**, isolation can be a drawback **because** human contact supports wellbeing. **So overall**, hybrid models **seem** most balanced.”

Extended Practice Bank

Exercise 6: Remove 50% linkers

Take a 150-word paragraph with six linkers. Remove half without breaking logic.

Exercise 7: Add bridges only

Two unrelated paragraphs provided — write one bridge sentence.

Exercise 8: Task 1 grouping

Given ten data points, assign to two body paragraphs and write topic sentences.

Exercise 9: Speaking signpost

Answer Part 3 question in 45 seconds using at least three natural spoken ties (not *furthermore*).

Exercise 10: Cohesion diagnosis

Identify cohesion type (reference/substitution/conjunction/lexical chain) in each underlined tie:

“**This policy** reduced emissions, **which in turn** lowered healthcare costs. **Such outcomes demonstrate** the value of prevention.”

Exercise 11–15: Timed cohesion rebuilds

Exercise 11 (3 min): Write a topic sentence + three supporting sentences on **renewable energy** using one lexical chain only.

Exercise 12 (3 min): Join two sentences with *whereas* and *while* — different logical relations.

Exercise 13 (3 min): Write Task 1 overview for any table using *Overall* + *In contrast* without data numbers.

Exercise 14 (3 min): Fix paragraph where every sentence starts with *However*.

Exercise 15 (5 min): Write 100-word Speaking Part 3 answer on **urbanisation** with oral signposts only (no *furthermore*).

Band 6 vs Band 9 Cohesion — Full Paragraph Comparison

Topic: Online learning

Band 6: > “Online learning is popular. However, it is good. However, some people don’t like it. Moreover, students can study at home. However, there are problems. For example, internet is bad sometimes.”

Band 9: > “Online learning has expanded rapidly, **largely because** it offers flexibility for students balancing work and family commitments. **This flexibility, however, comes at a cost: learners without** reliable connectivity **or** self-discipline **may fall behind peers** in traditional classrooms. **Nevertheless, when** courses **are well designed, remote instruction can match face-to-face outcomes — a finding supported by several university audits.**”

Analysis: Band 9 uses **reference** (*this flexibility, learners, a finding*), **concession** (*however, nevertheless*), **example frame** (*a finding supported by*), and **lexical chain** (*online learning → flexibility → learners → remote instruction → face-to-face outcomes*). Study this paragraph structure and replicate it across your own Task 2 body paragraphs.

Cohesion Error Log Template

Date	Script	Error type	Fix applied
	Essay 3 P2	Ambiguous <i>this</i>	Replaced with <i>this funding model</i>
	Task 1	Missing overview link	Added <i>Overall</i> sentence

Review weekly; top three errors become next week’s drill focus.

Summary

Band 9 cohesion is **invisible architecture**: reference, substitution, conjunction, and lexical chains working together so the reader never stumbles. Replace mechanical templates with content-driven signposting. Master paragraph bridges and known–new structure. Apply the same principles to Speaking through natural signposts. Cohesion serves coherence — never the reverse.

Final Cohesion Principles (Review)

1. **Logic before linkers** — if ideas connect, fewer connectors needed.

-
2. **One job per paragraph** — topic sentence test: can you title the paragraph?
 3. **Clear antecedents** — every *this/these/such* points to one noun.
 4. **Real contrasts only** — *however* requires genuine opposition.
 5. **Overview separate** — Task 1 overview is not body detail repetition.
 6. **Speaking ≠ Writing** — oral signposts differ from essay connectors.
 7. **Bridge between paragraphs** — end P1 with forward link; open P2 with echo.

Apply these seven principles to every script in your final month of preparation. Cohesion upgrades often raise Coherence and Cohesion by a full band without adding new vocabulary. Review Chapter 110 alongside this chapter for Writing Task 2-specific cohesion drills. Complete at least five timed cohesion rebuild exercises per week in your final preparation month before test day.

Next: Chapter 178 — High-Band Grammar Tricks

Chapter 178: High-Band Grammar Tricks

Part: 10 — Band 9 Secrets

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will be able to:

- Deploy grammatical structures that consistently signal Band 8–9 (not Band 6 complexity).
- Use advanced but controlled patterns: inversion, cleft sentences, subjunctive, mixed conditionals, and participle clauses.
- Balance range with accuracy — the Band 9 principle of “error-free stretches.”
- Avoid “broken complexity” that confuses examiners and caps Grammatical Range and Accuracy.
- Select grammar strategically by task (Task 1 description vs Task 2 argument vs Speaking fluency).
- Self-edit grammar under time pressure using a priority-based error hierarchy.

Theory / Explanation

178.1 What Examiners Mean by “Wide Range”

Band 7: uses a **variety** of complex structures; produces frequent error-free sentences.

Band 8: uses a **wide range** flexibly; majority of sentences error-free.

Band 9: uses a **full range** with **very natural** accuracy; only rare slips.

Critical insight: One relative clause per paragraph is Band 6–7. Band 9 distributes structures **across** the script: conditionals, passives, participle clauses, nominal relative clauses, modality, comparison — all **controlled**.

178.2 The Band 9 Grammar Toolkit

Tool 1: Participle Clauses (Openers and Reducers)

Opening participle (reason/time):

“**Faced with rising costs**, many firms automate production.”

“**Having completed the survey**, researchers analysed the results.”

Reducing relative clauses:

“Students **who study abroad** often gain confidence” → “Students **studying abroad** often gain confidence.”

Warning: Dangling participle — ensure subject matches:

Wrong: “**Having finished the essay**, the deadline approached.” (The deadline didn’t finish the essay.)

Tool 2: Inversion (Emphasis and Formal Tone)

After negative/limiting fronted adverbs:

- *Never have I seen such rapid change.*
- *Rarely does policy align so closely with evidence.*
- *Not only does X benefit Y, but it also...*
- *Only when funding increases will outcomes improve.*

Use **one** inversion per essay maximum — more sounds archaic or memorised.

Tool 3: Cleft Sentences (Focus)

It-cleft: “**It is funding** that determines quality, not intention alone.”

What-cleft: “**What cities need** is integrated planning, not isolated projects.”

Effective for thesis statements and emphatic conclusions.

Tool 4: Advanced Conditionals

Mixed conditional (past condition → present result):

“If governments **had invested** earlier, cities **would be** less congested today.”

Inverted conditional (without if):

“**Had** policymakers **acted** sooner, emissions **would have** fallen faster.”

“**Were** education fully funded, inequality **might** narrow.”

Modal nuance in open conditions:

"If technology **continues to** advance, labour markets **will** transform." (likely future)

"If technology **were to** stall, growth **could** slow." (hypothetical)

Tool 5: Passive and Impersonal Structures (Academic Distance)

- *It is widely believed that...*
- *Measures have been taken to...*
- *The data were collected over ten years.* (Academic: *data* plural in formal British style)

Do not passive everything — active voice shows clarity: *Researchers collected data over ten years.*

Tool 6: Nominal Relative Clauses

- *What matters most is equitable access.*
- *Where the policy fails is in enforcement.*
- *Why crime persists is complex.*

Tool 7: Parallelism (Band 9 polish)

Lists and comparisons must match grammatically:

Weak: "The policy aims to reduce pollution, improving health, and economic growth."

Strong: "The policy aims **to reduce pollution, improve public health, and stimulate economic growth.**"

See Chapter 29 (Parallelism) for full treatment.

Tool 8: Subjunctive (Formal Mandates)

- *It is essential that every child **have** access.* (mandative subjunctive — formal)
- *The committee recommended that he **be** dismissed.*

In IELTS, one mandative subjunctive per formal essay demonstrates range; do not force throughout.

178.3 Grammar by Task: Strategic Selection**Writing Task 1**

Priority structures: - Past perfect for earlier baseline: *By 2010, sales had reached...* - Comparatives/superlatives: *the highest, twice as much as* - Passive for processes: *The liquid is heated...* - Time clauses: *After reaching a peak in 2015,...*

Avoid: Complex argument grammar (conditionals about policy) — not required.

Writing Task 2

Priority structures: - Thesis with modal: *Governments **should** prioritise...* - Concession clauses: *Although X, Y* - Cause/effect: *Because / Since / As a result* - Hypothetical policy: mixed conditionals - Participle openers for variety

Distribution target (250 words): ~60% complex sentences, ~40% simple/compound for rhythm.

Speaking

Priority structures: - Accurate tense for personal narrative (past simple, past continuous) - Present perfect for life experience: *I've lived here for...* - Would/could for hypotheticals in Part 3 - Tag questions for naturalness: *It's quite stressful, isn't it?*

Avoid in speech: Heavy inversion and mandative subjunctive — sounds unnatural.

178.4 The Error Hierarchy: What Hurts Most

Examiners weight errors by **communication impact**:

Severity	Example	Effect
Critical	Wrong tense obscures time	Band drop
Major	Sentence fragment / run-on	Band drop
Moderate	Article error (<i>a education</i>)	Minor if isolated
Minor	Preposition (<i>depend of</i>)	Rare slips OK at Band 9
Slip	Spelling <i>goverment</i> once	Forgiven if rare

Band 9 strategy: Write **shorter correct sentences** under pressure rather than **long broken ones**.

178.5 Broken Complexity: The Band 6 Trap

Candidates memorise complex patterns without control:

"Although technology is developing, but it causes problems which is affecting society and if governments would take action the situation will be improved."

Errors: double connector (*although...but*), agreement (*which is* vs *which are*), conditional (*if governments would*).

Fix: One structure per sentence until automatic; then combine.

178.6 Error-Free Stretches: Practical Method

1. Write paragraph.
2. Mark every verb — check tense consistency.
3. Mark every *this/which/they* — check agreement and reference.
4. Read aloud — broken rhythm reveals grammar gaps.
5. Under exam conditions, reserve 3 minutes for grammar-only proofread (Writing).

178.7 Grammar Tricks for Reading and Listening

Grammar awareness aids paraphrase recognition:

- Active ⇌ passive: *The company employed 500* ⇌ *500 were employed*
- Positive ⇌ negative: *rarely legal* ⇌ *seldom permitted*
- Tense shift in reported speech
- Modal shift: *must* ⇌ *have to* ⇌ *required to*

When Listening gap-fill expects a verb, grammar in the sentence stem tells you **form**.

Worked Examples

Band 6 → Band 9 Sentence Upgrades

Topic: Public health

Band	Sentence
6	If people eat unhealthy food, they will get sick and government should do something.
7	If people consume unhealthy food, they are more likely to become ill, so governments should intervene.
8	Were dietary habits to deteriorate further, healthcare systems would face unsustainable pressure, which is why preventive policy is essential.
9	Not only does poor diet increase chronic disease rates, but it also strains healthcare budgets — a trend that would intensify were public education inadequate .

Task 1 Grammar Sample

“Overall, coal **declined steadily** from 40% to 15%, **having been** the dominant source in 1990. **By contrast**, renewables **rose, eventually overtaking** gas **to become** the largest contributor **by** 2020.”

Uses: past simple, past perfect, participle (*having been, overtaking*), comparative logic.

Common Mistakes

1. **Comma splices:** *Technology is useful, it saves time.*
2. **Double conditionals:** *If... would... will...* mixed wrongly
3. **Relative clause overload:** three *which* clauses in one sentence
4. **Agreement with uncountable nouns:** *informations, evidences*
5. **Over-passivisation:** reader loses agent and clarity

Practice Exercises

Exercise 1: Combine with Participle

Combine each pair into one sentence with a participle opener or reducer.

1. Many workers lost jobs. They retrained in digital skills.
2. The city built new cycle lanes. Pollution levels fell.

Exercise 2: One Inversion

Rewrite with inversion (one per sentence):

1. I have rarely seen such commitment.
2. Policy changes only when pressure mounts.

Exercise 3: Mixed Conditional

Complete:

If countries ____ (invest) in renewables decades ago, emissions ____ (be) lower today.

Exercise 4: Error Hunt

Correct all errors:

“Although there is many benefits, but technology effect children which are using phones and if parents would restrict it the problem will solved.”

Exercise 5: Task 2 Paragraph

Write 100 words on education funding using: one concession clause, one passive, one cleft or inversion, one modal verb.

Examiner Insight Box

Examiners **do not** tick off grammar structures like a checklist. They notice **natural variety** and **safe execution**. A Band 9 essay may use simpler grammar in the conclusion for rhetorical clarity. **Accuracy beats acrobatics**.

In Speaking, grammar errors during complex Part 3 answers are tolerated if self-corrected smoothly: *The government should... sorry, should have... implemented the policy earlier.*

Self-correction **without** fluency breakdown can still score Band 8–9.

Grammar Range Distribution Guide (Task 2, ~280 words)

Structure type	Target count
Complex sentence (subordinate clause)	8–12
Compound sentence	3–5
Simple sentence (for emphasis)	2–4
Participle clause	1–2
Conditional (any type)	1–2
Passive	2–4
Inversion/cleft (optional)	0–1 each

Extended Section: Structure Selection Matrix (Task 2)

Goal	Structure	Example opener
Emphasis	Cleft	<i>It is funding that determines outcomes.</i>
Condition	Mixed conditional	<i>If they had acted, cities would be cleaner today.</i>
Concession	Although + main clause	<i>Although costly, reform is necessary.</i>
Cause chain	Participle	<i>Having reduced emissions, cities improved air quality.</i>
Formal claim	Passive + impersonal	<i>It is widely believed that access should expand.</i>
Narrative (Speaking)	Past perfect + past simple	<i>I'd lived there for years before I moved.</i>

Rule: Select **one** showcase structure per paragraph — not all in one sentence.

Extended Section: Grammar by Band — Side-by-Side

Prompt: Describe a policy that reduced pollution.

Band	Output
5	"Government make new law and pollution go down because factory stop dirty smoke."
6	"The government made a new law and pollution went down because factories stopped producing dirty smoke."
7	"The government introduced regulations, which reduced pollution because factories were forced to filter emissions."
8	" Having implemented stricter emissions standards, authorities observed a measurable decline in airborne particulates."
9	" Had enforcement been consistent earlier, urban air quality would have improved sooner; nevertheless , recent regulatory tightening has demonstrably curbed industrial discharge."

Extended Section: Error-Free Stretch Training

Method: Write 5 sentences on any topic with **zero** errors — simple structures allowed.

Week 1: 5 simple sentences, perfect.

Week 2: 3 compound, 2 complex — perfect.

Week 3: 5 complex with one participle each — perfect.

Week 4: Full paragraph under timed conditions — maximum 1 minor slip.

Why it works: Band 9 requires **confidence in accuracy** before complexity.

Extended Section: Task 1 Grammar Patterns

Past description

- Sales **rose** from 20% to 35% between 2005 and 2010.
- By 2015, the figure **had reached** 50%.
- Having **peaked** in 2012, output **subsequently declined**.

Passive process

- Raw materials **are transported** to the factory.
- The mixture **is heated** to 200°C.
- Finished products **are packaged and distributed**.

Comparison

- A accounted for **twice as much as** B.
- X was **marginally higher than** Y throughout the period.
- The proportion of coal fell, **while** renewables **increased**.

Extended Section: Speaking Grammar Priorities

Part	Priority structures
Part 1	Present simple/continuous; past for memories; would like
Part 2	Past narrative; past continuous background; used to
Part 3	Modals (might, could, should); conditionals; present perfect for trends

Self-correction model:

*"The government should implemented... sorry, **should have implemented** the policy earlier."*

Fluency pause minimal → Band 8+ handling.

Extended Practice Bank

Exercise 6: Structure identification

Label structures in: "Had funding been available, schools would have upgraded equipment, which might have improved outcomes."

Exercise 7: Broken → fixed

Fix: "If technology will continue, jobs will changed and many workers must retrain or they will lose their job."

Exercise 8: Task 1 tense

Chart runs 1990–2020. Write three sentences using past simple, past perfect, and past perfect continuous.

Exercise 9: One inversion

Write one formal inversion about education policy.

Exercise 10: Error-free five

Write five sentences on **technology** with zero errors — at least two complex.

Exercise 11–15: Advanced grammar drills

Exercise 11: Rewrite using mixed conditional: "Countries didn't invest in renewables early, so emissions are still high."

Exercise 12: Combine with perfect participle: "The survey finished. The team published results."

Exercise 13: Write one *It-cleft* and one *What-cleft* about **education funding**.

Exercise 14: Convert active to passive and back: "Researchers conducted the study in 2023."

Exercise 15: Identify and fix all errors: "If the government would invest more, the economy will improved and many jobs would created which help poor people."

Grammar Range Self-Assessment Grid

Rate yourself 1–5 (1 = cannot produce, 5 = automatic under time):

Structure	Score 1–5
Although/while concession	
Relative clauses (defining/non-defining)	
Participle openers	
Present perfect vs past simple	
Past perfect (Task 1)	
Modals (might/should/could)	
Passive voice	
Mixed conditionals	
Inversion	
Cleft sentences	

Target for Band 8+: All items at 4–5. Items at 1–2 are priority drills before test day. Re-test monthly and track score changes in your preparation journal. Pair this chapter with Part 2 Chapters 26–29 for conditionals, modals, and parallelism depth.

Grammar Proofread Checklist (3 Minutes, Writing)

1. Every verb marked — tense consistent?
2. Every *s* ending on third person present?
3. Articles before singular countable nouns?
4. *Although* not followed by *but*?
5. Comma splices eliminated?
6. Plural agreement (*number of... has* vs *a number of... have*)?

Summary

High-band grammar is **deliberate variety under control**. Deploy participle clauses, advanced conditionals, passives, and occasional inversion or cleft sentences where they serve clarity — not display. Eliminate broken complexity. Build error-free stretches through verb audits and

timed proofreading. Match grammar choices to task: descriptive precision for Task 1, argumentative range for Task 2, fluent narrative for Speaking. See Appendix A01 for quick grammar reference.

Final Grammar Principles (Review)

1. **Accuracy before acrobatics** — one correct complex sentence beats three broken ones.
2. **Distribute structures** — variety across the script, not packed into one paragraph.
3. **Match task to grammar** — Task 1 descriptive; Task 2 argumentative; Speaking narrative/analytical.
4. **Error-free stretches** — deliberate training builds Band 8+ confidence.
5. **Self-repair in Speaking** — smooth correction preserves Fluency and GRA.
6. **Proofread verbs first** — tense errors hurt most under time pressure.
7. **One showcase structure** — inversion or cleft per essay maximum.

Master these principles alongside Part 2 grammar chapters (9–43). Band 9 grammar feels invisible because it serves meaning — never the reverse.

Next: Chapter 179 — Thinking Like an Examiner

Chapter 179: Thinking Like an Examiner

Part: 10 — Band 9 Secrets

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will be able to:

- Internalise the four IELTS scoring criteria as an examiner applies them, not as candidates imagine them.
- Predict band levels for sample responses using public descriptors and evidence-based reasoning.
- Identify “first impression” features that shape Writing and Speaking marks within seconds.
- Distinguish between myths (examiners count errors, prefer British accent) and operational reality.
- Conduct a self-marking session on your practice scripts with examiner discipline.
- Apply examiner thinking to reduce anxiety and improve strategic preparation.

Theory / Explanation

179.1 The Examiner’s Mandate

IELTS examiners are **trained raters**, not teachers giving feedback. Their job:

1. Apply **public band descriptors** consistently.
2. Mark under **time pressure** (especially Writing).

3. Submit to **monitoring and recalibration**.

They are **not** judging your intelligence, morality, or knowledge — only **English communicative performance** against criteria.

Psychological shift: Stop asking *Will they like me?* Ask *Can they follow my answer and locate my strengths on the descriptor sheet?*

179.2 The Four Criteria: Examiner Lens

Writing Task 2 (and Task 1 equivalents)

Criterion	Examiner question	Band 9 signal
Task Response	Is every part answered? Is position clear? Ideas extended?	Fully developed, nuanced position
Coherence & Cohesion	Can I follow without re-reading?	Seamless logic, skilful paragraphing
Lexical Resource	Is vocabulary precise, natural, flexible?	Rare slips only
Grammatical Range & Accuracy	Is there variety with control?	Error-free stretches common

Equal weight: Weakness in one criterion caps the overall score even if others shine.

Speaking (same four, different labels)

Fluency & Coherence | Lexical Resource | Grammatical Range & Accuracy | Pronunciation

Fluency = continuity, pace, logical flow — not speed alone.

179.3 The First 30 Seconds (Writing)

Examiners form initial impressions quickly:

Positive signals: - Legible handwriting or clean typed layout

- Clear paragraphs visible immediately
- Introduction paraphrases question (not copied)
- Obvious task engagement from line one

Negative signals: - Memorised template unrelated to question

- No paragraphs (wall of text)
- Question copied verbatim as “introduction”
- Off-topic or severely under-length (< 180 words Task 2)

Strategy: Invest in a **custom opening** that paraphrases the specific question — examiners notice effort versus memorisation instantly.

179.4 The First 30 Seconds (Speaking)

Part 1: Warm, extended but not rambling answers. Examiner tests comfort.

Part 2: Structured talk covering all bullets; notes used naturally.

Part 3: Analytical depth — compare, evaluate, speculate.

Examiner behaviour is neutral by design. A serious face does **not** mean low score.

Interruptions are normal in Part 1 if you over-extend — not a penalty.

179.5 How Examiners Apply Band Descriptors (Not Linear)

Descriptors describe **performance level**, not error counts.

Myth: “Ten grammar mistakes = Band 6.”

Reality: Ten minor article slips in an otherwise Band 8 script may still be Band 8. One systematic tense failure throughout may cap Grammatical Range at Band 6.

Myth: “Using complex words = Band 9 Lexical Resource.”

Reality: Wrong collocations lower Lexical Resource regardless of word rarity.

Myth: “British accent required.”

Reality: Intelligibility and feature control matter; accent variety accepted globally.

179.6 Task Response: The Silent Score Killer

Many candidates lose marks before vocabulary or grammar are considered:

Task 2 failures: - Partial question answered (discuss both views but only one discussed)

- No clear position (discuss both sides essay with no synthesis)

- Bullet points in GT letter missed

- Task 1 Academic with no overview

- Task 1 with opinion when none requested

Examiner rule: Task Response caps overall Writing if seriously deficient — often at Band 5–6 regardless of language beauty.

Self-check: Underline every word in the question; tick each part addressed in your essay.

179.7 Reading and Listening: Key-Marker Logic

No human examiner in the room — but **key design** reflects same philosophy:

- **Spelling exactness** (unless alternatives listed)
- **Word limit compliance**
- **Synonym acceptance** pre-approved in key

- **NOT GIVEN discipline** — key distinguishes absence of information vs contradiction

Examiner-equivalent skill: Would the key writer accept your paraphrase? If unsure, evidence must be **explicit in text**.

179.8 Standardisation: What It Means for You

Examiners calibrate to **anchor scripts** at known bands. Your performance is compared to **descriptor definitions**, not to the previous candidate.

Implication: A “bad day” cohort does not lower your score. You are not graded on a curve.

Implication: Preparation must target **descriptor behaviours**, not local teacher preferences.

179.9 Self-Marking Protocol (Examiner Simulation)

Step 1: Mark Task Response first — be harsh on partial answers.

Step 2: Mark Coherence — read once without stopping; note confusion points.

Step 3: Mark Lexis — highlight wrong collocations and repetition.

Step 4: Mark Grammar — mark only errors that affect communication.

Step 5: Assign **four separate** band scores; overall Writing is **not** a simple average but holistic — weak Task Response pulls down heavily.

Use public descriptors from Chapter 3 and IELTS.org — quote evidence from your script for each band choice.

179.10 What Examiners Penalise vs Ignore

Penalise: - Memorised irrelevant chunks

- Illegible script
- Off-topic content
- Communication-breaking errors
- Template cohesion without logic
- Part 2 missing bullet points

Usually ignore (if isolated): - Single spelling slip on common word

- One mispronounced word with clear context
- Accent features that do not block understanding
- Brief hesitation with self-repair

179.11 Ethics and Red Lines

Examiners report suspected malpractice (memorised identical scripts, impersonation). **Do not:**

- Memorise entire model essays and force-fit
- Use pre-written Part 2 speeches unrelated to card

- Bring hidden notes

Band 9 preparation is **skill-based**, not **script-based**.

179.12 Examiner Mindset for Test Day

Before Listening/Reading: Precision and instruction compliance.

Before Writing: Task coverage and overview (Task 1).

Before Speaking: Communicate; do not perform accent or vocabulary circus.

Mantra: *Clarity, coverage, control.*

Worked Example: Examiner Annotation

Task 2 question: Discuss both views on banning cars from city centres. Give your opinion.

Candidate excerpt (abridged):

“Many people think cars should be banned. Cars cause pollution. However, cars are convenient. I think banning is good.”

Examiner notes:

Criterion	Evidence	Provisional band
Task Response	Both views mentioned but undeveloped; opinion stated but unsupported	5
Coherence	List-like; no paragraph development	5
Lexical Resource	Basic (<i>good, many people</i>); no topic precision	5
Grammar	Simple only; accurate but limited	6

Overall Writing likely ~5.5 — language accuracy cannot rescue thin task response.

Band 9 contrast (same task, one sentence):

“While **advocates of a ban cite** air-quality gains and **pedestrian safety**, **opponents stress** the **economic cost to suburban commuters** and **emergency services**; **on balance**, **phased restriction strikes a more pragmatic balance** than **outright prohibition**.”

Every criterion addressed in two sentences.

Common Candidate Myths vs Examiner Reality

Myth	Reality
Examiners want long essays	Quality and coverage; 280–320 words sufficient if developed
More linking words = higher score	Logical links only
Part 3 must agree with examiner	Content not scored; language is
Reading needs every word understood	Location and paraphrase suffice
Listening accent is always British	Multiple accents by design
Computer test easier/harder	Same standards, different delivery

Practice Exercises

Exercise 1: Descriptor Matching

Assign a criterion (TR/CC/LR/GRA) to each weakness:

1. Wrong collocation *strong rain*
2. No overview in Task 1
3. Paragraph 3 unrelated to thesis
4. Only present simple throughout

Exercise 2: Band Prediction

Read a practice essay (your own or Chapter 111). Assign four band scores with one sentence justification each.

Exercise 3: Task Audit

Take one Task 2 question. List every instruction element. Check a model answer against the list.

Exercise 4: First Impression

Rewrite only the first 40 words of an introduction to maximise examiner first impression.

Exercise 5: Speaking Simulation

Record 90 seconds Part 3. Listen once — note where an examiner might lose thread.

Examiner Insight Box

Senior examiners report that **Task Response** and **Coherence** distinguish Band 7 from Band 8 more often than isolated grammar errors. Band 9 candidates **sound like confident writers/speakers** who happen to be accurate — not like students performing grammar tricks.

Examiner Simulation Checklist (Test Day)

Writing: - ☐ Every question part addressed

- ☐ Overview present (Task 1)

- ☐ Paragraphs visible

- ☐ Word count adequate

- ☐ 3-minute proofread completed

Speaking: - ☐ Part 2 bullets covered

- ☐ Part 3 answers extended analytically

- ☐ Self-correction smooth, not disruptive

- ☐ Neutral examiner behaviour accepted mentally

Listening/Reading: - ☐ Instructions double-checked

- ☐ Spelling verified on transfer

- ☐ Evidence located for every answer

Extended Section: Four-Criteria Marking Simulation

Sample Task 2 excerpt (abridged):

"Some people think university should be free. I agree because education is important. Poor people cannot pay. Rich people can pay but free is better for society."

Criterion	Band	One-line justification
Task Response	5	Opinion present but undeveloped; ideas listed not extended
Coherence	5	No paragraph structure; abrupt jumps
Lexical Resource	5	Basic repetition (<i>people, pay, free</i>)
Grammar	6	Simple but mostly accurate

Overall Writing ~5.5 — language cannot rescue thin development.

Band 9 rewrite (same task, 3 sentences):

"While tuition fees **may deter** disadvantaged applicants, **fully subsidised** higher education **could promote** social mobility **and yield** long-term economic returns. **Admittedly**, fiscal constraints **limit** universal free access; **nevertheless, targeted** grants **often represent** a **more viable compromise** than **market-driven** fees. **On balance**, I support **substantially reduced** costs **rather than purely private financing**."

Extended Section: What Examiners Ignore vs Penalise (Expanded)

Usually ignored (isolated)

- One article slip (*a* vs *the*)
- One spelling error (*goverment*)
- Brief hesitation with self-repair (Speaking)
- L1 accent features that do not block understanding
- Using *data is* vs *data are* (variation accepted)

Always penalised

- Off-topic response
- Under word count significantly
- Missing overview (Task 1 Academic)

- Missing bullet points (GT letter, Speaking Part 2)
- Memorised unrelated template
- Communication-breaking grammar
- TFNG treated as Yes/No without reading instruction

Extended Section: Examiner Timeline (Writing, ~40 min script)

Minute	Examiner activity
0–1	Legibility, paragraphs, length impression
1–3	Task Response: question addressed?
3–8	Read full script; note cohesion and development
8–12	Assess lexis and grammar; confirm band per criterion
12+	Holistic check; assign four criteria + overall

Implication: Weak introduction hurts Task Response immediately. Strong body cannot fully recover if question ignored.

Extended Section: Speaking Examiner Script (Conceptual)

Part 1: Examiner follows question list; may interrupt extended answers to maintain pace — **not a penalty**.

Part 2: Examiner listens; minimal interruption unless time exceeded significantly.

Part 3: Examiner probes with follow-ups (*Why? In what way? How might that change?*) — depth test.

Neutral face: Standardised behaviour — **not** feedback on performance.

Extended Section: Self-Marking Rubric (Practice)

After each mock, assign **four bands** with **evidence quotes**:

Task Response: Band ____
 Evidence: "... " – [addresses / partial / off-topic]
 Coherence: Band ____

Evidence: paragraph structure / linker use

Lexical Resource: Band ____

Evidence: collocation accuracy / range

Grammar: Band ____

Evidence: error types / range

Holistic Writing band: Usually near **lowest** criterion if one criterion is weak; not mathematical average.

Extended Section: Myth-Busting Table (Expanded)

Myth	Reality	Source
Longer essay = higher band	Development beats length	Descriptors
British accent required	Intelligibility required	Speaking criteria
Examiners disagree randomly	Standardisation monitoring	IELTS.org
Template guarantees Band 7	Template abuse caps Coherence	Examiner training
Reading needs 100% comprehension	Strategic location suffices	Test design
All idioms boost Speaking	Natural use only	Lexical descriptors
Computer easier	Same standards	IDP/Cambridge
False easier than NG	Both need evidence discipline	Reading design

Extended Practice Bank

Exercise 6: Four-criteria mark

Mark a Chapter 111 comparison essay excerpt with four bands + evidence.

Exercise 7: Task Response audit

Underline every instruction word in three Task 2 questions; list required response elements.

Exercise 8: First impression

Rewrite weak introductions (provided) for three question types.

Exercise 9: Speaking depth

Turn one-word Part 3 answers into 30-second analytical responses.

Exercise 10: Myth or fact?

Explain why each myth in the table is false in one sentence.

Examiner Calibration Exercise

Read the following Task 2 introduction and assign four band scores:

“In today’s world, technology is very important and many people use it every day. Some people think it is good and some think it is bad. This essay will discuss both views and give my opinion.”

Criterion	Your band	Reason
Task Response		
Coherence		
Lexical Resource		
Grammar		

Sample examiner marking: - TR: 5 — vague paraphrase; thesis empty (*discuss both views*)

- CC: 5 — no clear paragraph preview; generic template

- LR: 5 — *very important, many people, good, bad*

- GRA: 6 — accurate simple sentences only

Improved Band 8+ introduction:

“Digital technology now permeates education, employment, and social interaction, prompting debate over whether its overall impact is beneficial. While proponents em-

phasise efficiency and connectivity, critics highlight privacy risks and social fragmentation; this essay examines both perspectives before arguing that balanced regulation—not prohibition—offers the most pragmatic response.”

Examiner Mindset Journal (Pre-Test)

Answer before test day:

1. What will I prioritise if time is short? (Task coverage > vocabulary show)
2. What will I **not** interpret as failure? (Neutral examiner face, one missed Listening answer)
3. What is my proofread order? (Task → paragraphs → spelling)
4. What memorised chunks will I **avoid**?

Summary

Thinking like an examiner means applying **public criteria with evidence**, not guessing preferences. Prioritise Task Response and logical cohesion before decorative language. First impressions matter in Writing layout and Speaking structure. Self-mark with four separate scores and harsh task coverage discipline. Band 9 is **communicative mastery under criteria** — train accordingly.

Final Examiner Principles (Review)

1. **Criteria, not feelings** — mark evidence against public descriptors.
2. **Task first** — Task Response caps overall Writing if deficient.
3. **First impression matters** — paragraphs, legibility, immediate engagement.
4. **Neutral ≠ negative** — Speaking examiner face is not feedback.
5. **Self-mark with four scores** — never one overall guess.
6. **Ignore myths** — accent, error counting, template guarantees.
7. **Clarity, coverage, control** — the Band 9 trilogy for test day.

Internalise these seven principles until they replace anxiety-driven behaviours (template stuffing, synonym cycling, panic on missed Listening answers). Examiner thinking is trainable — and it is one of the highest-return investments in your final preparation week.

Next: Chapter 180 — Time-Saving Methods

Chapter 180: Time-Saving Methods

Part: 10 — Band 9 Secrets

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Learning Objectives

By the end of this chapter, you will be able to:

- Allocate time across all four modules using Band 9-efficient schedules.
- Apply reading and listening shortcuts that preserve accuracy, not gamble.
- Use writing frameworks that reduce planning time while maintaining task coverage.
- Deploy speaking strategies that maximise score per minute of talk.
- Eliminate time-wasting habits that feel productive but lower scores.
- Build a personal time protocol for computer-delivered and paper-based tests.

Theory / Explanation

180.1 Time Is a Scoring Variable

IELTS does not reward unfinished tasks. A Band 9 linguistic performance left incomplete may score Band 5–6 on Task Response or leave Listening answers blank.

Principle: Time-saving methods must **protect criteria**, not skip steps examiners require (overview, bullet coverage, proofreading).

Band 9 candidates appear calm because they **automate** micro-decisions — where to look first, how long to plan, when to move on.

180.2 Master Timeline: Full Test Day

Module	Duration	Band 9 time philosophy
Listening	30 min (+ 10 transfer paper)	Never leave blank; predict answer type
Reading	60 min	20 min/passage strict; move on
Writing	60 min	Task 2 weighted; Task 1 overview non-negotiable
Speaking	11–14 min	Depth in Part 3; efficiency in Part 1

No module is isolated — fatigue from Reading affects Writing. Simulate full tests to build stamina.

180.3 Listening Time-Saving

Before Each Section

- Read questions **before** audio starts (CD) or during intro (paper).
- Underline **keywords** and predict **grammar class** (noun/number/adjective).
- Note word limits: *NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS*.

During Audio

- **Write answers immediately** — do not wait for replay unless lost.
- **Skip** and return only if section structure allows (rare).
- Use shorthand; expand in transfer time.

Transfer Time (Paper)

- **10 minutes** — prioritise spelling check on uncertain words.
- **Grammar check** on gap-fill (plural? verb form?).
- Never leave blank — guess from context.

Computer-Delivery Note

No separate transfer; type during audio. Practice **typing under pressure** — Band 9 candidates are not slow typists.

Time-saver: Build a personal **spelling hit-list** (Appendix A07) and drill weekly.

180.4 Reading Time-Saving

The 20-Minute Rule

Three passages, 60 minutes → **~20 minutes each**. Exceeding 22 minutes on Passage 1 jeopardises Passage 3 (hardest).

If stuck 90 seconds on one question → mark guess, move on.

Order of Operations (Per Passage)

1. **Skim title, intro, topic sentences** (60–90 sec) — grasp structure.
2. **Read questions first** — not full passage deep read.
3. **Locate** via keywords/synonyms — scan.
4. **Verify** answer in evidence sentence.
5. **Transfer** and next question.

Question-Type Shortcuts

Type	Time-saver
TFNG/YNNG	Find one decisive sentence; stop
Matching headings	Read first/last sentence per paragraph
Gap-fill summary	Predict grammar before searching
Multiple choice	Eliminate two quickly
Matching info	Use names/numbers as anchors

False Time-Savers (Avoid)

- Reading entire passage slowly first — rarely affordable.
- Translating every word — catastrophic for timing.
- Obsessing over one NOT GIVEN — mark and return if time.

Band 9 discipline: Accept **good enough** location speed; refine only if time remains.

180.5 Writing Time-Saving

Recommended Split (Paper and Computer)

Task	Time	Minutes breakdown
Task 1	20 min	Plan 3 → Write 14 → Check 3
Task 2	40 min	Plan 5 → Write 30 → Check 5

Never steal Task 2 time for Task 1 perfection — Task 2 is double the weight.

Task 1 Speed Framework (AC)

Minute 0–3 (Plan): - Identify chart type, time range, units

- Find **2–3 main trends** (overview content)
- Group details (by time or category)

Minute 3–17 (Write): - Paragraph 1: paraphrase + overview

- Paragraph 2–3: grouped details with figures
- Use **comparative language** templates (Appendix A12)

Minute 17–20 (Check): - Overview present?

- Data accurate?
- No opinion creep?

Task 2 Speed Framework

Minute 0–5 (Plan on question paper / scratch): - Underline instruction words (*discuss, agree, causes*)

- **Brainstorm 2 body ideas** (+ example each)
- Thesis one sentence
- Optional: topic sentence per paragraph

Minute 5–35 (Write): - Intro: paraphrase + thesis (3–4 sentences)

- Body 1: topic sentence → explain → example → link
- Body 2: same structure
- Conclusion: synthesise, no new ideas

Minute 35–40 (Check): - Every question part hit?

- Paragraph breaks clear?
- 3–5 grammar/spelling fixes only — not rewrite

GT Letter Speed

- **Circle** bullet points; tick each when written.

- Opening purpose sentence in first 20 words.
- One paragraph per bullet where possible.

180.6 Speaking Time-Saving

Speaking is not timed like Writing, but **efficiency** matters:

Part 1 (4–5 min): 2–4 sentences per answer — not monologue. Examiner has many questions.

Part 2 (3–4 min total): - Use **1 minute prep** to note **4–5 keywords**, not full sentences.

- Structure: beginning → each bullet → ending feeling.
- If running short, expand **one** anecdote; if long, wrap conclusion.

Part 3 (4–5 min): - **Answer directly first** (*Yes, to some extent*) — saves examiner impatience.

- Use **two-reason + example** template mentally.
- Buy 2 seconds: *That's an interesting question* — not 10 seconds.

Time-waster: Memorised 2-minute intro unrelated to cue card — examiner may interrupt.

180.7 Computer-Delivery Specific Saves

- **Highlight** question text in Reading.
- **Copy/paste** from question for headings matching (careful with typos).
- **Word count** visible — stop at 280+ Task 2, do not chase 350.
- **Keyboard shortcuts** practiced before test day.

180.8 The 80/20 Preparation Rule

80% of score gains from 20% of activities:

High yield	Low yield
Full timed mocks	Random untimed grammar exercises
Error log from mocks	10,000-word vocabulary lists
Task 2 planning drills	Memorising generic introductions
Listening spelling drill	Watching English movies without practice
Overview writing daily	Colour-highlighting entire textbooks

Band 9 candidates **simulate test conditions** weekly in final month.

180.9 Decision Trees Under Pressure

Reading: Stuck on One Question?

90 sec elapsed?

- YES: mark guess, continue
- NO: scan one more paragraph, then move

Writing: Running Out of Time?

5 min left, Task 2 body incomplete?

- Write short conclusion stating position
- Never leave Task 2 without conclusion

2 min left?

- Stop writing new ideas; fix clearest errors only

Listening: Missed an Answer?

Next question approaching?

- Let go; refocus immediately
- Do not panic-replay mentally

180.10 Physical and Cognitive Time Savers

- **Sleep** before test — fatigue slows Reading 15–20%.
- **Hydrate**; Speaking dry mouth breaks fluency.
- **Familiar venue timing** — arrive early, reduce cortisol.
- **Breathing** between modules — 4-4-4 box breath resets focus.

Worked Example: Task 2 Five-Minute Plan

Question: Some think universities should teach practical skills; others think academic knowledge is more important. Discuss both views and give your opinion.

Plan (examiner-acceptable speed):

Element	Notes (30 sec each)
View A (practical)	employability, vocational courses, industry links
View B (academic)	critical thinking, research, long-term adaptability
My opinion	balance — academic core + embedded practical modules
Body 1 TS	Practical skills directly enhance graduate employment.
Body 2 TS	Nevertheless , pure vocational training may limit intellectual breadth.
Example bank	nursing placements; engineering labs; vs narrow skill obsolescence
Conclusion	Universities should integrate both rather than privilege either

Total plan: **4 minutes**. Write from plan — no mid-essay brainstorming.

Common Time-Wasting Habits

1. **Perfect Task 1** — 30 minutes spent, Task 2 rushed.
2. **Rewriting introduction** three times.
3. **Reading Passage 1** twice fully.
4. **Part 2 memorised speech** — examiner interrupts, panic wastes time.
5. **Checking Listening during Section 4** — miss live answers.
6. **Untimed practice only** — no transfer to exam speed.

Practice Exercises

Exercise 1: Reading Sprint

Complete one passage in 18 minutes. Record score and guessing rate.

Exercise 2: Task 1 in 18 Minutes

Write full Task 1 response including overview. Self-mark overview in 30 seconds.

Exercise 3: Task 2 Plan Only

Five plans in 25 minutes (5 min each) for questions from Chapter 112.

Exercise 4: Part 2 Prep Drill

Ten cue cards: 1 minute notes only, then 90-second talk. Time with stopwatch.

Exercise 5: Full Mock

One complete test under exam conditions. Log time per section and unfinished items.

Examiner Insight Box

Examiners **cannot see** your time struggle — only the product. An incomplete Task 2 with Band 9 language may still fail Task Response. **Finished beats brilliant.**

Candidates who plan **5 minutes** often write faster than those who start immediately and stall mid-paragraph.

Personal Time Protocol Template

Fill before test day:

Module	My target split	Move-on trigger	Emergency rule
Listening		miss 1 Q → continue	guess all blanks
Reading P1/P2/P3	/ /	90 sec stuck	circle and skip
Writing T1/T2	/	T1 at 20 min sharp	conclusion priority
Speaking P2	1 min notes	low on time → bullet 4	wrap with feeling

Extended Section: Module Time Budgets (Detailed)

Listening (30 min + 10 transfer paper)

Section	Difficulty	Suggested focus
1	Easier	Build confidence; full marks target
2	Medium	Map/plan labelling — preposition prep
3	Medium-hard	Academic discussion — multiple speakers
4	Hardest	Lecture — dense vocabulary; stay focused

Transfer priority order: Sections 4 → 3 → 2 → 1 (hardest spelling first while memory fresh).

Reading (60 min)

Passage	Typical position	Strategy
1	Most accessible	17–18 min; bank easy marks
2	Medium	19–20 min
3	Longest/hardest	20–22 min; accept strategic guesses

Writing (60 min)

Block	Minutes	Non-negotiable output
Task 1 plan	3	Overview bullets
Task 1 write	14	160–180 words
Task 1 check	3	Overview present
Task 2 plan	5	Thesis + 2 body ideas
Task 2 write	30	260–300 words
Task 2 check	5	Conclusion + task coverage

Extended Section: Speed Without Sacrifice — Reading Tactics

Keyword mutation prediction: If question says *cost*, scan for *price, fee, expense, affordable, funding*.

Name/number anchoring: Match proper nouns first — fastest route to location.

Parallel structure in summaries: Gap grammar (article, plural) eliminates wrong answers before search.

NOT GIVEN speed rule: If no locatable span after two paragraphs, mark NG and move — do not hunt entire passage.

Extended Section: Writing Speed — Sentence Templates (Internalised)

Internalise until automatic (then vary):

Task 2 topic sentence: *One compelling argument for X is that...*

Task 2 example: *This is illustrated by the case of...*

Task 2 concession: *Admittedly, X has merit; nevertheless,...*

Task 1 comparison: *In contrast to A, B experienced...*

Task 1 data intro: *The figure for X stood at...*

Speed gain: 5–7 minutes per essay when templates are automatic and content-filled.

Extended Section: Speaking Time Efficiency

Part 1 — 20-second rule: Aim for 20–40 seconds per answer. Examiner has ~12 questions in ~4 minutes.

Part 2 — Bullet timing: ~20 seconds per bullet × 4 = 80 seconds; leaves margin for intro/outro.

Part 3 — 45-second rule: Most answers 45–90 seconds; longer only if examiner prompts.

Buy-time phrases (2–3 sec only): - *That's an interesting question.*

- *I've never thought about that before.*

- *Let me see...*

Extended Section: Computer vs Paper Time Differences

Factor	Paper	Computer
Listening transfer	+10 min	During audio
Writing speed	Hand fatigue	Typing skill matters
Word count	Manual estimate	On-screen counter
Reading highlight	Pen only	Digital highlight
Review answers	Flip pages	Scroll — know navigation

CD advantage: Editing Writing easier.

Paper advantage: Skimming physical text intuitive for some.

Extended Section: Fatigue Management (Full Test Day)

After module	2-min reset
Listening	Box breathing; ignore last missed answer
Reading	Close eyes; hydrate
Writing	Shake hands; review time split card
Before Speaking	Vocal warm-up; slow speech slightly

Extended Practice Bank

Exercise 6: 18-minute Reading sprint

One passage; log score and time.

Exercise 7: Task 1 in 18 minutes

Full response with overview.

Exercise 8: Five plans in 25 minutes

Task 2 questions only — no writing.

Exercise 9: Listening Section 4 focus

One Section 4 audio; target $\geq 8/10$.

Exercise 10: Full mock debrief

Log: time per section, unfinished items, top three time leaks.

Personal Time Protocol (Fill In)

Module	Target time	Move-on trigger	Emergency action
Listening S4		miss 2 in row	refocus next section
Reading P3	20 min	90 sec stuck	guess
Writing T1	20 min	min 18	ensure overview
Writing T2	40 min	min 35	write conclusion
Speaking P2	2 min talk	short on bullet 4	summarise feeling

One-Week Intensive Time-Training Schedule

Day	AM (45 min)	PM (45 min)
Mon	Reading P1 timed 18 min	Task 2 plan $\times 3$
Tue	Reading P2 timed 19 min	Task 1 full 18 min
Wed	Listening full test	Task 2 full 38 min
Thu	Reading P3 timed 20 min	Speaking Part 2 $\times 3$
Fri	Reading full 58 min	Writing full 58 min
Sat	Full mock	Error log
Sun	Review A09, A11	Rest

Repeat this cycle twice in the final month before your test date.

Summary

Band 9 time management is **ruthless prioritisation**: overview and task coverage before polish; 20-minute reading passages; guess and move rather than stall; plan Task 2 before writing. Eliminate false time-savers (full passage translation, memorised speeches). Simulate full tests, build decision trees, and protect Task 2 time. Speed serves accuracy when automated through practice — see Appendices A09 (checklists) and A11 (cheat sheets) for printable protocols.

Final Time Principles (Review)

1. **Finished beats brilliant** — incomplete Task 2 caps Task Response harshly.
2. **20-minute Reading passages** — strict move-on discipline.
3. **Plan before write** — 5 minutes saves 15 minutes of mid-essay stalling.
4. **Overview non-negotiable** — Task 1 Band 7+ requires it.
5. **Guess and move** — blank answers guarantee zero marks.
6. **Task 2 time protected** — never borrow from Task 2 for Task 1 polish.
7. **Simulate full tests** — untimed practice does not build time instincts.

Print Appendix A09 checklists and A11 cheat sheets. Execute your personal time protocol on every mock until behaviour is automatic. Band 9 candidates appear calm because they decided in advance what to sacrifice and what to protect.

End of Part 10 — Band 9 Secrets

Appendix A01: Grammar Reference

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Ultimate IELTS Mastery — Quick Reference

How to Use This Appendix

Cross-reference with **Part 2 (Chapters 9–43)** for full teaching sections. This appendix provides **at-a-glance rules, common IELTS patterns, and error alerts** for test-day revision.

1. Sentence Types

Type	Structure	IELTS use
Simple	One independent clause	Emphasis, clarity
Compound	Two independent clauses + coordinator (and, but, so)	Balanced statements
Complex	Independent + dependent clause	Argument, condition, concession
Compound-complex	Two+ independent + one+ dependent	Band 8+ variety (controlled)

2. Clauses

Noun Clauses

- *What matters is access to education.*
- *It is clear that policy must change.*
- *Whether funding increases depends on political will.*

Adjective (Relative) Clauses

- Defining: *Students **who study abroad** gain confidence.*
- Non-defining: *My hometown, **which is coastal**, relies on tourism.*

Reduced relatives: *The policy **introduced last year**...* (= which was introduced)

Adverb Clauses

Function	Conjunctions
Time	when, while, before, after, until, since
Reason	because, since, as
Contrast	although, though, whereas, while
Condition	if, unless, provided that, as long as
Purpose	so that, in order to
Result	so...that, such...that

3. Tenses — IELTS Selection Guide

Tense	When to use	Example
Present simple	Facts, habits, processes	<i>Renewables account for 30%.</i>
Present continuous	Trends changing now	<i>Urban populations are rising.</i>
Present perfect	Past → present relevance	<i>Technology has transformed work.</i>
Present perfect continuous	Duration to now	<i>Governments have been investing for decades.</i>
Past simple	Finished past (Task 1 data)	<i>Sales rose in 2010.</i>
Past continuous	Background past	<i>While exports were falling, imports grew.</i>
Past perfect	Earlier past (Task 1)	<i>By 2015, output had doubled.</i>
Future (will/going to)	Predictions, plans	<i>Demand will increase.</i>

Task 1 rule: Match tense to chart time frame. Future dates → future or projected language (*is expected to*).

4. Conditionals

Type	Form	Example
Zero	If + present, present	<i>If water freezes, it expands.</i>
First	If + present, will	<i>If funding rises, outcomes will improve.</i>
Second	If + past, would	<i>If cities banned cars, pollution would fall.</i>
Third	If + past perfect, would have	<i>If they had acted, damage would have been limited.</i>
Mixed	If + past perfect, would + base	<i>If they had invested earlier, cities would be cleaner today.</i>

Inverted (formal): *Had they acted... / Were it implemented... / Should you need...*

5. Modal Verbs — Nuance

Modal	Meaning	IELTS example
can/could	ability, possibility	<i>Renewables could replace coal.</i>
may/might	possibility (weaker)	<i>Policy may face resistance.</i>
must	strong obligation / deduction	<i>Governments must address inequality.</i>
should/ought to	recommendation	<i>Schools should teach digital literacy.</i>
would	hypothetical	<i>Many would prefer flexible hours.</i>
need to / have to	necessity	<i>Candidates must follow instructions.</i>

Avoid: *would* in both clauses of first conditional (If X *would*...).

6. Passive Voice

Form: be + past participle

- *Measures **were implemented**.*
- *The survey **was conducted** in 2023.*

Agent optional when obvious or unimportant: - *Crime **was reduced** by 15%.* (agent less important) - *The report **was published** by the WHO.*

IELTS: Academic Writing favours passive for impersonal tone; do not overuse.

7. Reported Speech

Direct	Reported
Present simple → past simple	<i>He said that technology was essential.</i>
Present perfect → past perfect	<i>She claimed that sales had risen.</i>
will → would	<i>Experts predicted that demand would grow.</i>
can → could	<i>Officials stated that access could improve.</i>

Reporting verbs: claim, argue, suggest, maintain, acknowledge, warn, estimate

8. Articles (a / an / the / zero)

Rule	Example
First mention	<i>a policy</i> → later <i>the policy</i>
Unique / known	<i>the government, the internet</i>
General plural/uncountable (zero)	<i>Education is vital. / Policies vary.</i>
Academic subjects (zero)	<i>Technology transforms society.</i>
Countries (most zero)	<i>in Japan; the UK, the USA</i>

Common errors: a advice, the education (general concept), a research

9. Prepositions — High-Frequency

Pattern	Correct
depend on	depend of
interested in	
responsible for	
result in / from	
invest in	
rise in / rise by (% change)	
increase from X to Y	
different from (BrE) / than (AmE)	IELTS accepts both in many contexts

10. Countable vs Uncountable

Uncountable (no plural)	Countable alternative
information	a piece of information
research	a study / a research project
evidence	a piece of evidence
advice	a piece of advice
furniture	a piece of furniture
traffic	traffic jams (countable events)

11. Parallelism

Lists and comparisons must match form:

- *to reduce, to improve, and to stimulate* (infinitives)
- *not only economic but also environmental* (adjectives)
- *Governments should fund, regulate, and monitor.* (verbs)

12. Punctuation Essentials

Mark	Use	IELTS alert
Comma	Lists, after adverb openers, non-defining clauses	Comma splice error
Semicolon	Link related independent clauses	Rare but Band 8+
Colon	Introduce list or explanation	Before examples
Apostrophe	Possession, contractions	Contractions informal in Task 2
Hyphen	Compound adjectives	<i>well-known, long-term</i>

Comma splice (wrong): *Technology is useful, it saves time.*

Fix: *Technology is useful **because** it saves time.* OR *Technology is useful; **it** saves time.*

13. Subject–Verb Agreement

- *The number of students **has** increased.* (subject = number)
 - *A number of students **have** complained.* (subject = students)
 - *Data **are** collected* (formal plural) / *Data **is** collected* (increasingly accepted)
 - *Each of the policies **is** controversial.*
-

14. Participle Clauses

Present participle (-ing): *Working remotely, employees save commuting time.*

Past participle (-ed): *Located in the north, the city receives more rain.*

Perfect participle: *Having finished the survey, researchers analysed results.*

Dangling participle error: subject of participle must match main clause subject.

15. Question Tags

- Positive statement → negative tag: *It's difficult, **isn't it?***
- Negative statement → positive tag: *They won't agree, **will they?***

Speaking: tags add naturalness. Writing Task 2: avoid.

16. Common IELTS Error Summary

Error	Correction
Although... but...	Use one only
More better	much better
Peoples (plural of people)	people
Informations	information
Do a mistake	make a mistake
Discuss about	discuss
The both sides	both sides

17. Grammar Range Targets by Band

Band	Typical range
6	Mix of simple + some complex; errors frequent but meaning clear
7	Frequent error-free sentences; variety attempted
8	Wide range; majority error-free
9	Full range; rare slips; natural complexity

See Part 2 for full chapters. See Appendix A09 for grammar checklists.

Appendix A02: Vocabulary Dictionary Index

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Ultimate IELTS Mastery — Topic Module Index

How to Use This Index

Part 3 (Chapters 44–70) contains **full topic vocabulary modules** with definitions, collocations, example sentences, and practice. This appendix indexes all topic chapters with **usage notes** for quick reference during revision.

File path pattern: `book/part03_vocabulary/ch##_topic.md`

Learning System (Chapter 44)

Ch	Topic	File	Usage notes
44	How to Learn IELTS Vocabulary	ch44_vocab_system.md	Start here: spaced repetition, collocation notebooks, topic rotation

Topic Modules A–Z

A

Ch	Topic	Key lexis	Writing/Speaking focus
55	Agriculture	crop yield, irrigation, subsistence farming, agribusiness, food security	Task 2: rural development, sustainability
58	Artificial Intelligence	algorithm, automation, machine learning, ethical AI, displacement	High-frequency modern topic; precise tech vocabulary
69	Academic Word List Core	analyse, concept, establish, significant, vary (+ families)	Cross-topic academic backbone; see also A06

B

Ch	Topic	Key lexis	Writing/Speaking focus
48	Business	entrepreneur, merger, profit margin, startup, competitiveness	Task 2: economy, employment; GT formal letters

C

Ch	Topic	Key lexis	Writing/Speaking focus
54	Climate	emissions, carbon footprint, renewable, mitigation, global warming	Pair with Environment (47); trend vocabulary for Task 1
50	Crime & Justice	offender, deterrent, rehabilitation, incarceration, recidivism	Cause/solution essays; formal register
65	Culture	heritage, assimilation, multiculturalism, tradition, identity	Discussion essays; Speaking Part 3
70	Collocations	(cross-topic frames)	Essential — use daily; supports all modules

E

Ch	Topic	Key lexis	Writing/Speaking focus
45	Education	curriculum, literacy, vocational, attainment, tuition	Most common IELTS theme
56	Economy	GDP, inflation, austerity, workforce, productivity	Link to Business (48), Employment
47	Environment	biodiversity, conservation, pollution, sustainable, ecosystem	Pair with Climate (54)
66	Ethics	moral obligation, accountability, transparency, integrity	Abstract Part 3; argument essays

F

Ch	Topic	Key lexis	Writing/Speaking focus
64	Family	nuclear family, up-bringing, single-parent, dependency, caregiver	Speaking Part 1–3; social policy essays

G

Ch	Topic	Key lexis	Writing/Speaking focus
49	Government	legislation, bureaucracy, sovereignty, public sector, mandate	Policy essays; passive voice contexts
67	Globalization	interdependence, outsourcing, trade liberalization, homogenization	Discussion both-views format

H

Ch	Topic	Key lexis	Writing/Speaking focus
52	Health	preventive care, sedentary lifestyle, mental health, obesity, wellbeing	Very high frequency
53	Medicine	diagnosis, vaccination, clinical trial, epidemic, treatment	Post-pandemic relevance; formal lexis

L

Ch	Topic	Key lexis	Writing/Speaking focus
61	Law	legislation, jurisdiction, plaintiff, enforce, constitutional	Formal register; avoid informal crime words

M

Ch	Topic	Key lexis	Writing/Speaking focus
62	Media	censorship, misin-formation, broadcast, sensationalism, digital platform	Free speech essays; modern relevance

P

Ch	Topic	Key lexis	Writing/Speaking focus
60	Psychology	cognitive, behaviour, motivation, percep-tion, resilience	Education/health crossover

S

Ch	Topic	Key lexis	Writing/Speaking focus
59	Science	hypothesis, empiric-al, peer review, in-novation, reproduc-ibility	Academic tone model
51	Society	demographic, in-equality, urbanisa-tion, welfare, cohe-sion	Broad; links many modules

T

Ch	Topic	Key lexis	Writing/Speaking focus
46	Technology	digital literacy, connectivity, surveillance, innovation, automation	Overlaps AI (58); Task 1 processes
63	Transportation	infrastructure, congestion, public transit, commute, freight	Urban policy; cause/solution
57	Tourism	hospitality, eco-tourism, heritage site, seasonal demand, visitor impact	Local economy arguments

U

Ch	Topic	Key lexis	Writing/Speaking focus
68	Urbanization	metropolitan, sprawl, gentrification, housing affordability, density	Pair with Transportation (63), Society (51)

Cross-Topic Clusters (Study Together)

Cluster	Chapters	Typical essay angle
Environment & climate	47, 54, 55	Sustainability, policy, agriculture
Economy & work	48, 56, 58	Automation, jobs, globalisation
Society & urban life	51, 63, 64, 68	Cities, family, inequality
Health & science	52, 53, 59, 60	Public health, research funding
Governance & law	49, 50, 61, 66	Crime, ethics, regulation
Education & culture	45, 65, 46	Curriculum, technology in schools
Media & communication	62, 46, 58	Misinformation, AI, platforms

Usage Notes by Skill

Writing Task 2

- Prioritise **collocations** from Ch 70 + AWL from Ch 69/A06
- Import **3–4 topic-specific items** per paragraph maximum
- Avoid mixing registers (e.g. *kids* + *legislation* without reason)

Writing Task 1

- Trend verbs: rise, fall, fluctuate, plateau, peak (see A12)
- Topic nouns from Environment/Economy when describing charts about those themes

Speaking

- Part 1: lighter lexis from Family, Health, Culture, Education
- Part 3: abstract nouns from Ethics, Government, Globalization, Society

Reading & Listening

- Build **paraphrase pairs** while studying each module
- Note spelling of AWL items — frequent in gap-fill

Alphabetical Quick Lookup (Lemma → Chapter)

Word/Theme	Chapter
agriculture, farming	55
AI, automation	58
business, commerce	48
climate, emissions	54
collocations	70
crime, justice	50
culture, tradition	65
economy, GDP	56
education, schools	45
environment, pollution	47
ethics, morality	66
family, parenting	64
globalisation	67
government, policy	49
health, wellbeing	52
law, legal	61
media, news	62
medicine, healthcare	53
psychology	60
science, research	59
society, inequality	51
technology, digital	46
tourism, travel	57
transport, traffic	63
urbanisation, cities	68
vocabulary learning	44
AWL core	69

Revision Protocol

1. **Week 1–4:** One topic module per day (Ch 45–68) + 10 collocations from Ch 70
 2. **Week 5–6:** AWL families (Ch 69 + A06) + weak-topic review
 3. **Pre-test:** Scan this index; drill 3 weakest clusters
 4. **Maintain:** One essay per cluster using only that module's lexis
-

Full definitions and examples are in Part 3 chapter files. See Appendix A06 for AWL expansion and A13 for terminology glossary.

Appendix A03: Irregular Verbs

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Ultimate IELTS Mastery — Comprehensive Reference with Examples

How to Use This List

Columns: **Base (V1)** | **Past Simple (V2)** | **Past Participle (V3)** | **Example sentence (IELTS context)**

Irregular verbs appear in **Listening gap-fill**, **Writing Task 1** (past data), **Speaking** (narratives), and **Reading** paraphrase. Drill V2 and V3 separately — they often differ.

Group A: Same Form (V1 = V2 = V3)

V1	V2	V3	Example
bet	bet	bet	Governments bet on renewables; many have bet heavily since 2010.
burst	burst	burst	Demand burst beyond capacity after the policy launch.
cost	cost	cost	The project cost millions; it has cost more than estimated.
cut	cut	cut	Funding was cut by 15% between 2018 and 2020.
hit	hit	hit	Unemployment hit a peak of 12% in 2019.
hurt	hurt	hurt	Recession hurt small businesses disproportionately.
let	let	let	The reform let firms compete more freely.
put	put	put	Authorities put new regulations in place.
set	set	set	The survey set a baseline for future comparison.
shut	shut	shut	Rural clinics shut due to lack of staff.
split	split	split	Investment split evenly between sectors.

Group B: V2 = V3 (Different from V1)

V1	V2	V3	Example
bend	bent	bent	Rules were bent to accommodate local needs.
bleed	bled	bled	Public services bled resources for years.
breed	bred	bred	Fish were bred in controlled conditions.
bring	brought	brought	Tourism brought economic benefits to the region.
build	built	built	Housing was built on former industrial land.
burn	burnt/burned	burnt/burned	Fossil fuels burnt more cleanly after up-grade.
buy	bought	bought	Consumers bought more online during the pandemic.
catch	caught	caught	Many students caught up through on-line courses.
choose	chose	chosen	Participants chose flexible study options.
cling	clung	clung	Traditional practices clung to rural communities.
creep	crept	crept	Costs crept up unnoticed over the decade.
deal	dealt	dealt	Authorities dealt with congestion through tolls.
dig	dug	dug	Archaeologists dug near the heritage site.
dream	dreamt/dreamed	dreamt/dreamed	Many dreamed of urban mobility reform.
feed	fed	fed	Aid programmes fed millions during the crisis.
feel	felt	felt	Residents felt excluded from planning decisions.
fight	fought	fought	Activists fought for cleaner air standards.
find	found	found	

V1	V2	V3	Example
			Research found a correlation between income and health.
flee	fled	fled	Populations fled conflict-affected areas.
fling	flung	flung	Governments flung resources at short-term fixes.
get	got	got/gotten (AmE)	Enrollment got harder as demand rose.
grind	ground	ground	Poverty ground down community resilience.
hang	hung	hung	Charts hung on the trend of gradual decline.
have	had	had	The region had already invested in rail.
hear	heard	heard	Citizens heard little from officials.
hold	held	held	Elections were held amid widespread debate.
keep	kept	kept	Rates kept rising until mid-2019.
lay	laid	laid	Foundations were laid for a new policy framework.
lead	led	led	Innovation led to productivity gains.
lean	leant/leaned	leant/leaned	The economy leant heavily on tourism.
leap	leapt/leaped	leapt/leaped	Costs leapt after deregulation.
learn	learnt/learned	learnt/learned	Students learnt practical skills on placement.
leave	left	left	Graduates left for larger cities.
lend	lent	lent	Banks lent less during the downturn.
light	lit/lighted	lit/lighted	Streets were lit by solar panels.
lose	lost	lost	The sector lost 20,000 jobs.
make	made	made	Policy made access more equitable.
mean	meant	meant	The reform meant stricter compliance.
meet	met	met	Targets were met ahead of schedule.

V1	V2	V3	Example
pay	paid	paid	Households paid more for energy.
say	said	said	Critics said the plan lacked detail.
sell	sold	sold	Electric vehicles sold in record numbers.
send	sent	sent	Samples were sent to regional labs.
shine	shone/shined	shone/shined	Performance shone in the export sector.
shoot	shot	shot	Production shot up in Q3.
sit	sat	sat	The committee sat for three months.
sleep	slept	slept	Shift workers slept poorly, studies found.
slide	slid	slid	Confidence slid during the recession.
speed	sped/speeded	sped/speeded	Adoption sped up after subsidies.
spend	spent	spent	Governments spent less on culture.
spin	spun	spun	Media spun the data differently.
stand	stood	stood	Output stood at 4 million units.
stick	stuck	stuck	Old habits stuck despite training.
sting	stung	stung	Inflation stung low-income families.
strike	struck	struck	Disaster struck coastal communities.
sweep	swept	swept	Reform swept through the public sector.
swing	swung	swung	Opinion swung toward stricter regulation.
teach	taught	taught	Staff taught remotely for two terms.
tell	told	told	Reports told a consistent story.
think	thought	thought	Planners thought demand would plateau.
understand	understood	understood	Few understood the long-term risk.
win	won	won	Renewable firms won major contracts.
wind	wound	wound	The programme wound down in 2022.

Group C: V1 = V2 ≠ V3

V1	V2	V3	Example
become	became	become	Cities became denser over twenty years.
come	came	come	Migration has come under tighter control.
run	ran	run	The pilot ran for six months.

Group D: All Three Different (High Priority for IELTS)

V1	V2	V3	Example
arise	arose	arisen	New challenges have arisen from automation.
be	was/were	been	Enrollment has been rising steadily.
bear	bore	borne/born	Costs were borne by taxpayers.
beat	beat	beaten	Competition beat forecasts.
begin	began	begun	Recovery had begun before funding ended.
blow	blew	blown	Funding was blown on short-term projects.
break	broke	broken	Trust was broken by repeated scandals.
draw	drew	drawn	Samples were drawn from five regions.
drink	drank	drunk	Consumption drank deep into reserves (figurative rare).
drive	drove	driven	Growth was driven by exports.
eat	ate	eaten	Resources were eaten up by bureaucracy.
fall	fell	fallen	Output has fallen to a ten-year low.
fly	flew	flown	Passengers flew less during restrictions.
forget	forgot	forgotten	Lessons were forgotten within a decade.
forgive	forgave	forgiven	Debts were forgiven under the scheme.
freeze	froze	frozen	Investment froze amid uncertainty.
give	gave	given	Grants were given to rural clinics.
go	went	gone	Funding has gone toward digital infrastructure.
grow	grew	grown	The sector has grown rapidly.
hide	hid	hidden	Costs were hidden in supplementary fees.
know	knew	known	Effects were known beforehand.
lie (recline)	lay	lain	The issue has lain dormant for years.

V1	V2	V3	Example
lie (tell untruth)	lied	lied	Officials lied about the scale of pollution.
ride	rode	ridden	Cycling has ridden a wave of popularity.
ring	rang	rung	Alarm rang about housing shortages.
rise	rose	risen	Prices have risen sharply.
see	saw	seen	Trends have been seen across sectors.
shake	shook	shaken	Markets were shaken by the announcement.
show	showed	shown/showed	Data has shown consistent improvement.
sing	sang	sung	Campaigns sang the benefits of reform.
sink	sank/sunk	sunk/sunken	Investment sank after policy reversal.
speak	spoke	spoken	Residents spoke at public hearings.
steal	stole	stolen	Data was stolen in the breach.
swim	swam	swum	Funding swam against the tide of cuts.
take	took	taken	Measures were taken to reduce emissions.
tear	tore	torn	Communities were torn by the dispute.
throw	threw	thrown	Resources were thrown at the problem.
wake	woke/waked	woken/waked	Awareness woke after the report.
wear	wore	worn	Infrastructure was worn by underinvestment.
write	wrote	written	Guidelines were written in unclear language.

Listening Spelling Alert List

These cause frequent lost marks in Listening:

Verb	Common misspelling
occurred	oecured
referred	referred
began	begun (wrong tense)
paid	payed
built	builded
brought	bringed
chosen	choosed
driven	drived
fallen	falled
risen	rised
written	writed

Task 1 Trend Verbs (Regular + Irregular)

Verb	Past	Past participle	Task 1 use
rise	rose	risen	Upward trend
fall	fell	fallen	Downward trend
grow	grew	grown	Increase
decline	declined	declined	Decrease (regular)
increase	increased	increased	Regular
decrease	decreased	decreased	Regular
fluctuate	fluctuated	fluctuated	Regular
remain	remained	remained	Stable
peak	peaked	peaked	Regular
drop	dropped	dropped	Regular

Practise with Appendix A10 revision sheets. See Part 2 Chapter 35 for past simple teaching.

Appendix A04: Phrasal Verbs for Academic IELTS

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Ultimate IELTS Mastery — 100+ Academic-Useful Phrasal Verbs

How to Use This List

Phrasal verbs are **acceptable in IELTS** when register-appropriate. Speaking (especially Parts 1–3) welcomes natural phrasal verbs. Writing Task 2 prefers **formal one-word equivalents** where they exist — but accurate phrasal verbs are **not penalised**.

Format: Phrasal verb | Meaning | Register | Example sentence

A

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
account for	explain / constitute	Academic	Renewables account for 40% of supply.
add up to	total / mean	Neutral	Delays add up to significant cost.
adhere to	follow (rules)	Formal	Firms must adhere to safety standards.
aim at	target	Neutral	Policy aims at reducing inequality.
allow for	take into account	Academic	Forecasts allow for seasonal variation.
apply for	request formally	Neutral	Graduates apply for research grants.
arrive at	reach (decision/conclusion)	Academic	The team arrived at a consensus.

B

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
back up	support with evidence	Neutral	Claims must be backed up by data.
boil down to	be essentially	Neutral-S	The issue boils down to funding.
break down	divide / stop working	Neutral	Figures break down by age group.
bring about	cause	Formal	Reform brought about lasting change.
bring up	raise (topic/child)	Neutral	Reports bring up ethical concerns.
build on	develop from	Academic	New policy builds on earlier trials.
build up	accumulate	Neutral	Traffic builds up at peak hours.

C

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
call for	demand	Academic	Experts call for stricter regulation.
carry out	conduct	Academic	Researchers carried out a survey.
catch up	reach same level	Neutral	Rural schools caught up slowly.
check in	register arrival	Neutral	Patients check in digitally now.
come across	find by chance	Neutral	I came across an interesting study.
come up with	devise	Neutral	Teams come up with innovative solutions.
cut back on	reduce	Neutral	Budgets were cut back on culture.
cut down on	reduce consumption	Neutral	Campaigns urge us to cut down on waste.

D

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
deal with	handle / address	Academic	Laws deal with data privacy.
die down	become less intense	Neutral	Protest died down after talks.
do away with	abolish	Formal	Some want to do away with tuition fees.
draw on	use as resource	Academic	The essay draws on recent evidence.
draw up	prepare (document)	Formal	Officials drew up a new framework.
drop out	leave (education)	Neutral	Many drop out due to cost.

E

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
embark on	begin (major)	Formal	The city embarked on a rail project.
end up	finally be/do	Neutral	Poor planning ends up costing more.
engage in	participate in	Academic	Students engage in community work.
even out	become equal	Neutral	Disparities evened out over time.

F

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
face up to	accept and confront	Neutral	Governments must face up to ageing populations.
fall behind	lag	Neutral	Regions fell behind on digital access.
figure out	understand/solve	Informal-N	Analysts figured out the trend cause.
fill in	complete (form)	Neutral	Candidates fill in application forms.
find out	discover	Neutral	Studies found out little was enforced.
focus on	concentrate	Academic	Policy should focus on prevention.
follow up	pursue further	Neutral	Clinics follow up with patients.

G

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
get across	communicate clearly	Neutral	Speakers must get their message across .
get by	manage financially	Neutral	Families get by on low wages.
get rid of	eliminate	Neutral	Cities want to get rid of diesel buses.
give rise to	cause	Formal	Inequality gives rise to social tension.
go ahead	proceed	Neutral	The project went ahead despite protests.
go through	experience / examine	Neutral	Bills go through parliament slowly.

H

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
hand in	submit	Neutral	Essays must be handed in on time.
hand out	distribute	Neutral	Aid was handed out locally.
hold back	restrict progress	Neutral	Lack of skills holds back growth.
keep up with	match pace	Neutral	Schools struggle to keep up with tech.

I

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
iron out	resolve (problems)	Neutral	Negotiators ironed out differences.

K

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
kick in	begin to take effect	Neutral	Subsidies kicked in last quarter.

L

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
lead to	result in	Academic	Pollution leads to health costs.
leave out	omit	Neutral	Reports left out rural data.
line up with	align with	Neutral	Results line up with predictions.
live up to	meet expectations	Neutral	Reform failed to live up to promises.
look after	care for	Neutral	Families look after elderly relatives.
look into	investigate	Neutral	Authorities look into complaints.
look up to	admire	Neutral	Youth look up to local mentors.

M

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
make up	constitute / invent	Neutral	Women make up 60% of graduates.
make up for	compensate	Neutral	Gains made up for earlier losses.
mount up	accumulate	Neutral	Debt mounted up rapidly.

O

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
opt for	choose	Academic	Commuters opt for public transport.
opt out	choose not to participate	Academic	Parents opt out of standard tests.

P

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
pay off	yield results / re-pay	Neutral	Investment eventu-ally paid off .
phase in/out	introduce/with-draw gradually	Academic	Carbon taxes will be phased in slowly.
pick up	improve / collect	Neutral	Sales picked up in spring.
point out	highlight	Academic	The author points out a flaw.
put forward	propose	Academic	Experts put for-ward a new model.
put off	postpone / dis-courage	Neutral	Bad weather put off tourists.
put up with	tolerate	Neutral	Residents put up with noise.

R

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
rely on	depend on	Academic	Healthcare relies on skilled staff.
result in	cause	Academic	Delays resulted in higher costs.
rule out	eliminate possibil-ity	Academic	Fraud was ruled out early.
run out of	exhaust supply	Neutral	Cities ran out of ICU beds.

S

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
scale up	expand	Academic	Pilots were scaled up nationally.
set up	establish	Neutral	NGOs set up rural clinics.
settle down	become stable	Neutral	Migration settled down after reform.
show up	appear / arrive	Neutral	Disparities show up in the data.
slow down	reduce speed/rate	Neutral	Growth slowed down in 2023.
sort out	resolve	Neutral	Disputes were sorted out locally.
speak up	express opinion boldly	Neutral	Citizens spoke up at hearings.
stand for	represent	Neutral	GDP stands for gross domestic product.
stem from	originate from	Formal	Conflict stems from inequality.
stick to	maintain / adhere	Neutral	Stick to the word limit.
sum up	summarise	Academic	To sum up , evidence favours reform.

T

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
take on	accept responsibility	Neutral	Firms take on apprentices.
take over	assume control	Neutral	The state took over failing utilities.
talk over	discuss thoroughly	Neutral	Committees talked over the proposal.
tear down	demolish (literal/fig)	Neutral	Old barriers were torn down .
think over	consider carefully	Neutral	Policy was thought over for months.
turn down	reject / lower volume	Neutral	Funding was turned down twice.
turn into	become	Neutral	Farmland turned into suburbs.
turn out	prove to be	Neutral	Measures turned out effective.
turn to	seek help from	Neutral	Patients turn to private care.

W

Phrasal verb	Meaning	Register	Example
ward off	prevent	Formal	Vaccines ward off severe illness.
watch out for	be cautious of	Neutral	Watch out for misleading charts.
wipe out	destroy completely	Neutral	Floods wiped out crops.
work out	solve / exercise	Neutral	Planners worked out a compromise.

Writing Task 2: Formal Alternatives

Phrasal verb	Formal alternative
carry out	conduct
find out	discover / determine
set up	establish
put forward	propose
deal with	address
go up	increase
go down	decrease
look into	investigate
cut down on	reduce
get rid of	eliminate

Use alternatives in very formal essays; phrasal verbs remain valid if accurate.

Separable vs Inseparable

Separable: *hand in the essay / hand the essay in*

Inseparable: *rely on, result in, stem from* — object always follows particle

See Chapter 176 for register guidance. See Appendix A05 for idioms (more opaque than phrasal verbs).

Appendix A05: Idioms for IELTS

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Ultimate IELTS Mastery — IELTS-Safe Idioms + Warnings

Register Guide

Symbol	Meaning
✓	Safe for Speaking; often natural
⚠	Use sparingly; risk of cliché or overuse
✗	Avoid in IELTS (too informal, offensive, or confusing)
📝	Writing Task 2 — use formal equivalent instead

General & Opinion (Speaking)

Idiom	Meaning	Rating	Example
to be honest	frankly	✓	To be honest , I prefer smaller cities.
on the whole	generally	✓	On the whole , the policy worked.
by and large	mostly	✓	By and large , students adapted well.
as far as I'm concerned	in my view	✓	As far as I'm concerned , balance is key.
at the end of the day	ultimately	⚠	Overused globally; once per test max
in the long run	eventually	✓	In the long run , investment pays off.
once in a blue moon	rarely	✓	I visit the cinema once in a blue moon .
from time to time	occasionally	✓	We travel abroad from time to time .

Work, Study & Achievement

Idiom	Meaning	Rating	Example
burn the midnight oil	study / work late	✓	I burned the midnight oil before exams.
learn the ropes	learn basics	✓	Interns learn the ropes in week one.
get the hang of	become skilled	✓	I got the hang of academic writing slowly.
go the extra mile	make extra effort	✓	Good teachers go the extra mile .
call it a day	stop for the day	✓	After six essays, I called it a day .
behind the scenes	not public	✓	Behind the scenes , teams fix errors.
hit the books	study seriously	✓	I hit the books every weekend.
pass with flying colours	succeed easily	✓	She passed with flying colours .
a blessing in disguise	hidden benefit	✓	Failure was a blessing in disguise .
back to square one	restart from beginning	✓	Wrong data sent us back to square one .

People & Relationships

Idiom	Meaning	Rating	Example
down-to-earth	practical, humble	✓	My mentor is very down-to-earth .
a people person	sociable	✓	Sales roles suit people persons .
hit it off	become friends quickly	✓	We hit it off on the first day.
keep in touch	maintain contact	✓	I keep in touch with former colleagues.
get on well with	have good relations	✓	I get on well with my neighbours.
fair-weather friend	friend only in good times	⚠	Negative context; use carefully

Problems & Difficulty

Idiom	Meaning	Rating	Example
the tip of the iceberg	small visible part	✓	Reported cases are the tip of the iceberg .
a grey area	unclear rule	✓	Consent online is a grey area .
teething problems	early difficulties	✓	The app had teething problems .
a steep learning curve	hard to learn quickly	✓	PhD research has a steep learning curve .
the last straw	final unbearable event	⚠	Emotional; fine in personal narrative
out of the blue	unexpectedly	✓	Funding arrived out of the blue .

Success & Failure

Idiom	Meaning	Rating	Example
pay off	succeed after effort	✓	Years of practice paid off .
fall short	not reach target	✓	Output fell short of forecasts.
miss the mark	fail to achieve aim	⚠	prefer <i>fail to achieve objectives</i>
make a breakthrough	important discovery	✓	Researchers made a breakthrough .
set the bar high	establish high standard	✓	The school sets the bar high .

Money & Economy (Speaking Part 3 OK)

Idiom	Meaning	Rating	Example
break the bank	cost too much	✓	Renovation didn't break the bank .
tighten one's belt	reduce spending	✓	Households tightened their belts .
worth its weight in gold	extremely valuable	⚠	Slightly dramatic
money doesn't grow on trees	money is limited	⚠	Informal; Part 1 OK

Time & Change

Idiom	Meaning	Rating	Example
in the nick of time	just in time	✓	Aid arrived in the nick of time .
stand the test of time	remain valid	✓	The theory stood the test of time .
the ship has sailed	opportunity gone	⚠	Informal metaphor
turn over a new leaf	start fresh	✓	After failing, he turned over a new leaf .

Communication & Understanding

Idiom	Meaning	Rating	Example
get the message across	communicate clearly	✓	Charts must get the message across .
it rings a bell	sound familiar	✓	The name rings a bell .
spell it out	explain clearly	✓	Let me spell it out simply.
lost in translation	meaning changed	✓	Nuance was lost in translation .

Avoid in IELTS

Idiom	Reason
kick the bucket	Offensive euphemism for death
it's raining cats and dogs	Cliché; sounds rehearsed
every cloud has a silver lining	Empty in analytical answers
you can't judge a book by its cover	Overused; adds little content
bite the bullet	Often misused
ball is in your court	Business jargon; odd in many topics
piece of cake	Too informal for Writing
tons of / heaps of	Informal quantifiers
gonna, wanna, kinda	Non-standard
regional slang unknown internationally	Communication risk



Writing Task 2 Replacements

Idiom (Speaking)	Academic equivalent (Writing)
burst at the seams	experience severe overcrowding
get to the bottom of	investigate the root causes
miss the mark	fail to achieve stated objectives
pay off	yield measurable returns
tighten belts	reduce expenditure
tip of the iceberg	a small visible proportion
back to square one	return to the initial stage
in a nutshell	in summary / to summarise

Usage Rules (Band 9)

1. **Maximum 1–2 idioms per Speaking section** — natural embedding only
 2. **Zero forced idioms in Writing Task 2** — use academic phrases (Ch 176)
 3. **Never use idiom you cannot define** — misuse drops Lexical Resource
 4. **Prefer international idioms** over culture-specific ones
 5. **Part 3 favours analytical phrases** over colourful idioms
-

Quick Practice

Upgrade for Speaking: Add one safe idiom to: “I worked very hard and finally succeeded.”
→ “I **burned the midnight oil** for months, and in the end it really **paid off**.”

Downgrade for Writing: Replace idioms in: “The policy missed the mark and we went back to square one.”
→ “The policy **failed to achieve its objectives**, requiring a **return to initial planning stages**.”

See Chapter 176 for full teaching section. See Appendix A04 for phrasal verbs (less opaque).

Appendix A06: Academic Word List (AWL)

Expanded Families

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Ultimate IELTS Mastery — Coxhead AWL Sublist Coverage

About the AWL

The Academic Word List (Averil Coxhead, 2000) contains **570 word families** across **10 sublists**, ranked by frequency in academic corpora. This appendix expands **core families** for IELTS use. See Chapter 69 for introduction.

Study tip: Learn **word family** (noun, verb, adjective, adverb) + **one collocation** per family.

Sublist 1 (Most Frequent)

Family	Forms	Collocation	IELTS example
analyse	analysis (n), analytical (adj), analytically (adv)	conduct an analysis	The data were analysed by region.
approach	approachable (adj)	adopt an approach	A holistic approach is needed.
area	—	key area	Education is a key area of reform.
assess	assessment (n), assessable (adj)	assess the impact	Outcomes must be assessed regularly.
assume	assumption (n), assumed (adj)	challenge an assumption	Assumptions about growth proved wrong.
authority	authoritative (adj), authorise (v)	local authority	Authorities tightened regulations.
available	availability (n), avail (v, rare)	readily available	Data are readily available online.
benefit	beneficial (adj), beneficiary (n)	mutual benefit	Reform offers mutual benefit .
concept	conceptual (adj), conceptualise (v)	core concept	The concept of equity guides policy.
consist	consistent (adj), consistency (n), consistently (adv)	consist of	The sample consisted of 500 adults.
constitute	constitution (n), constitutional (adj)	constitute a threat	Delays constitute a serious risk.
context		broader context	Context shapes interpretation.

Family	Forms	Collocation	IELTS example
	contextual (adj), contextualise (v)		
contract	contractual (adj), contractor (n)	breach of contract	Contracts were renegotiated.
create	creation (n), creative (adj), creatively (adv), creator (n)	create opportunities	Policy created new opportunities.
data	datum (sing., rare)	collect data	Data were collected over five years.
define	definition (n), definite (adj), definitely (adv)	clearly defined	Roles must be clearly defined .
derive	derivation (n), derivative (adj/n)	derive from	Benefits derive from early investment.
distribute	distribution (n), distributive (adj)	uneven distribution	Distribution remains uneven.
economy	economic (adj), economical (adj), economically (adv), economise (v)	economic growth	Economic recovery was slow.
environment	environmental (adj), environmentally (adv), environmentalist (n)	environmental impact	Environmental costs were ignored.
establish	establishment (n), established (adj)	establish a link	Research established a clear link.

Family	Forms	Collocation	IELTS example
estimate	estimation (n), estimated (adj), overestimate (v)	conservative estimate	Estimates varied widely.
evidence	evident (adj), evidently (adv)	empirical evidence	Evidence supports early intervention.
export	exporter (n), exportation (n)	export market	Exports rose in Q4.
factor	—	contributing factor	Cost is a key factor .
finance	financial (adj), financially (adv), financier (n)	financial constraint	Financial pressure limited options.
formula	formulate (v), formulation (n)	develop a formula	A new formula was adopted.
function	functional (adj), functionally (adv), dysfunction (n)	primary function	The function of schools evolved.
identify	identification (n), identifiable (adj), identity (n)	identify trends	Researchers identified three trends.
income	—	household income	Income inequality widened.
indicate	indication (n), indicative (adj), indicator (n)	indicate a shift	Figures indicate a shift.
individual	individualise (v), individually (adv), individuality (n)	individual responsibility	Individual choice matters.

Family	Forms	Collocation	IELTS example
interpret	interpretation (n), interpretive (adj), misinterpret (v)	interpret results	Interpret findings cautiously.
involve	involvement (n), involved (adj)	involve stakeholders	Reform involves communities.
issue	—	address an issue	Housing is a pressing issue .
labour	labor (AmE)	labour market	The labour market tightened.
legal	illegal (adj), legally (adv), legalise (v)	legal framework	A legal gap remains.
legislate	legislation (n), legislative (adj), legislature (n)	pass legislation	Legislation was passed in 2022.
major	majority (n), mostly (adv)	major concern	Cost is a major concern .
method	methodical (adj), methodology (n)	research method	Methods were standardised.
occur	occurrence (n), recurring (adj)	occur frequently	Errors occurred frequently.
percent	percentage (n)	percentage point	A five percent rise was recorded.
period	periodic (adj), periodically (adv)	over the period	Period coverage was 2000–2020.
policy	—	implement policy	Policy must be evidence-based.
principle	principled (adj), principally (adv)	guiding principle	Principles of fairness apply.
proceed	—	proceed with caution	Work proceeded slowly.

Family	Forms	Collocation	IELTS example
	procedure (n), procedural (adj)		
process	processed (adj), processing (n)	learning process	The process takes years.
require	requirement (n), required (adj)	meet requirements	Candidates must meet requirements.
research	researcher (n), researched (adj)	conduct research	Research remains inconclusive.
respond	response (n), responsive (adj), respondent (n)	respond to change	Firms responded quickly.
role	—	play a role	Technology plays a central role .
section	sectional (adj)	following section	The next section discusses methods.
sector	—	public sector	The private sector expanded.
significant	significance (n), significantly (adv), signify (v)	statistically significant	Change was significant .
similar	similarity (n), similarly (adv), dissimilar (adj)	similar pattern	A similar pattern emerged.
source	—	reliable source	Sources must be cited.
specific	specifically (adv), specify (v), specification (n)	specific example	One specific example suffices.
structure	structural (adj), structurally (adv),	organisational structure	Structure affects outcomes.

Family	Forms	Collocation	IELTS example
	restructure (v)		
theory	theoretical (adj), theoret-ically (adv), theorise (v)	in theory	In theory , access improves.
vary	variable (adj/ n), variation (n), various (adj), vari-ously (adv)	vary considerably	Results varied considerably .

Sublist 2–3 (Selected High-Utility Families)

Family	Key forms	Example
achieve	achievement, achievable	Targets were achieved ahead of schedule.
alternative	alternatively, alternate (adj/v)	Alternative routes exist.
circumstance	circumstantial	Under normal circumstances , access is equal.
commit	commitment, committed	Governments committed funding.
communicate	communication, communicative	Communication breakdowns occurred.
concentrate	concentration, concentrated	Concentrated poverty persists.
contrast	contrasting, contrastingly	Contrast urban and rural outcomes.
contribute	contribution, contributor	Volunteers contributed significantly.
convert	conversion, convertible	Energy was converted efficiently.
convince	convincing, convincingly	Evidence was convincing .
cultural	culturally, culture (n)	Cultural factors influence uptake.
debate	debatable	Public debate intensified.
demonstrate	demonstration, demonstrable	Trials demonstrated efficacy.
document	documentation, documented	Trends are well documented .
emerge	emergence, emerging	New risks emerged .
enable	enabling (adj)	Technology enables remote learning.
energy	energetic, energise	Energy costs rose.
enforce	enforcement, enforceable	Rules were enforced weakly.
enhance	enhancement, enhanced	Policy enhanced access.
enormous	enormously	Enormous pressure built.

Family	Key forms	Example
ensure	—	Tests ensure quality.
exclude	exclusion, exclusive, exclusively	Groups were excluded .
expand	expansion, expansive	Services expanded rapidly.
expose	exposure, exposed	Children were exposed to risk.
external	externally, externalise	External funding declined.
facilitate	facilitation, facilitator	Reform facilitated trade.
fundamental	fundamentally	Fundamental change is needed.
generate	generation, generator	Jobs were generated locally.
highlight	—	Reports highlight inequality.
implement	implementation, implemented	Laws were implemented slowly.
imply	implication, implicit	Data imply a correlation.
impose	imposition, imposed	Taxes were imposed .
integrate	integration, integrated	Migrants integrated successfully.
internal	internally, internalise	Internal review followed.
investigate	investigation, investigator	Teams investigated fraud.
justify	justification, justified	Costs were justified .
layer	layered, layering	Multiple layers of bureaucracy.
link	linkage, linked	Poverty is linked to health.
locate	location, located	Facilities are located centrally.
maintain	maintenance, maintained	Standards were maintained .
normal	normally, normalise	Normal service resumed.
obtain	obtainable	Permits were obtained .
participate	participation, participant	Participation rates rose.
potential	potentially	Potential benefits are clear.

Family	Key forms	Example
previous	previously	Previous studies disagreed.
primary	primarily	Primary care was underfunded.
purchase	purchaser, purchasing	Purchasing power fell.
range	ranging	Prices ranged widely.
regulate	regulation, regulatory, regulator	Markets were regulated .
relevant	relevance, irrelevant	Relevant skills are taught.
reside	resident, residence, residential	Most residents commute.
restrict	restriction, restrictive, restricted	Access was restricted .
secure	security, securely, insecurity	Data were secured .
select	selection, selective, selectively	Samples were selected randomly.
sequence	sequential, sequentially	Events were sequenced logically.
summarise	summary, summative	Reports summarise findings.
survive	survival, survivor	Firms survived the downturn.
text	textual	Source texts were analysed.
tradition	traditional, traditionally	Traditional methods persisted.
transfer	transferable	Skills transfer across sectors.
transform	transformation, transformative	Cities were transformed .
trend	trending	Trends suggest decline.
valid	validity, validate, invalid	Arguments remained valid .
visible	visibility, visibly, invisible	Gains were visible quickly.
voluntary	voluntarily, volunteer (n/v)	Voluntary compliance failed.

Sublist 4–10 (Additional IELTS-High Families)

accessible, accompany, aggregate, allocate, amend, annual, apparent, append, appreciate, approximate, arbitrary, attribute, automate, behalf, bias, bond, brief, bulk, capable, challenge, channel, chapter, chart, chemical, circumstance, clause, coherent, coincide, collapse, colleague, commence, compatible, compensate, compile, complement, complex, component, compound, comprehensive, comprise, compute, conceive, concentrate, conclude, concurrent, confer, confine, confirm, conflict, conform, consent, consequent, considerable, consist, constant, constrain, consult, consume, contact, contemporary, contradict, contrary, contrast, convene, converse, coordinate, core, corporate, correspond, couple, credit, criteria, crucial, currency, cycle, decade, decline, deduce, definite, demonstrate, denote, deny, depress, derive, descend, despite, detect, deviate, device, devote, differentiate, dimension, diminish, discrete, discriminate, displace, dispose, distinct, distort, distribute, diverse, dominate, draft, drama, duration, dynamic, edit, element, eliminate, emerge, emit, emphasis, empirical, enable, encounter, enforce, enhance, enormous, ensure, entity, environment, equate, equip, equivalent, erode, error, establish, estate, estimate, ethic, ethnic, eventual, evident, evolve, exceed, exclude, exhibit, expand, expert, explicit, exploit, export, expose, external, extract, facilitate, factor, feature, federal, fee, file, final, finance, finite, flexible, fluctuate, focus, format, formula, forthcoming, found, foundation, framework, function, fund, fundamental, furthermore, gender, generate, generation, globe, grade, grant, guarantee, guideline, hence, hierarchy, highlight, hypothesis, identical, identify, ideology, ignore, illustrate, image, immigrate, impact, implement, implicate, implicit, imply, impose, incentive, incidence, incline, incline, incorporate, index, induce, inevitable, infer, infrastructure, inherent, inhibit, initial, initiate, injure, innovate, input, insert, insight, inspect, instance, institute, instruct, integral, integrate, integrity, intelligence, intense, interact, intermediate, internal, interpret, interval, intervene, intrinsic, invest, investigate, invoke, involve, isolate, issue, item, job, journal, justify, label, labour, layer, lecture, legal, legislate, levy, liberal, licence, likewise, link, locate, logic, maintain, major, manipulate, manual, margin, mature, maximise, mechanism, media, mediate, medical, medium, mental, method, migrate, military, minimal, minimise, minimum, ministry, minor, mode, modify, monitor, motive, mutual, negate, network, neutral, nevertheless, nonetheless, norm, normal, notion, notwithstanding, nuclear, objective, oblige, obtain, occupy, occur, odd, offset, ongoing, option, orient, outcome, output, overall, overlap, overseas, panel, paradigm, paragraph, parallel, parameter, participate, partner, passive, perceive, period, persist, perspective, phase, phenomenon, philosophy, physical, plus, policy, portion, pose, positive, potential, precede, precise, predict, predominant, preliminary, presume, previous, primary, prime, principal, principle, prior, priority, proceed, process, professional, prohibit, project, promote, proportion, prospect, protocol, psychology, publication, publish, purchase, pursue, qualitative, quote, radical, random, range, ratio, rational, react, recover, refine, regime, region, register, regulate, reinforce, reject, relax, release, relevant, reluctance, rely, remove, require, research, resolve, resource, respond, restore, restrict, retain, reveal, revenue, reverse, revise, revolution, role, route, scenario, schedule, scheme, scope, section, sector, secure, seek, select, sequence, series, sex, shift, significant, similar, simulate, simultaneous, so-called, sole, somewhat, source,

specific, specify, sphere, stable, statistic, status, straightforward, strategy, stress, structure, style, submit, subsequent, subsidise, substitute, succeed, sufficient, sum, summary, supplement, survey, survive, suspend, sustain, symbol, tape, target, task, team, technical, technique, technology, temporary, tense, terminate, text, theme, theory, thereby, thesis, topic, trace, tradition, transfer, transform, transit, transmit, transport, trend, trigger, ultimate, undergo, underlie, undertake, uniform, unify, unique, utilise, valid, vary, vehicle, version, via, violate, virtual, visible, vision, visual, volume, voluntary, welfare, whereas, whereby, widespread, withdraw, yield

(Use this list for recognition; master 200 families actively for production.)

Word Form Traps

Error	Correct
economical growth	economic growth (economical = not wasteful)
environment problems	environmental problems
a research	research / a study
evidences	evidence (uncountable)
significancy	significance

Source concept: Coxhead AWL (2000). This appendix is an original pedagogical expansion for IELTS. See Chapter 69 and Appendix A02.

Appendix A07: Common Spelling Mistakes

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Ultimate IELTS Mastery — Listening & Writing Spelling Reference

Why Spelling Matters in IELTS

- **Listening:** Wrong spelling = wrong answer (unless alternative in key)
- **Writing:** Repeated spelling errors affect Lexical Resource
- **Reading/Listening gap-fill:** Word form + spelling both required

Category 1: Double Letters

Correct	Common error
accommodate	accomodate
occurrence	oocurance, occured
committee	comittee
embarrassed	embarassed
necessary	neccessary
parallel	paralel
recommend	reecomend
successful	succesful
until	untill
beginning	begining

Category 2: -ence / -ance

Correct	Common error
existence	existance
independence	independance
performance	performence
reference	referance
maintenance	maintainance
attendance	attendence
evidence	evidance
occurrence	oocurence

Category 3: -able / -ible

Correct	Common error
accessible	accessable
achievable	achieveable
responsible	responsable
visible	visable
compatible	compatable
negligible	negligable

Category 4: -tion / -sion / -cion

Correct	Common error
education	educaton
government	goverment
environment	enviroment
decision	desicion
expansion	expantion
conclusion	conclution
discussion	discusion
profession	proffession

Category 5: IELTS High-Frequency Academic Words

Correct	Common error
benefit	benifit
category	catagory
definitely	definately
separate	seperate
definitely	defiantly (wrong word)
receive	recieve
achieve	acheive
believe	beleive
foreign	foriegn
guarantee	garantee
hierarchy	heirarchy
immediately	immediatly
independent	independant
judgment / judgement	judgement (BrE both OK)
knowledge	knowlege
leisure	leasure
liaison	liason
millennium	millenium
minuscule	miniscule
necessary	neccesary
occasion	ocassion
occurred	oecured
opportunity	oppertunity
persistent	persistant
privilege	priviledge
pronunciation	pronounciation
publicly	publically

Correct	Common error
questionnaire	questionaire
relevant	relevent
rhythm	rythm
schedule	schedual
separate	seperate
significant	significante
similar	similiar
succeed	succede
sufficient	suFFicient
technique	techneque
temperature	temprature
threshold	threshhold
truly	truely
unnecessary	unneccessary
until	untill
vacuum	vaccum
vehicle	vehical
village	villiage
weird	wierd
withhold	withold

Category 6: British vs American (IELTS Accepts Both If Consistent)

British	American	Note
colour	color	Be consistent within script
centre	center	
organise	organize	
analyse	analyze	
programme	program	programme (TV/course) vs program (computer)
licence (n)	license	license (n) in AmE
travelling	traveling	Double l in BrE
defence	defense	
labour	labor	
catalogue	catalog	

Strategy: Pick one system for Writing; Listening accepts either if in key.

Category 7: Plural Traps

Correct	Common error
analyses (plural of analysis)	analysises
criteria (plural of criterion)	criterias
phenomena (plural of phenomenon)	phenomenons
data (often plural in formal BrE)	datas
children	childs
people	peoples (except ethnic peoples)
women	womans
men	mans

Category 8: Homophones (Listening Danger)

Word	Confused with	Meaning
their	there, they're	possession / place / they are
affect	effect	verb influence / noun result
accept	except	agree / exclude
principal	principle	main / rule
complement	compliment	complete / praise
stationary	stationery	not moving / paper supplies
practice (n)	practise (v) BrE	
advice (n)	advise (v)	
desert	dessert	arid land / sweet course
hear	here	listen / location
its	it's	possession / it is
loose	lose	not tight / misplace
than	then	comparison / time
weather	whether	climate / if

Category 9: Geography & Proper Nouns (Listening)

Practise spelling common IELTS names/places:

- Mediterranean, Caribbean, Antarctica
- Edinburgh, Melbourne, Wellington
- Thompson, Mitchell, Richardson
- February, Wednesday, accommodation

Category 10: Numbers and Units

Correct	Note
million	not million
billion	
percent / per cent	Both seen; Listening follows audio
30°C	degree symbol optional
km, kg, cm	no full stop in SI

Personal Spelling Log Template

Word	My error	Correct	Source (test/module)
government	goverment	government	Listening Test 3
environment	enviroment	environment	Writing feedback

Review weekly. Drill top 20 errors before test day.

Mnemonic Tips

- **necessary** — one collar, two socks (c one, s two)
- **accommodate** — two cots, two mattresses
- **separate** — there is *a rat* in separate
- **believe** — believe before i before e rule breaks
- **receive** — i before e except after c

Cross-reference Appendix A03 (irregular verb spelling). Use British Council / Cambridge learner dictionaries for verification.

Appendix A08: Common Pronunciation Mistakes

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Ultimate IELTS Mastery — Speaking & Listening Pronunciation Guide

IELTS Pronunciation Criteria (Speaking)

Band descriptors assess:

- **Individual sounds** (phoneme accuracy where needed for intelligibility)
- **Word stress**
- **Sentence stress and intonation**
- **Connected speech** (natural linking, not robotic)

Not required: British RP accent; elimination of L1 accent.

Section 1: Problem Consonants (L1-Dependent — Universal Hot List)

/θ/ and /ð/ (think / this)

Word	Common error	Tip
think	<i>tink, sink</i>	Tongue between teeth
three	<i>tree</i>	
through	<i>true</i>	
although	<i>altough</i>	
weather	<i>wether</i>	
breathe (v)	confuse with breath	/ð/ vs /θ/

/v/ vs /w/

Word	Error
very	<i>wery</i>
west	<i>vest</i>
wave	<i>wafe</i>

/r/ and /l/

Word	Note
rural	Multiple syllables; slow practice
really	Don't roll unless natural
correct	Clear /r/ in rhotic accents OK

/ʃ/ (sh) vs /s/

Word	Error
special	<i>espicial</i>
social	<i>sosial</i>
machine	<i>masheen</i> stress: ma-CHINE

Silent Letters

Word	Pronunciation
psychology	/saɪ'kɒlədʒi/ — silent p
doubt	silent b
island	silent s
government	often /'ɡʌvənmənt/ — drops er
comfortable	/'kʌmftəbl/ — drops or
interesting	/'ɪntrəstɪŋ/ — 3 syllables common

Section 2: Word Stress Errors

Wrong stress = wrong word or unclear communication.

Word	Correct stress	Common error
photograph	PHO-to-graph	photo-GRAPH
photography	pho-TOG-ra-phy	
economic	e-co-NOM-ic	E-co-no-mic
economy	e-CON-o-my	
education	e-du-CA-tion	
develop	de-VEL-op	DE-vel-op
development	de-VEL-op-ment	
record (n)	RE-cord	re-CORD
record (v)	re-CORD	
present (n)	PRE-sent	pre-SENT
present (v)	pre-SENT	
significant	sig-NIF-i-cant	
specific	spe-CIF-ic	
necessary	NEC-es-sar-y	
comfortable	COMF-ta-ble	
absolutely	AB-so-lute-ly	
absolutely		
environment	en-VI-ron-ment	
environmental	en-vi-ron-MEN-tal	
policy	POL-i-cy	
police	po-LICE	
address (v)	ad-DRESS	AD-dress (n)
detail (n)	DE-tail	de-TAIL (v AmE)
research (n)	RE-search	re-SEARCH (some variants)
analysis	a-NAL-y-sis	
analyse	AN-a-lyse	

Rule: Noun-adjective pairs often shift stress: *PHOtograph* vs *photoGRAPHic*.

Section 3: Vowel Confusions

Sound pair	Examples
/i:/ vs /ɪ/	sheep vs ship; leave vs live
/æ/ vs /e/	man vs men; bat vs bet
/ɑ:/ vs /ʌ/	cart vs cut; park vs puck
/u:/ vs /ʊ/	pool vs pull; fool vs full
/ɜ:/	bird, word, nurse — central vowel

Schwa /ə/

Unstressed syllables reduce to schwa:

- *about* → /ə'baʊt/
- *support* → /sə'pɔ:t/
- *information* → /,ɪnfə'meɪʃən/

Over-pronouncing every vowel sounds unnatural (Band 6 fluency).

Section 4: Intonation Patterns

Wh-questions

Falling tone at end: *Where do you live* ↘

Yes/No questions

Rising tone: *Do you work here* ↗

Lists

Rise on each item, fall on last: *We need pens* ↗ *paper* ↗ *and desks* ↘

Contrast

Stress contrasted words: *I wanted **tea**, not **coffee**.*

Part 3 analytical tone

Measured fall — avoid monotone or sing-song.

Section 5: Connected Speech (Natural Fluency)

Process	Example
Linking	<i>an apple</i> /ən æpəl/
Elision	<i>next day</i> — /t/ dropped
Assimilation	<i>ten people</i> — /n/ before /p/
Weak forms	<i>to</i> /tə/, <i>for</i> /fə/, <i>and</i> /ən/

Band 9: Natural reductions without losing clarity.

Section 6: Listening — Accent Awareness

IELTS features **British, American, Australian, New Zealand, Canadian** accents (and others).

Feature	British	American
rhotic /r/	often non-rhotic	rhotic
bath vowel	/ɑ:/	/æ/
schedule	/'ʃedju:l/	/'skedʒu:l/
advertisement	stress varies	

Practice: BBC Learning English, ABC Australia, CBC Canada — short clips daily.

Section 7: Numbers & Dates (Listening + Speaking)

Item	Pronunciation note
13 vs 30	thirTEEN vs THIRty — stress
14 vs 40	
15 vs 50	
1900	nineteen hundred
2010	twenty ten OR two thousand ten
1st, 2nd, 3rd	ordinals clear
0	zero, oh (phone), nought (BrE)

Section 8: Top Mispronounced IELTS Words

Word	IPA (approx BrE)
architecture	/ˈɑːkɪtektʃə/
bureaucracy	/bjʊəˈrɒkrəsi/
entrepreneur	/ˌɒntreprəˈnɜː/
particularly	/pəˈtɪkjələli/
inevitably	/ɪnˈevɪtəbli/
necessarily	/ˌnesəˈserəli/
specifically	/spəˈsɪfɪkli/
significantly	/sɪɡˈnɪfɪkəntli/
responsibility	/rɪˌspɒnsəˈbɪləti/
vulnerable	/ˈvʌlnərəbl/
rural	/ˈrʊərəl/
colonel	/ˈkɜːnl/
chaos	/ˈkeɪɒs/
choir	/ˈkwaɪə/

Self-Study Protocol

1. Record 2-minute Speaking answer weekly
 2. Mark stress errors on transcript
 3. Drill 10 problem words daily (IPA + audio from dictionary)
 4. Shadow BBC 6 Minute English for connected speech
 5. Before Speaking test: slow down on content words, relax on function words
-

Pronunciation vs Fluency

Hesitation from **pronunciation searching** hurts Fluency.

Minor accent features that **do not block understanding** do not hurt Pronunciation at Band 8–9.

Use Cambridge Online Dictionary / Oxford Learner's Dictionary for audio models. See Chapter 121 for full pronunciation teaching.

Appendix A09: IELTS Checklists

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Ultimate IELTS Mastery — Pre-Test & Module Checklists

Master Pre-Test Checklist (Night Before / Morning Of)

Documents & Logistics

- ☐ Valid ID (same as registration)
- ☐ Confirmation email / test details
- ☐ Arrive 45–60 minutes early (Speaking may be different day)
- ☐ Know test centre location and transport
- ☐ Water bottle (where permitted)
- ☐ No phone in test room

Mental Preparation

- ☐ 7–8 hours sleep
- ☐ Light breakfast
- ☐

Full test simulation completed in prior week

☐

Personal spelling list reviewed (A07)

☐

Time protocols memorised (Ch 180)

Listening Checklist

Before Each Section

☐

Read all questions before audio

☐

Underline keywords

☐

Predict answer type (number/name/adjective/verb)

☐

Note word limit (NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS...)

During

☐

Write answers immediately

☐

Move on if missed — do not panic

☐

Watch plural/singular in grammar hints

Paper Test Transfer (10 min)

☐

All blanks filled (guess if needed)

☐

Spelling checked on uncertain words

☐

Word form checked (verb tense, plural)

☐

Answers in correct numbered box

☐

Legible handwriting

Computer Test

- ☐ Typing speed adequate
- ☐ Answers saved in correct fields during audio

Reading Checklist

Per Passage (~20 min)

- ☐ Skim title, intro, topic sentences (60–90 sec)
- ☐ Read questions first
- ☐ Locate via scan — do not read every word
- ☐ Evidence sentence found before answering
- ☐ Move on after 90 sec stuck — mark guess

By Question Type

- ☐ **TFNG/YNNG:** Exact match or NG discipline
- ☐ **Matching headings:** First/last sentence strategy
- ☐ **Gap-fill:** Grammar prediction before search
- ☐ **Word limit:** Never exceed

Final 3 Minutes

- ☐ No blank answers
- ☐ Transfer accuracy (paper)
- ☐ Review flagged questions only if time

Writing Checklist

Task 1 (20 min) — Academic

- ☐ At least 150 words
- ☐ **Overview present** (Band 7+ essential)
- ☐ No opinion (unless asked)
- ☐ Key data selected — not every number
- ☐ Trend language accurate
- ☐ Paragraphs: intro+overview / body / body
- ☐ 2–3 min proofread

Task 1 — General Training Letter

- ☐ All bullet points addressed
- ☐ Correct tone (formal/semi-formal/informal)
- ☐ Standard letter format (greeting, closing)
- ☐ At least 150 words

Task 2 (40 min)

- ☐ At least 250 words
- ☐ **Every part of question answered**
- ☐ Clear position (argumentative types)
- ☐ 4–5 paragraphs visible
- ☐ Introduction paraphrases (not copies) question
- ☐

Body paragraphs: claim → explain → example

☐

Conclusion synthesises — no new ideas

☐

3–5 min proofread (grammar/spelling only)

Proofread Priority Order

1. Subject–verb agreement
2. Article errors
3. Word form (noun/verb/adjective)
4. Spelling of words you often miss
5. Punctuation (comma splices)

Speaking Checklist

Part 1

☐

Extended answers (2–4 sentences)

☐

Direct response first

☐

Not monologuing — allow examiner pace

Part 2

☐

Use 1 minute prep — keyword notes only

☐

Cover **all bullet points**

☐

Clear beginning and ending

☐

1–2 minutes sustained speech

Part 3

☐

Analytical answers — compare, evaluate, speculate

☐

Direct answer → reasons → example → wrap

☐

Natural signposting (not written essay tone)

☐

Self-correction smooth if needed

Pronunciation & Fluency

☐

Content words stressed

☐

Intonation on questions/statements

☐

Minimal long silence

☐

Don't memorise unrelated speech

Band 9 Quality Checklist (Self-Mark After Mock)

Writing

☐

Task Response: all parts + overview + clear position

☐

Coherence: one idea per paragraph; logical flow

☐

Lexis: precise collocations; no forced synonyms

☐

Grammar: variety + error-free stretches

Speaking

☐

Fluency: sustained without strain

☐

Lexis: flexible + idiomatic where natural

☐

Grammar: range with self-repair OK

☐

Pronunciation: intelligible throughout

One-Week Countdown

Day	Focus
-7	Full mock under timed conditions
-6	Review errors; spelling list
-5	Weak module drill (Reading/Listening)
-4	Writing Task 1 + 2 timed
-3	Speaking mock recording
-2	Light review; A11 cheat sheets
-1	Rest; logistics; no cramming
Test	Execute checklists; stay calm

Post-Test Checklist (Optional Review)

☐

Note topics for future candidates (don't share confidential items)

☐

Log performance feelings vs mock averages

☐

Plan re-test timeline if needed (results in 3–5 days computer / 13 days paper traditionally)

Print this appendix for test preparation folder. See A10 revision sheets and A11 cheat sheets.

Appendix A10: Revision Sheets

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Ultimate IELTS Mastery — Printable One-Page Topic Reviews

How to Use

Each sheet summarises **one revision unit**. Cover the right column; test yourself; mark gaps. Combine with Part 3 modules and Part 10 Band 9 secrets.

Sheet 1: IELTS Overview

Item	Key facts
Modules	Listening 30m, Reading 60m, Writing 60m, Speaking 11–14m
Bands	0–9 in 0.5 steps; overall = average of four (rounded)
Academic vs GT	Same L/R Speaking; Writing Task 1 differs
Computer vs Paper	Same content; CD Writing typed; L/R answers on screen
Scoring	No pass/fail — university sets requirement

Sheet 2: Writing Task 2 Structure

Paragraph	Content
Intro	Paraphrase question + thesis/roadmap (3–4 sentences)
Body 1	Topic sentence → explain → example → link
Body 2	Same structure; contrast or second theme
Body 3 (optional)	Third angle or concession paragraph
Conclusion	Synthesise; restate position; no new ideas

Time: Plan 5 / Write 30 / Check 5

Sheet 3: Writing Task 1 — Line Graph Language

Function	Phrases
Up	rose, increased, grew, climbed, surged
Down	fell, declined, dropped, plunged, decreased
Stable	remained stable, levelled off, plateaued
Peak/low	peaked at, reached a high of, bottomed out at
Compare	whereas, while, in contrast, similarly
Overview	Overall, the most notable trend was...

Sheet 4: TFNG / YNNG Decision Tree

Does statement match passage meaning?

YES → True / Yes

NO (contradicted) → False / No

NOT mentioned / can't tell → NG

Trap: Don't use outside knowledge.

Sheet 5: Listening Answer Types

Signal in question	Expected answer
How many...	number
When...	date/time
Who...	name
Where...	place
What kind of...	adjective/noun
Why...	reason phrase (rare direct)

Sheet 6: Speaking Part 2 Framework

1. **Intro** — what/where/when
2. **Bullet 1** — develop with detail
3. **Bullet 2** — example or story
4. **Bullet 3** — feeling/opinion
5. **Close** — brief reflection

Notes: 4–5 keywords only in prep minute.

Sheet 7: Conditionals Quick Revision

Type	Pattern	Example
0	if + present, present	If water boils, it evaporates
1	if + present, will	If funding rises, outcomes will improve
2	if + past, would	If cars were banned, air would improve
3	if + past perfect, would have	If they had acted, damage would have been less
Mixed	if + past perfect, would + base	If they had invested, cities would be cleaner now

Sheet 8: Articles Revision

Use	Example
a/an	first mention, singular countable
the	specific, unique, second mention
zero	general plural/uncountable concepts

Errors: a advice, the education is important (general)

Sheet 9: AWL Top 20 Families

analyse, approach, area, assess, assume, authority, available, benefit, concept, consist, context, create, data, define, establish, evidence, factor, function, indicate, significant

→ Learn noun, verb, adjective forms + one collocation each.

Sheet 10: Environment Lexis (Ch 47)

Word	Collocation
emissions	reduce/cut emissions
biodiversity	loss of biodiversity
sustainable	sustainable development
conservation	wildlife conservation
ecosystem	fragile ecosystem
renewable	renewable energy
pollution	air/water pollution
climate change	combat climate change

Sheet 11: Education Lexis (Ch 45)

Word	Collocation
curriculum	revise the curriculum
literacy	literacy rates
vocational	vocational training
attainment	academic attainment
tuition	tuition fees
enrol	enrol in a course
pedagogy	modern pedagogy
scholarship	award a scholarship

Sheet 12: Technology Lexis (Ch 46)

Word	Collocation
automation	workplace automation
digital	digital literacy
connectivity	internet connectivity
innovation	drive innovation
surveillance	mass surveillance
algorithm	predictive algorithm
cybersecurity	cybersecurity threat
artificial intelligence	deploy AI

Sheet 13: Health Lexis (Ch 52)

Word	Collocation
preventive	preventive care
sedentary	sedentary lifestyle
mental health	mental health services
obesity	childhood obesity
epidemic	contain an epidemic
wellbeing	physical wellbeing
healthcare	healthcare provision
diagnosis	early diagnosis

Sheet 14: Cohesion Connectors by Function

Function	Words
Add	furthermore, in addition, also
Contrast	however, whereas, while, conversely
Result	therefore, consequently, as a result
Example	for example, for instance, namely
Concession	although, even though, despite
Order	first, subsequently, finally

Sheet 15: Band Descriptor Snapshots (Writing)

Band	Task Response	Coherence	Lexis	Grammar
6	Addresses task; some parts more fully	Arranged coherently; some ineffective cohesion	Adequate range; some errors	Mix; errors rarely impede
7	Addresses all parts; clear position	Logical progression; range of cohesive devices	Flexible; occasional errors	Variety; frequent error-free
8	Sufficiently addresses; well-developed	Sequences well; managed cohesion	Wide, skilful; rare errors	Wide range; majority error-free
9	Fully addresses; fully developed	Effortless to follow	Full flexibility; rare slips	Full range; rare slips

Sheet 16: Irregular Verbs — Top 15

be-was/were-been | go-went-gone | see-saw-seen | take-took-taken | make-made-made |
 come-came-come | give-gave-given | write-wrote-written | rise-rose-risen | fall-fell-fallen |
 grow-grew-grown | know-knew-known | think-thought-thought | find-found-found | tell-told-told

Sheet 17: Prepositions of Change (Task 1)

- increase **from** X **to** Y
- rise **by** 10% (amount of change)
- rise **to** 50% (final level)
- increase **in** spending (noun)
- compared **with** / **to**

Sheet 18: Problem/Solution Essay Frame

1. Intro: paraphrase + outline problem + thesis (solutions exist)
2. Body 1: causes / problem detail

3. Body 2: solution 1 + how + result
4. Body 3: solution 2 + how + result
5. Conclusion: summarise + recommend

Sheet 19: Discussion Essay Frame

1. Intro: both views acknowledged + your opinion
2. Body 1: View A + support
3. Body 2: View B + support
4. Body 3 (or integrated): Your opinion + justification
5. Conclusion: balanced synthesis + clear stance

Sheet 20: Final 24-Hour Revision Rotation

Hour block	Activity
1	A07 spelling + A03 verbs
2	One Reading passage timed
3	Task 1 overview drill × 2
4	Task 2 plan × 3 (no full write)
5	Speaking Part 3 recorded answers × 5
6	A09 checklists + rest

Photocopy sheets for wall display. Cross-link to Part chapters via Appendix A14 index.

Appendix A11: Cheat Sheets

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Ultimate IELTS Mastery — Quick-Reference Exam Day Sheets

Cheat Sheet 1: Writing Task 2 — 5-Minute Plan Template

QUESTION TYPE: [opinion / discuss / problem / adv-disadv / double]

PARTS TO ANSWER:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

THESIS (one sentence): _____

BODY 1 TOPIC SENTENCE: _____

Example: _____

BODY 2 TOPIC SENTENCE: _____

Example: _____

CONCLUSION (restate + synthesise): _____

Cheat Sheet 2: Task 1 Overview Formula

Overall, [main trend 1], while [main trend 2].
[Optional: most dramatic change / highest/lowest point].

Rules: No numbers required in overview; no opinion; 2 sentences max often sufficient.

Cheat Sheet 3: Paraphrase Toolkit (Question Rewriting)

Original	Alternatives
many people	a large number of individuals / numerous
think / believe	argue / maintain / contend / hold the view
important	significant / crucial / vital
problem	issue / challenge / concern
good	beneficial / advantageous / positive
bad	detrimental / adverse / harmful
more and more	increasingly / a growing number
nowadays	in contemporary society / currently
because	due to / owing to / since / as

Cheat Sheet 4: Linking Words — Minimal Set (Don’t Overuse)

- Contrast:** however, whereas, while, although
Result: therefore, consequently, as a result
Addition: furthermore, in addition, also
Example: for example, for instance
Concession: admittedly, while it is true that
Summary: in conclusion, on balance, overall

Cheat Sheet 5: Listening — Last-Minute Reminders

- Read ahead always

- ONE WORD ONLY = exactly one
- TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER = max two words + number allowed
- Hyphenated = one word
- Spelling counts
- Singular/plural must fit grammar
- Never leave blank

Cheat Sheet 6: Reading — 60-Minute Split

Passage	Minutes	Target
1	17–20	≥ 12/13
2	18–20	≥ 12/13
3	20–22	≥ 12/14
Buffer	0–3	Review flags

Stuck > 90 sec → guess and move.

Cheat Sheet 7: Speaking Part 3 — ARE Formula

Answer directly

Reason (why)

Example (personal/societal)

Add **concession** for Band 8+: *That said,...*

Cheat Sheet 8: Formal vs Informal (GT Letters)

Formal	Informal
Dear Sir or Madam	Hi [Name]
I am writing to...	I'm writing to...
I would appreciate...	I'd love it if...
I look forward to...	Hope to hear from you
Yours faithfully	Best wishes / Take care

Cheat Sheet 9: Number & Data Language (Task 1)

Pattern	Example
X doubled	The figure doubled to 40%.
X tripled	Sales tripled over the period.
X halved	Production halved by 2015.
twofold/threefold increase	a twofold increase
respectively	A and B rose to 30% and 50% respectively.
accounted for	Coal accounted for 45% of supply.
the majority of	the majority of respondents

Cheat Sheet 10: Common Grammar Fixes Under Pressure

Wrong	Right
Although X, but Y	Although X, Y
more better	much better
informations	information
peoples	people
do research	conduct research
economical growth	economic growth
government (spelling)	government

Cheat Sheet 11: Task 2 Introduction — Two Sentences

Sentence 1: Paraphrase background (general statement about topic)

Sentence 2: Thesis + outline (your position / what essay will do)

Avoid: *In this essay I will discuss...* (acceptable but plain; paraphrase question instead)

Cheat Sheet 12: Opinion Essay Thesis Patterns

- *I firmly believe that...*
 - *While I acknowledge..., I would argue that...*
 - *On balance, I consider... to be the most effective approach.*
 - *I am convinced that...*
-

Cheat Sheet 13: Double-Question Essay Split

Q1: Direct answer paragraph (2–3 sentences + example)

Q2: Direct answer paragraph (2–3 sentences + example)

Optional intro/conclusion frame both parts

Cheat Sheet 14: When to Use Passive (Writing)

✓ Processes (Task 1), impersonal claims, formal reports

✗ Every sentence; when agent important; Speaking Part 1 personal stories

Cheat Sheet 15: Emergency Writing — Running Out of Time

5 min left, no conclusion: Write 2-sentence conclusion with clear position.

2 min left: Stop new ideas; fix spelling of common words.

Task 1 forgotten overview: Add overview sentence at end — better than none (not ideal).

Keep Cheat Sheets 5, 6, 7 for test-day folder. Do not bring unauthorized materials into test room — memorise key sheets beforehand.

Appendix A12: Formula Sheets

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Ultimate IELTS Mastery — Structural & Language Formulas

Writing Task 2 Formulas

F1: Opinion Essay

Intro: Context paraphrase + clear thesis (agree/disagree extent)
 Body 1: Reason 1 + explanation + example
 Body 2: Reason 2 + explanation + example
 [Body 3: Concession paragraph – optional Band 8+]
 Conclusion: Restate position + summarise reasons (no new ideas)

F2: Discussion (+ Opinion)

Intro: Acknowledge both views + state your opinion
 Body 1: View A (fair presentation)
 Body 2: View B (fair presentation)
 Body 3: Your opinion with justification
 Conclusion: Synthesise + reaffirm stance

F3: Problem / Solution

Intro: State problem relevance + outline essay
 Body 1: Problem causes/impacts (developed)
 Body 2: Solution(s) + implementation + expected outcome

[Body 3: Second solution or evaluation]
Conclusion: Summarise + recommendation

F4: Advantages / Disadvantages

Intro: Topic paraphrase + outline (often "outweigh" question)
Body 1: Advantages (2 developed points)
Body 2: Disadvantages (2 developed points)
Conclusion: Judgement – which outweighs + why

F5: Double Question

Intro: Brief context + signal both questions addressed
Body 1: Answer Question 1 fully
Body 2: Answer Question 2 fully
Conclusion: Brief wrap of both answers

Writing Task 1 Formulas

F6: Line Graph / Bar Chart

Para 1: Paraphrase + overview (2 main trends)
Para 2: Detail group A (time period or category)
Para 3: Detail group B + comparisons

F7: Pie Chart

Para 1: Paraphrase + overview (largest/smallest/most change)
Para 2: Major segments compared
Para 3: Remaining segments + notable exceptions

F8: Table

Para 1: Paraphrase + overview (highest/lowest/key contrast)
Para 2: Compare rows or columns (logical grouping)
Para 3: Remaining data + exceptions

F9: Process Diagram

Para 1: Paraphrase + overview (number of stages / start-end)
 Para 2: Stages 1-n (sequential passive)
 Para 3: Final stages + result
 Language: is fed, is heated, is then filtered, finally packaged

F10: Map

Para 1: Paraphrase + overview (most dramatic changes)
 Para 2: Area/feature group 1 changes
 Para 3: Area/feature group 2 changes
 Language: was replaced by, was converted into, newly constructed

Language Formulas

F11: Hedge Formula (Academic Caution)

[Subject] + may/might/could + verb
 It appears that / It seems that / tends to / is likely to
 In many cases / to some extent / often / generally

F12: Boost Formula (Strong Claim)

[Subject] + clearly/demonstrably + verb
 There is compelling evidence that
 It is widely acknowledged that
 Undoubtedly / inevitably (use sparingly)

F13: Cause → Effect Chain

X leads to Y → Y results in Z → Consequently, [conclusion]
 Stem from / give rise to / contribute to / account for

F14: Concession → Counter

Although / While / Admittedly + [counterpoint],
 nevertheless / however / yet + [main claim]

F15: Example Introduction

For example, / For instance, / A case in point is
This is illustrated by / To illustrate,
Specifically, / In particular,

Speaking Formulas

F16: Part 1 EXTEND

Answer (1 sentence) + Reason (because...) + Example (e.g. last week...) + Optional feeling

F17: Part 2 STORY

Setting (when/where) → Event → Details (senses/people) → Feeling → Significance

F18: Part 3 ARE + C

Answer → Reason → Example → Concession (That said...) → Close (So overall...)

Reading Formulas

F19: TFNG

T: Passage confirms statement
F: Passage contradicts statement
NG: Passage neither confirms nor contradicts

F20: Matching Headings

Read first + last sentence of paragraph → identify main idea (not detail) → match heading
Eliminate used headings

F21: Gap-Fill Summary

Predict grammar (noun/verb/adj) → scan for paraphrase → check word limit → check spelling

Listening Formulas

F22: Answer Prediction

Wh-word → answer type
 Grammar in sentence → word form
 Synonym in audio → paraphrase recognition

F23: Map Labelling

Orient: north/entrance/you are here
 Track speaker movement chronologically
 Prepositions: opposite, next to, behind, at the end of

Band Upgrade Formulas

F24: Sentence Upgrade Ladder

Band 6: Simple sentence + basic linker
 Band 7: Complex sentence + precise vocabulary
 Band 8: Multiple clauses + collocation + hedging
 Band 9: Natural integration + nominalisation + seamless cohesion

F25: Paragraph Upgrade

Topic sentence (claim)
 → Explanation (why)
 → Evidence (example/data)
 → Link (back to thesis / forward to next para)

Task 1 Trend Sentence Templates

Template	Example
[Noun] + verb-ed + adverb + from X to Y	Sales rose steadily from 10% to 40%.
There was a + adj + increase in + noun	There was a dramatic increase in exports.
[Noun] + saw /experienced + a + adj + rise	The sector experienced a gradual rise .
The figure for X + verb + to + number	The figure for coal fell to 12%.
X was the largest/smallest + noun	Coal was the largest source throughout.

Quick Application Table

Need	Use Formula
Opinion essay	F1
Both views essay	F2
Chart description	F6–F8
Process	F9
Map	F10
Cautious claim	F11
Speaking depth	F18
TFNG	F19

Formulas are scaffolding — replace with original content. See Part 7 for model essays (Ch 113).

Appendix A13: Glossary

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Ultimate IELTS Mastery — IELTS & Linguistics Terms (150+ Entries)

Author: Azhar Hussain · First Edition 2026

A

Academic IELTS — Module typically required for university study; Academic Writing Task 1 uses visual data.

Academic Task 1 — Writing report describing visual data (graph, chart, table, map, process); minimum 150 words.

Academic Word List (AWL) — Coxhead (2000) list of 570 word families frequent in academic texts.

Active voice — Subject performs verb (*The government raised taxes*).

Adjective — Word describing noun (*significant change*).

Adverb — Modifies verb/adjective (*rapidly increased*).

Anchor scripts — Sample performances at known band levels used to train IELTS examiners.

Antonym — Word with opposite meaning (*increase vs decrease*).

Article — Determiners *a, an, the*.

Assessment criteria — Public band descriptors used to score performance.

AWL sublist — AWL divided into 10 frequency sublists.

B

Band descriptor — Published rubric describing performance at each band 0–9.

Band score — IELTS result from 0–9 in 0.5 steps.

Bar chart — Task 1 visual comparing categories with bars.

Bias (Reading) — Pre-existing view that may distort NOT GIVEN discipline.

Brainstorming — Pre-writing idea generation (Task 2 planning).

British English — Preferred spelling variant in many IELTS materials; American also accepted if consistent.

C

Candidate — Test taker.

Cleft sentence — Emphatic structure (*It was funding that mattered*).

Coherence — Logical connection of ideas.

Cohesion — Grammatical/lexical linking between sentences.

Collocation — Natural word pairing (*heavy rain, commit a crime*).

Complex sentence — Independent clause + dependent clause.

Computer-delivered IELTS (CD IELTS) — Digital test format.

Concession — Acknowledging counter-argument (*Although...*).

Conditionals — Sentences expressing if–then relationships (zero through mixed).

Conjunction — Connector (*however, because, although*).

Content word — Nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs carrying meaning.

Co-marking — Quality control where senior examiner reviews marks.

Cue card — Speaking Part 2 prompt card with topic and bullets.

Criterion (pl. criteria) — Single scoring dimension.

D

Dependent clause — Clause not standing alone as sentence.

Descriptor — See band descriptor.

Diagram (process) — Task 1 visual showing stages of a process.

Discourse marker — Phrase organising speech/writing (*however, on balance*).

Distractor (Listening/Reading) — Wrong option designed to trap careless selection.

Double Question essay — Task 2 with two direct questions to answer.

Draft — Written version before final proofread.

E

Elision — Omitting sounds in connected speech (*next day*).

Examiner — Certified rater for Speaking/Writing.

Extended response — Developed answer beyond one sentence.

F

False (TFNG) — Statement contradicts passage.

Fluency (Speaking) — Flow of speech without undue hesitation.

Form completion — Listening question type filling gaps in forms.

Function word — Grammatical words (articles, prepositions) with low lexical content.

Future perfect — *will have done* — rare in IELTS but shows range.

G

Gap-fill — Question requiring word(s) in blank.

General Training (GT) — IELTS module with practical Reading and letter-writing Task 1.

Gerund — Verb -ing as noun (*Swimming is healthy*).

Grammatical Range and Accuracy (GRA) — Writing/Speaking criterion.

Graph — Visual data representation (line, bar, pie).

H

Hedging — Language softening claims (*may, tend to, appear to*).

Homophone — Same sound, different spelling/meaning (*their/there*).

Hypothesis — Proposed explanation; academic term.

I

Idiom — Fixed expression with non-literal meaning (*once in a blue moon*).

Independent clause — Stand-alone sentence clause.

Inference — Conclusion drawn from evidence; Reading skill.

Intelligibility — How easily speech is understood (Pronunciation criterion).

Intonation — Pitch patterns in speech.

Inversion — Reversed word order for emphasis (*Never have I...*).

IELTS — International English Language Testing System.

IDP — Co-owner of IELTS (with British Council and Cambridge).

L

Lemma — Base dictionary form of word (*analyse*).

Lexical chain — Related vocabulary repeated across text.

Lexical Resource (LR) — Vocabulary criterion.

Line graph — Task 1 chart showing change over time.

Linker — See discourse marker.

Listening section — One of four audio parts (Sections 1–4).

L1 — Candidate's first language.

M

Main idea — Central point of paragraph/passage.

Matching headings — Reading task pairing titles to paragraphs.

Mixed conditional — Conditional mixing time frames.

Modal verb — *can, could, may, might, must, should, would*.

Multiple choice — Question with options A–D.

N

Nominalisation — Turning verbs/adjectives into nouns (*analyse* → *analysis*).

Not Given (NG) — Statement neither confirmed nor contradicted by passage.

Noun phrase — Noun plus modifiers (*the rapid growth of urban populations*).

O

On-screen marking — Digital scoring of Writing scripts.

Opinion essay — Task 2 asking agree/disagree.

Overview (Task 1) — Summary of main trends/features; required Band 7+.

Oxford comma — Comma before final item in list (optional in IELTS).

P

Paraphrase — Restating meaning in different words.

Part 1 (Speaking) — Introduction interview on familiar topics.

Part 2 (Speaking) — Individual long turn with cue card.

Part 3 (Speaking) — Two-way discussion on abstract questions.

Participle clause — Clause using present/past participle (*Located in the north,...*).

Passive voice — Subject receives action (*Taxes were raised*).

Pie chart — Circular chart showing proportions.

Plagiarism — Copying memorised or source text — malpractice.

Planning time — Task 2 recommended 5 minutes; Speaking Part 2 = 1 minute.

Preposition — Word showing relation (*in, on, at, by*).

Pronunciation — Speaking criterion covering sounds, stress, intonation.

Proofreading — Final error check before submission.

R

- Reading passage** — Academic or GT text with question set.
- Register** — Level of formality (formal/neutral/informal).
- Relative clause** — Clause modifying noun (*students who study abroad*).
- Re-marking (Enquiry on Results)** — Official score review request.
- Reported speech** — Indirect quotation (*He said that...*).
- Rubric** — Instructions and scoring guide for task.
-

S

- Scanning** — Reading quickly for specific information.
- Schwa** — Neutral unstressed vowel /ə/.
- Skimming** — Reading quickly for gist.
- Speaking fluency** — See Fluency.
- Standardisation** — Examiner calibration process.
- Stimulus (Writing Task 2)** — Essay question prompt.
- Subordinate clause** — Dependent clause.
- Synonym** — Word with similar meaning (*rise/increase*).
- Synonym trap** — Choosing Reading answer with same word as question (often wrong).
-

T

- Task Achievement (Task 1) / Task Response (Task 2)** — Fulfilment criterion.
- Task 1** — Writing report (Academic) or letter (GT).
- Task 2** — Writing essay; minimum 250 words; double weight.
- Template** — Fixed essay structure; risky if overused.
- Tense** — Verb time form (past, present, future variants).
- TFNG** — True/False/Not Given Reading question type.
- Thesis statement** — Clear position sentence in Task 2 introduction.
- Topic sentence** — First sentence stating paragraph main idea.

Transfer time — 10 minutes copying Listening answers (paper test).

Trend language — Vocabulary describing data change.

True (TFNG) — Statement agrees with passage.

U

Uncountable noun — Noun without plural (*information, research*).

Upgrade (language) — Improving band through better lexis/grammar.

V

Visual (Task 1) — Chart, graph, table, map, or diagram.

Vocabulary range — Variety and precision of word choice.

Vowel — Speech sound (*a, e, i, o, u*).

W

Word family — Lemma plus derived forms (*economy, economic, economically*).

Word form — Correct noun/verb/adjective/adverb choice.

Word limit (Reading/Listening) — Maximum words allowed in answer.

Word stress — Emphasis on syllable within word.

Writing Task 2 weighting — Task 2 counts double Task 1 toward Writing band.

Y

Yes/No/Not Given — Alternative to TFNG in some Reading passages.

Z

Zero article — No article with general plural/uncountable (*Education is vital*).

Zero conditional — If + present, present — general truths.

Linguistics Extensions

Allophone — Variant of a phoneme.

Aspect — Verb feature (perfect, continuous).

Clause — Group containing subject and verb.

Coherence relation — Logical tie between propositions.

Colligation — Grammatical pattern word enters (*depend on*).

Concordance — Database of word usage in context.

Connotation — Implied emotional meaning.

Denotation — Literal dictionary meaning.

Diphthong — Two-vowel sound (*/aɪ/ in price**).

Discourse — Extended spoken/written language.

Ellipsis — Omission of understood words.

Etymology — Word origin history.

Figurative language — Non-literal expression (metaphor, idiom).

Fricative — Consonant sound (*f, v, s, z*).

Inflection — Word ending change (plural, tense).

Intransitive verb — Verb without direct object (*arrive*).

Irony — Meaning opposite to literal words.

Isolated language error — Single slip not affecting band heavily.

Metaphor — Implied comparison (** flood of immigrants**).

Morpheme — Smallest meaning unit.

Morphology — Word structure study.

Orthography — Spelling system.

Phoneme — Distinct sound unit.

Phrasal verb — Verb + particle (*carry out*).

Phrase — Group of words without full clause.

Plosive — Stop consonant (*p, b, t, d*).

Pragmatics — Language in context.

Predicate — What is said about subject.

-
- Prefix / suffix** — Affixes added to word base.
- Pre-modifier / post-modifier** — Words before/after noun.
- Prescriptive grammar** — Rules dictating “correct” usage.
- Proform** — Substitute word (*it, one, do so*).
- Prosody** — Rhythm and intonation of speech.
- Reference** — Cohesive pointing to prior mention.
- Rhoticity** — Pronouncing /r/ in all positions.
- Semantics** — Meaning in language.
- Simile** — Explicit comparison (*like a*).
- Stem** — Base form before affixes.
- Stop consonant** — See plosive.
- Stress-timed language** — English rhythm based on stressed syllables.
- Subjunctive** — Formal mood (*It is vital that he be informed*).
- Substitution** — Replacing phrase with pro-form.
- Syllable** — Beat unit in word.
- Syntax** — Sentence structure rules.
- Transitive verb** — Verb with direct object (*raise taxes*).
- Utterance** — Unit of spoken communication.
- Voice (grammar)** — Active or passive.
- Word class** — Part of speech.
-

150+ entries. Cross-reference Appendix A14 index and Part 1 Chapter 3 (Band Descriptors).

Appendix A14: Index

Ultimate IELTS Mastery — Alphabetical Index of Major Topics & Chapters

Author: Azhar Hussain · First Edition 2026

How to Navigate

- **Ch** = Chapter number
- **App** = Appendix
- In PDF/EPUB/HTML editions, use the clickable outline / search.
- File path: `book/part##_name/ch####_title.md` or `book/appendices/a##_name.md`

A

Topic	Location
Academic phrases vs idioms	Ch 176, App A05
Academic Task 1	Ch 94–101, App A12 F6–F10
Academic Word List (AWL)	Ch 69, App A06
Active voice	Ch 23, App A01, A13
Adjectives	Ch 13
Adverbs	Ch 14
Advantages/disadvantages essays	Ch 108, App A12 F4
Agriculture vocabulary	Ch 55
AI vocabulary	Ch 58
Articles (a/an/the)	Ch 15, App A01, A10 Sheet 8
Artificial intelligence	Ch 58

B

Topic	Location
Band 9 secrets (overview)	Part 10, Ch 175–180
Band descriptors	Ch 3, App A10 Sheet 15, A13
Band comparisons (essays)	Ch 111
Bar charts (Task 1)	Ch 96, App A12 F6
Brainstorming (Task 2)	Ch 104, App A11 Sheet 1
Business vocabulary	Ch 48
British vs American spelling	App A07

C

Topic	Location
Checklists	App A09
Cheat sheets	App A11
Climate vocabulary	Ch 54
Cohesion	Ch 110, 177, App A10 Sheet 14
Collocations	Ch 70, App A02
Common mistakes	Ch 8
Conditionals	Ch 26, App A01, A10 Sheet 7, A12
Crime vocabulary	Ch 50
Culture vocabulary	Ch 65

D

Topic	Location
Determiners	Ch 18
Diagram completion (Reading)	Ch 88
Discussion essays	Ch 106, App A12 F2
Double-question essays	Ch 109, App A11 Sheet 13

E

Topic	Location
Economy vocabulary	Ch 56
Education vocabulary	Ch 45, App A10 Sheet 11
Environment vocabulary	Ch 47, App A10 Sheet 10
Ethics vocabulary	Ch 66
Exam format overview	Ch 1
Exam strategy	Ch 6
Examiner expectations	Ch 5, 179
Examiner mindset	Ch 179

F

Topic	Location
Family vocabulary	Ch 64
Fluency (Speaking)	Ch 122
Form completion (Listening)	Ch 72
Formula sheets	App A12
Future tenses	Ch 39–42
Future perfect	Ch 41

G

Topic	Location
General Training (overview)	Ch 2
General Training letters	Ch 102, App A11 Sheet 8
Gerunds & infinitives	Ch 20
Globalization vocabulary	Ch 67
Government vocabulary	Ch 49
Grammar reference	Part 2, App A01
Grammar tricks (Band 9)	Ch 178
Glossary	App A13

H

Topic	Location
Health vocabulary	Ch 52, App A10 Sheet 13
Hedging language	Ch 175, App A12 F11

I

Topic	Location
Idioms	Ch 176, App A05
Inference (Reading)	Ch 90
Irregular verbs	App A03
IELTS scoring	Ch 4

L

Topic	Location
Law vocabulary	Ch 61
Lexical resource	Ch 110, 175
Line graphs	Ch 95, App A10 Sheet 3
Listening (overview)	Ch 71
Listening accents	Ch 78
Listening advanced	Ch 80
Listening question types	Ch 72–77

M

Topic	Location
Map labelling (Listening)	Ch 73
Maps (Task 1)	Ch 99, App A12 F10
Matching (Listening/Reading)	Ch 75, 84–85
MCQ (Listening/Reading)	Ch 74, 86
Media vocabulary	Ch 62
Medicine vocabulary	Ch 53
Mixed charts	Ch 101
Mock tests	Part 9, Ch 123–174
Modal verbs	Ch 27, App A01
Model answers (Task 2)	Ch 113

N

Topic	Location
Nominalisation	Ch 175, 178, A13
Nouns	Ch 11

O

Topic	Location
Opinion essays	Ch 105, App A12 F1
Overview (Task 1)	Ch 94, App A11 Sheet 2, A12 F6

P

Topic	Location
Parallelism	Ch 29
Participles	Ch 21, App A01
Parts of speech	Ch 10
Passive voice	Ch 23, App A11 Sheet 14
Past tenses	Ch 35–38
Phrasal verbs	App A04
Pie charts	Ch 97
Prepositions	Ch 16, App A01
Present tenses	Ch 31–34
Problem/solution essays	Ch 107, App A12 F3
Processes (Task 1)	Ch 100, App A12 F9
Pronouns	Ch 12
Pronunciation	Ch 121, App A08
Psychology vocabulary	Ch 60
Punctuation	Ch 30, App A01

Q

Topic	Location
Question tags	Ch 25
Question types (Reading overview)	Ch 81–89

R

Topic	Location
Reading (overview)	Ch 81
Reading passages (banks)	Ch 91–93
References	App A15
Relative clauses	Ch 22
Reported speech	Ch 28
Revision sheets	App A10

S

Topic	Location
Science vocabulary	Ch 59
Sentence structure	Ch 9
Short answer questions	Ch 77, 89
Skimming & scanning	Ch 82
Society vocabulary	Ch 51
Speaking Part 1	Ch 115–116
Speaking Part 2	Ch 117–118
Speaking Part 3	Ch 119–120
Speaking overview	Ch 114
Spelling mistakes	App A07
Summary completion	Ch 76, 87

T

Topic	Location
Tables (Task 1)	Ch 98, App A12 F8
Task 1 (overview)	Ch 94
Task 2 (overview)	Ch 104
Technology vocabulary	Ch 46, App A10 Sheet 12
Tenses (complete review)	Ch 43
TFNG / YNNG	Ch 83, App A10 Sheet 4, A12 F19
Time management	Ch 7, 180, App A09
Time-saving methods	Ch 180
Tourism vocabulary	Ch 57
Transportation vocabulary	Ch 63
True/False/Not Given	Ch 83

U

Topic	Location
Urbanization vocabulary	Ch 68

V

Topic	Location
Vocabulary dictionary (index)	App A02
Vocabulary learning system	Ch 44
Vocabulary (advanced patterns)	Ch 175

W

Topic	Location
Writing cohesion & lexis	Ch 110
Writing Task 1 practice	Ch 103
Writing Task 2 question bank	Ch 112

Appendices Quick Index

App	Title
A01	Grammar Reference
A02	Vocabulary Dictionary Index
A03	Irregular Verbs
A04	Phrasal Verbs
A05	Idioms for IELTS
A06	Academic Word List
A07	Common Spelling Mistakes
A08	Common Pronunciation Mistakes
A09	IELTS Checklists
A10	Revision Sheets
A11	Cheat Sheets
A12	Formula Sheets
A13	Glossary
A14	Index (this file)
A15	References

Parts Overview

Part	Title	Chapters
1	Introduction to IELTS	1–8
2	Complete English Grammar	9–43
3	Vocabulary Dictionary	44–70
4	Listening	71–80
5	Reading	81–93
6	Writing Task 1	94–103
7	Writing Task 2	104–113
8	Speaking	114–122
9	Practice Tests	123–174
10	Band 9 Secrets	175–180

Use `book/front_matter/05_toc.md` for complete table of contents.

Appendix A15: References

Estimated study time	45–120 minutes (adjust by level)
Prerequisites	Complete earlier chapters in this Part where marked
Difficulty	Progressive — core theory first, then Band 8–9 stretch tasks
Key takeaways	Finish Review, Quiz, and Exam Tips before advancing

Ultimate IELTS Mastery — Sources & Further Reading

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Note on Originality

Ultimate IELTS Mastery is an **original pedagogical work** by **Azhar Hussain**. Chapter content, exercises, model structures, practice materials, mock tests, appendices, and teaching sequences were **authored for this book** unless explicitly noted below.

This appendix cites **public official resources**, **widely published academic references**, and **standard reference works** that inform IELTS preparation. Listing a source does **not** imply reproduction of copyrighted test materials. **No actual IELTS test items** from Cambridge or other publishers are included in this book.

For **authentic practice tests**, obtain official materials from Cambridge University Press and IELTS partners listed below.

Official IELTS Resources

IELTS.org (Official IELTS Website)

- URL: <https://www.ielts.org>

- **Publisher:** IELTS partners (British Council, IDP, Cambridge)
- **Use in this book:** Test format descriptions, band descriptor alignment, administrative procedures referenced in Part 1.
- **Access:** Public; free information pages.

British Council — Take IELTS

- **URL:** <https://takeielts.britishcouncil.org>
- **Publisher:** British Council
- **Use in this book:** General preparation guidance, sample exercises concept, test-day information referenced in strategy chapters.
- **Access:** Public; free preparation resources.

IDP IELTS

- **URL:** <https://www.idp.com/ielts>
- **Publisher:** IDP Education
- **Use in this book:** Test booking information, format confirmation, candidate guidance cross-referenced in introduction chapters.
- **Access:** Public.

Cambridge English — IELTS

- **URL:** <https://www.cambridgeenglish.org/exams-and-tests/ielts/>
- **Publisher:** Cambridge University Press & Assessment
- **Use in this book:** Official test recognition, preparation pathway references, alignment with Cambridge English proficiency framework.
- **Access:** Public.

IELTS Public Band Descriptors

- **Availability:** Published via IELTS.org and British Council preparation sites (Writing Task 1, Writing Task 2, Speaking, Reading, Listening criteria).
- **Use in this book:** Chapters 3, 5, 94, 104, 114, 179, and appendices reference descriptor **categories and principles** — not reproduced verbatim in full. Candidates should download current descriptors from official sites.

Academic & Lexical References

Academic Word List (AWL)

- **Author:** Averil Coxhead

-
- **Publication:** *TESOL Quarterly*, 2000; Victoria University of Wellington
 - **URL (Victoria University):** <https://www.wgtn.ac.nz/lals/resources/academic-wordlist>
 - **Use in this book:** AWL word-family methodology in Chapter 69 and Appendix A06. Word lists in this book are **pedagogical selections and expansions** for IELTS — not a verbatim copy of the full AWL corpus.

English Vocabulary Profile / Cambridge Learner Corpus

- **Publisher:** Cambridge University Press & Assessment
 - **Use in this book:** Informing vocabulary level appropriateness for band targets.
-

Dictionary & Language Reference (Public)

Oxford Learner's Dictionaries

- **URL:** <https://www.oxfordlearnersdictionaries.com>
- **Publisher:** Oxford University Press
- **Use in this book:** Definitions, IPA pronunciation, collocations verified against learner dictionary entries in vocabulary and pronunciation appendices.
- **Access:** Free online learner dictionary (premium features optional).

Cambridge Dictionary

- **URL:** <https://dictionary.cambridge.org>
 - **Publisher:** Cambridge University Press
 - **Use in this book:** British/American pronunciation models, grammar guides, phrasal verb entries in Appendices A03, A04, A08.
 - **Access:** Free online.
-

BBC Learning English

- **URL:** <https://www.bbc.co.uk/learningenglish>
 - **Publisher:** British Broadcasting Corporation
 - **Use in this book:** Recommended for listening practice, pronunciation (6 Minute English, pronunciation tips), idiomatic but learner-safe English referenced in Chapters 176 and Appendix A05.
 - **Access:** Public; free.
-

Recommended Official Practice Materials (External Purchase)

The following are **not included** in this book but are **strongly recommended** for authentic timed practice:

Resource	Publisher	Notes
Cambridge IELTS series (Books 1–19+)	Cambridge University Press	Authentic past papers
Official IELTS Practice Materials	Cambridge / IELTS partners	Sample tests with examiner comments
IELTS Life Skills materials	Cambridge	For Life Skills test only

Grammar Reference Works (General Tradition)

The grammar teaching in Part 2 follows **standard English grammar description** found in widely used references. No single text was copied. Conceptual alignment with:

- *Practical English Usage* — Michael Swan (Oxford University Press)
- *English Grammar in Use* — Raymond Murphy (Cambridge University Press)
- *Cambridge Grammar of English* — Carter & McCarthy

These are cited as **general pedagogical tradition**, not as source of duplicated prose.

Research & Standards Frameworks

CEFR (Common European Framework of Reference for Languages)

- **Publisher:** Council of Europe
- **Use in this book:** Occasional band–CEFR alignment comments in Part 1 (approximate mapping IELTS bands to CEFR levels — indicative only; IELTS publishes its own alignment statements).

Corpus linguistics (general)

Collocations and academic vocabulary selection reflect patterns common in **academic English corpora** (e.g., academic word list research tradition, British National Corpus concepts) without reproducing corpus data.

How This Book Uses References Responsibly

1. **Official criteria** — Described in original words; candidates directed to official downloads.
2. **AWL** — Methodology credited; IELTS-focused expansion is original.
3. **Dictionaries** — Used for verification during authoring; example sentences in this book are **original**.
4. **Practice tests in Part 9** — **Original mock exams** authored for this title, not Cambridge past papers.
5. **Model answers** — **Original compositions** for teaching purposes.

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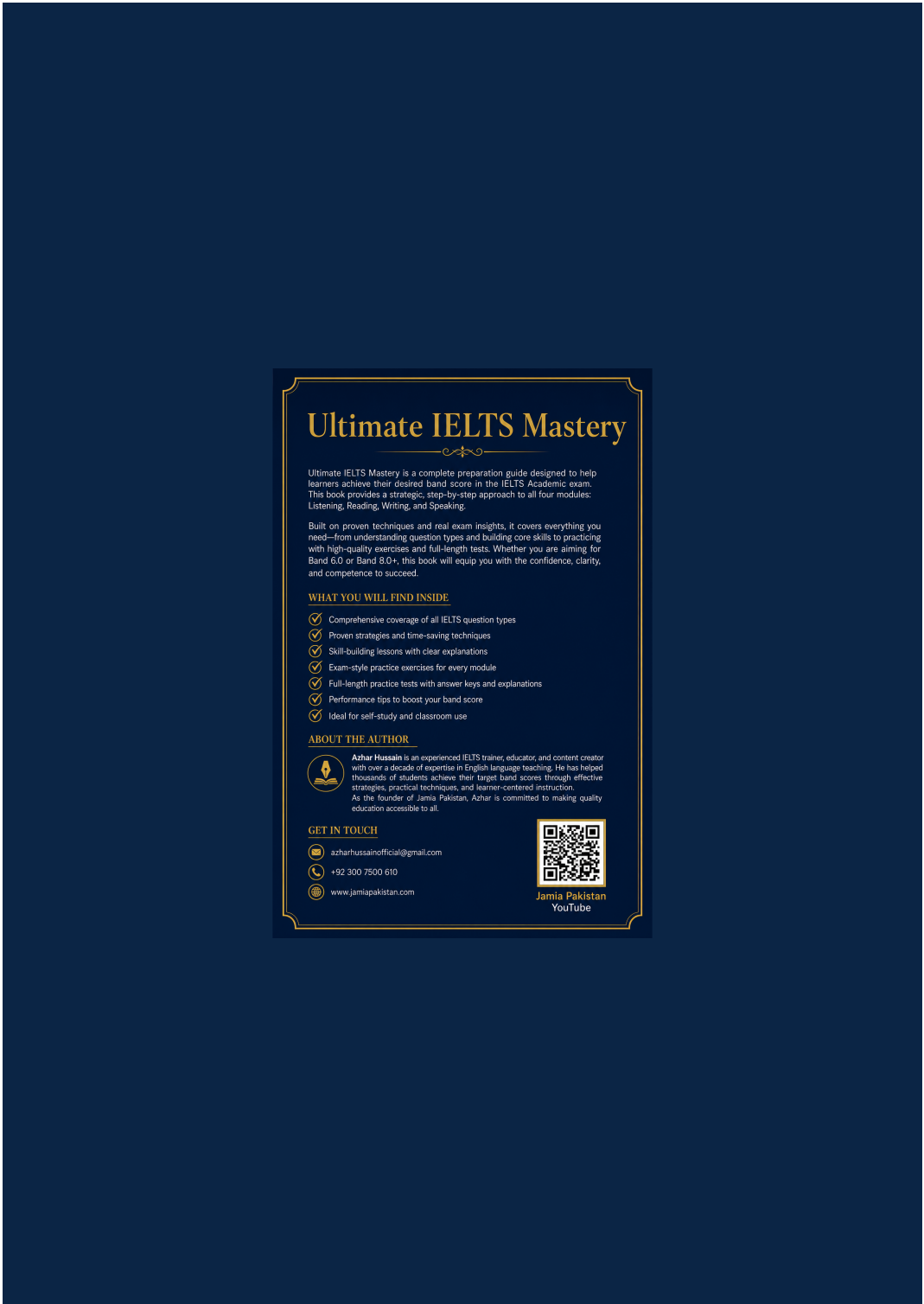
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Markdown source: `book/ directory`.

Version Note

References verified for inclusion: **2025–2026**. URLs active at time of authoring; if a link moves, search the organisation name directly.

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Back Cover



Ultimate IELTS Mastery — Back Cover

Book Description

This comprehensive IELTS preparation guide is designed to take learners from beginner to **Band 8.0–9.0** through structured lessons, thousands of practice questions, complete grammar coverage, advanced vocabulary, writing strategies, speaking practice, reading passages, listening exercises, and full-length mock examinations.

Suitable for

- Academic IELTS
- General Training IELTS
- University Admissions
- Immigration
- Scholarships
- Professional Certification

Features

- Complete Grammar Course
- 10,000+ Vocabulary
- Thousands of Practice Questions
- Model Band 9 Essays
- Speaking Practice
- Reading Passages
- Listening Exercises
- Full Mock Exams
- Answer Keys
- Examiner Tips

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